Table of Contents

JOINT VENTURE AGREEMENT 3
APPENDIX TO TECHNICAL PROPOSAL SUBMISSION FORM - STATEMENT OF INTEGRITY, ELIGIBILITY AND ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY 4
FORM TECH–2: TECHNICAL PROPOSAL 7
A. CONSULTANT'S STRUCTURE AND EXPERIENCE 7
IOS Partners, Inc. 7
Will Change Ltd 14
Project References of the Joint Venture 15
B. DESCRIPTION OF APPROACH, METHODOLOGY, AND WORK PLAN IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE TERMS OF REFERENCE 36
a) Description of Approach 36
b) Methodology 41
c) Work Plan 68
C. CONSULTANT'S ORGANIZATION AND STAFFING 74



FORM TECH-1: TECHNICAL PROPOSAL SUBMISSION FORM

Coral Gables, FL 33134
November 13th, 2025

To:

L'Union des Chambres de Commerce et d'Industrie de l'Océan Indien (UCCIOI)/
Cap Business Océan Indien
Suite 205, 2ème étage, NG Tower, Ebène, Maurice

Dear Sir/Madam:

We, the undersigned, offer to provide the consulting services for **Technical Assistance for Developing the Blue Tourism Cluster for the Indian Ocean** in accordance with your Request for Proposals dated **18 September 2025** and our Proposal. We are hereby submitting our Proposal, which includes this Technical Proposal, and a Financial Proposal sealed in a separate envelope.

We are submitting our Proposal as a **Joint Venture** with:

- **IOS Partners, Inc**., 311 Mendoza Avenue, Coral Gables, FL 33134, Miami, represented by Mr. Robert Hans, Managing Director;
- **WillChange Ltd**, Charmoses - 30702 - Petit Raffray, Mauritius, represented by Mr. Jean-Luc Wilain, Director.

We have attached a copy of our letter of intent to form a Joint Venture signed by every participating member, which details the likely legal structure of and the confirmation of joint and several liability of the members of the said Joint Venture.

We hereby declare that:

a) All the information and statements made in this Proposal are true and we accept that any misrepresentation contained in this Proposal may lead to the rejection of our Proposal by the Client;
b) Our Proposal shall be valid and remain binding upon us for the period of time specified in, Sub-Clause 12.1 of the Data Sheet;
c) We have no conflict of interest in accordance with Clause 3 of the ITC;
d) Except as stated in the Data Sheet, Sub-Clause 12.1, we undertake to negotiate a Contract on the basis of the proposed Key Experts. We accept that the substitution of Key Experts for reasons other than those stated in Sub-Clauses 12.5 and 29.3 of the ITC shall end Contract negotiations;
e) Our Proposal is binding upon us and subject to any modifications resulting from the Contract negotiations. We undertake, if our Proposal is accepted and the Contract is signed, to initiate the Services related to the assignment no later than the date indicated in Sub-Clause 31.2 of the Data Sheet

We acknowledge and agree that the Client reserves the right to annul the selection process and reject all Proposals at any time prior to Contract award, without thereby incurring any liability to us.

We remain,

Yours sincerely,



Full name: Robert Hans
Title: Senior Managing Director
Name of Consultant: IOS Partners, Inc. Capacity: Senior Managing Director and legal representative
Address: 311 Mendoza Avenue, Coral Gables, FL 33134,
Email: iospartners@iospartners.com

JOINT VENTURE AGREEMENT

311 Mendoza Avenue
Coral Gables, FL 33134 - U.S.A.
Tel: + 1 305 648 2877
Fax: + 1 305 446 7122
E-mail: iospartners@iospartners.com
Website: http://iospartners.com

Charmoses – 30702 –
Petit Raffray – Mauritius
+230 5941 7575
jeanluc@willchange.life

Coral Gables, FL 33134
November 13th, 2025

To:

L'Union des Chambres de Commerce et d'Industrie de l'Océan Indien (UCCIOI)/
Cap Business Océan Indien
Suite 205, 2ème étage, NG Tower, Ebène, Maurice

Name of the project: Technical Assistance for Developing the Blue Tourism Cluster for the Indian Ocean

In response to the Request for Proposal for the project "**Technical Assistance for Developing the Blue Tourism Cluster for the Indian Ocean**" the following companies:

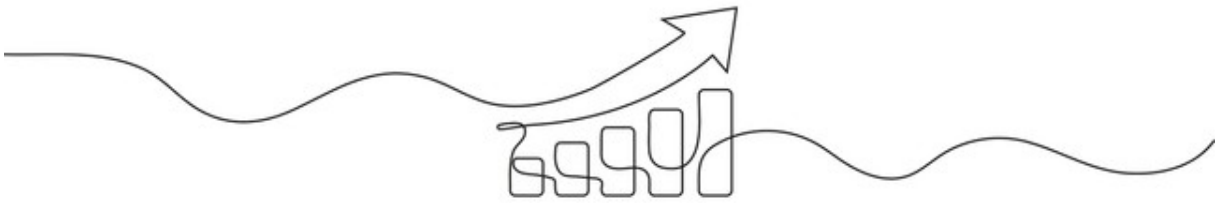
- **IOS Partners Inc**., located at 311 Mendoza Avenue, Coral Gables, FL 33134, Miami, represented by Mr. Robert Hans, Managing Director.
- **WillChange Ltd**, located at Charmoses – 30702 – Petit Raffray, Mauritius, represented by Mr. Jean-Luc Wilain, Director.

declare their intention to form a temporary consortium for the execution of the above-mentioned project.

IOS Partners Inc. shall act as the **Lead Partner of the Joint Venture**, authorized to sign the proposal and represent the partnership in all interactions with Cap Business Indian Ocean until completion of the assignment. In the event of contract award, the partnership will jointly carry out the project implementation.

The undersigned PARTIES appoint Mr. Robert Hans, Senior Managing Director of IOS Partners Inc., as the legal representative of the partnership, and he hereby accepts this appointment.

Robert Hans, Senior Managing Director, IOS Partners, Inc.	**Jean-Luc Wilain**, Director, WillChange Ltd.



APPENDIX TO TECHNICAL PROPOSAL SUBMISSION FORM - STATEMENT OF INTEGRITY, ELIGIBILITY AND ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

Reference name of the Bid/Proposal/Contract signed[1]:
Technical Assistance for Developing the Blue Tourism Cluster for the Indian Ocean (the "Contract")

To: L'Union des Chambres de Commerce et d'Industrie de l'Océan Indien (UCCIOI)/ Cap Business Océan Indien (the "Contracting Authority")

1. We recognize and accept that Agence Française de Développement ("AFD") only finances the projects of the Contracting Authority subject to its own conditions, as set out in the Financing Agreement that directly or indirectly binds it to the Contracting Authority. The Contracting Authority retains exclusive responsibility for the preparation and implementation of the procurement process and performance of the Contract. Consequently, no legal exists between AFD and our company, our joint venture, and our subcontractors. The Contracting Authority may also mean the Client, Employer or Purchaser, as the case may be, for the procurement of works, goods, plants, equipment, consulting services, or non-consulting services.

2. We hereby certify that neither we, nor any person acting on our behalf[2], nor any of the members of our joint venture, nor any of our subcontractors, are in any of the following situations:

2.1. Being bankrupt, wound up or ceasing our activities, having our activities administered by the courts, having entered into receivership, or being in any analogous situation arising from any similar procedure;

2.2. Having been, within the past five years, subject to a final administrative sanction, a final conviction issued by a competent authority, or any other non-court resolution[3] having notably an extinctive effect on public action, either (i) in the country where we are constituted, (ii) in the country of performance of the Contract, (iii) in the context of the procurement or performance of an AFD-financed Contract, (iv) pronounced by a European Union institution, or (v) pronounced by a competent authority in France, for:

- **a)** Prohibited Practices, as defined in Article 6.1 below, or for any other offence committed in the context of the procurement or performance of a Contract (in the event of such sanction, conviction or non-court resolution, we may attach additional information to this Statement of Integrity, such as a compliance program, showing that we (or the person acting on our behalf, the member of our joint venture, or our subcontractor) consider that this sanction, judgement or non-court resolution is not relevant in the context of the Contract, where applicable);
- **b)** Participation in a criminal organization, terrorist offences or offences related to terrorist activities, child labor, or other offences related to human trafficking;
- **c)** Having created an entity in a different jurisdiction (i) with the the intention of avoiding tax or social obligations, or any other legal obligation applicable in the jurisdiction of its registered office, central administration or principal place of business, or (ii) for being an entity created with the intention of avoiding such obligations;

2.3. Having been subject within the past five years to a Contract termination fully settled against us for significant or persistent breach of our contractual obligations during the performance of the Contract, unless this termination was challenged and dispute resolution is still pending or has not confirmed a full settlement against us;

2.4. Having been declared ineligible by one of the multilateral development banks signatories to the Mutual Recognition Agreement of 9 April 2010[4] (in the event of such ineligibility, we may attach additional information to this Statement of Integrity showing that we consider that such ineligibility is not relevant in the context of the Contract, where applicable);

2.5. Not having fulfilled our fiscal obligations relating to the payments of our taxes or social contributions in accordance with the legal provisions of our country of incorporation or of the country of the Contracting Authority;

---

[1] In the case of a Contract already signed to be refinanced.
[2] Directors, (including any person who is a member of the administrative management or supervisory body, or with powers of representation, decision or control), employees, or agents (be them declared or not).
[3] Including the Judicial Public Interest Agreement (CJIP), a decision following an Appearance on Prior Recognition of Guilt (CPRC), a negotiated resolution agreement, or any other similar form of transaction terminating criminal proceedings.
[4] World Bank, Inter-American Development Bank, African Development Bank, Asian Development Bank, and European Bank for Reconstruction and Development.

2.6. Having created falsified documents or committed misrepresentation when providing the information requested by the Contracting Authority in the context of the procurement and award process for this Contract.

3. We hereby certify that neither we, nor any party acting on our behalf[5], nor any members of our joint venture, nor any of our subcontractors, nor any of our direct or indirect shareholders, nor any of our subsidiaries acting with our knowledge or consent:

a) Are directly or indirectly subject to, controlled by a person or an entity subject to, or acting in the name or on behalf of a person or entity subject to individual sanctions measures adopted by the United Nations, the European Union and/or France;

b) Are directly or indirectly subject to, controlled by a person or an entity subject to, or acting in the name or on behalf of a person or entity subject to sectoral sanctions measures adopted by the United Nations, the European Union and/or France;

c) Are ineligible for the implementation of the Project owing to any other international sanctions measures pronounced by the United Nations, the European Union or France.

4. We hereby certify that neither we, nor any party acting on our behalf, nor any of the members of our joint venture, nor any of our subcontractors, are [nor have been (in the case of refinancing for a Contract already awarded)] in any of the following situations of conflict of interest:

4.1. Being a shareholder controlling the Contracting Authority or a subsidiary controlled by the Contracting Authority, unless the resulting conflict of interest has been brought to the attention of AFD and resolved to its satisfaction.

4.2. Having business or family relations with a member of the Contracting Authority's services involved in the procurement process or the supervision of the resulting Contract, unless the resulting conflict of interest has been brought to the attention of AFD and resolved to its satisfaction;

4.3. Controlling or being controlled by another applicant, bidder or consultant, or being under common with another applicant, bidder or consultant, receiving subsidies from another applicant, bidder or consultant, or granting subsidies to another applicant, bidder or consultant, directly or indirectly, having the same legal representative as another applicant, bidder or consultant, maintaining direct or indirect contacts with another applicant, bidder or consultant allowing us to (i) have given and/or give access to information contained in our respective applications, bids or proposals likely to distort competition (ii) influence them, or (iii) influence the decisions of the Contracting Authority;

4.4. Being engaged for a consulting services mission which, by its nature, is or may be in conflict with the mission envisaged for the Contracting Authority;

4.5. Having prepared ourselves, being or having been associated with a natural or legal person who has prepared, specifications, terms of reference or other documents that have been used for the procurement process in question, and that contain provisions likely to favor an application, bid or proposal;

4.6. Having or having had access to, having prepared ourselves, being or having been associated with a natural or legal person who has or has had access to or prepared, specifications, plans, calculations, studies, or other documents that have not been communicated to all the applicants, bidders or consultants in the context of the present procurement procedure, and which thereby confer us an unfair competitive advantage;

4.7. In the case of a procurement procedure for works, plants, equipment or goods, having been selected ourselves or proposed to be selected (or any of our subsidiary companies having been or being proposed to be selected) to carry out supervision or inspection of the services in the context of this Contract.

5. If we are a state-owned entity or a public enterprise, to participate in a competitive procurement process, we certify that we have legal and financial autonomy and that we operate under commercial laws and regulations.

6. In the context of the procurement and performance of the Contract:

[5] Directors, (including any person who is a member of the administrative management or supervisory body, or with powers of representation, decision or control), employees or agents (be them declared or not).

6.1. Neither we, nor any party acting on our behalf, nor any members of our joint venture, nor any of our subcontractors, have committed or shall commit a Prohibited Practice as defined in the document entitled "AFD Group's Policy to Prevent and Combat Prohibited Practices" available on AFD's Website[6].

6.2. Neither we, nor or any party acting on our behalf, nor any members of our joint venture, nor any of our subcontractors, shall acquire or provide [have acquired or provided (in the case of refinancing for a Contract already awarded)] in sectors subject to an embargo by the United Nations, the European Union or France.

7. We hereby undertake to, and we undertake to ensure that any party acting on our behalf, any members of our joint venture, and any of our subcontractors undertake to:

7.1. Comply with the environmental standards recognized by the international community, including the international conventions for the protection of the environment and, in particular, take all reasonable steps to avoid or limit negative effects on vegetation, biodiversity, soils, groundwater and surface water, and on persons and property resulting from pollution, noise, vibration, traffic and other effects resulting from our activities, in accordance with the laws and regulations applicable in the country of performance of the Contract.

7.2. Implement measures to mitigate environmental and social risks when they are indicated in the environmental and social management plan provided by the Contracting Authority, and ensure that the emissions, surface discharge and effluents produced by our activities respect the limits, specifications or requirements applicable to the Contract.

7.3. Respect the rights of workers related to wages, working hours, rest periods and vacations, overtime, minimum age, regular payments, compensation and benefits, in accordance with the standards recognized by the international community, including the fundamental conventions of the International Labour Organization (ILO), in accordance with the laws and regulations applicable in the country of performance of the Contract; indicate these elements in a document annexed to the employment contracts of our employees and made available to the Contracting Authority; and respect and facilitate the rights of workers to organize themselves and set up a complaints management mechanism for direct or indirect workers.

7.4. Implement practices for non-discrimination and equal opportunities and ensure the prohibition of child labor and forced labor.

7.5. Keep a record for each member of the local staff recording the hours worked by each person, the type of work, the wages paid and the training undertaken, and ensure that these records are available at all times to be inspected by the Contracting Authority and the authorized representatives of the government, in accordance with the laws and regulations applicable to the protection of personal data in the country of performance of the Contract.

8. We, any party acting on our behalf, the members of our joint venture, our subcontractors, our direct or indirect shareholders, and our subsidiaries, authorize AFD to conduct investigations and, in particular, inspect the documents and accounting records relating to the procurement and performance of the Contract, including, but not limited to, our internal processes and rules related to the respect of international sanctions pronounced by the United Nations, the European Union and/or France, and to have them verified auditors appointed by AFD.

9. We undertake to promptly inform the Contracting Authority, which shall inform AFD, of any change of circumstance regarding the sections above, including in case of any sanctions or embargo measures adopted by the United Nations, the European Union and/or France, after we have signed the present Statement.



Robert Hans
Senior Managing Director, IOS Partners, Inc.
311 Mendoza Avenue, Coral Gables, FL 33134, USA
iospartners@iospartners.com

[6] For informational purposes, this policy can be accessed via the following link: https://www.afd.fr/en/combating-corruption

FORM TECH–2: TECHNICAL PROPOSAL

A. CONSULTANT'S STRUCTURE AND EXPERIENCE

IOS Partners, Inc.

HISTORY



SMALL ISLAND DEVELOPING STATES

IOS Partners is an international economic development and financial advisory services firm with extensive experience in coastal & island countries across the Pacific Islands, the Indian Ocean, the Atlantic, and the wider Caribbean. Our experts understand the particular needs of SIDS and their challenges related to sustainable economic growth, trade facilitation, investment generation, access to finance, digital transformation, and climate change.

Stemming from the Barbados Programme of Action adopted in 1994, complemented by the Mauritius Strategy of 2005 and the final document of the Mauritius+5 review, which the Small Island Developing States (SIDS), IOS Partners strongly believes in the potential for growth and expansion in Blue Economy. For more than 20 years, our company has been working towards the **economic growth of SIDS**, focusing on the following sectors:

Blue Economy
Fisheries, Aquaculture, Coastal Tourism and Island Tourism

Connectivity
Aviation, Port & Maritime, Inter-island Transport

Public Sector Governance
Institutional Strenghthening, Health & Social Services

Private Sector Governance
Trade Facilitation & SEZ Creation

Information and Communication Technology for Development
(ICT4D)

Establishing sustainable economic growth is a multi-faceted process that must combine **natural, social and economic considerations**. This requires a coupled approach to policy and financing. Ambitious and coordinated action by governments and businesses is needed to move to a more sustainable development path for our ocean economies. Countries need to focus on integrating ocean sustainability into **economic planning and decision making, and developing appropriate policies, legislation, incentives, infrastructure and capacity.**

www.iospartners.com

BLUE ECONOMY

Singled out from the the UNSDGs, **IOS Partners** strongly believes in **the Blue Economy as a critical economic area with potential for tourism's growth and expansion**. Our company knows **the importance of the coastal and marine environment in SIDS countries**.

Our Blue Economy approach combined **5 areas** of specialization:



AQUACULTURE & FISHERY



SIDS AND COASTAL TOURISM



MARITIME TRANSPORT, LOGISTIC & CONNECTIVITY



INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT & STRENGTHENING



PPP AND PRIVATIZATION

Establishing pathways to a **Blue Economy is a multifaceted process that has to combine natural, social, and economic considerations**, and which must embed the value of nature at the heart of decision making. This requires a coupled approach addressing policy and financing. Ambitious, coordinated action by governments and businesses is needed to transition to a more sustainable development pathway for our ocean. It requires a **national focus on mainstreaming ocean sustainability into economic planning and decision-making**, and the development of appropriate policies, legislation, incentives, infrastructure and capacity.

IOS Partners is dedicated to using its extensive experience to promote sustainable Blue Economy practices and will actively seeks to contribute to the **overall development of the Blue Economy in Developing Countries, in line with the SDG14 of the Agenda 2030 for Sustainable Development**.

14 LIFE BELOW WATER

"The ocean drives global systems that make the Earth habitable for humankind. Our rainwater, drinking water, weather, climate, coastlines, much of our food, and even the oxygen in the air we breathe, are all ultimately provided and regulated by the sea. [...] Saving our ocean must remain a priority. Marine biodiversity is critical to the health of people and our planet. Marine protected areas need to be effectively managed and well-resourced and regulations need to be put in place to reduce overfishing, marine pollution and ocean acidification." – **UN website**

GEOGRAPHIC EXPERIENCES

Caribbean

- Antigua & Barbuda
- Bahamas
- Barbados
- Belize
- Cuba
- Dominican Republic
- Dominica
- Grenada
- Guyana
- Haiti
- Jamaica
- St Kitts & Nevis
- St Lucia
- St Vincent & the Grenadines
- Suriname
- Trinidad & Tobago

Pacific

- Fiji
- Kiribati
- Marshall Islands
- Micronesia
- Palau
- Papua New Guinea
- Samoa
- Solomon Islands
- Timor-Leste
- Tonga
- Tuvalu
- Vanuatu

Atlantic

- Cabo Verde
- Guinea Bissau
- Sao Tome & Principe

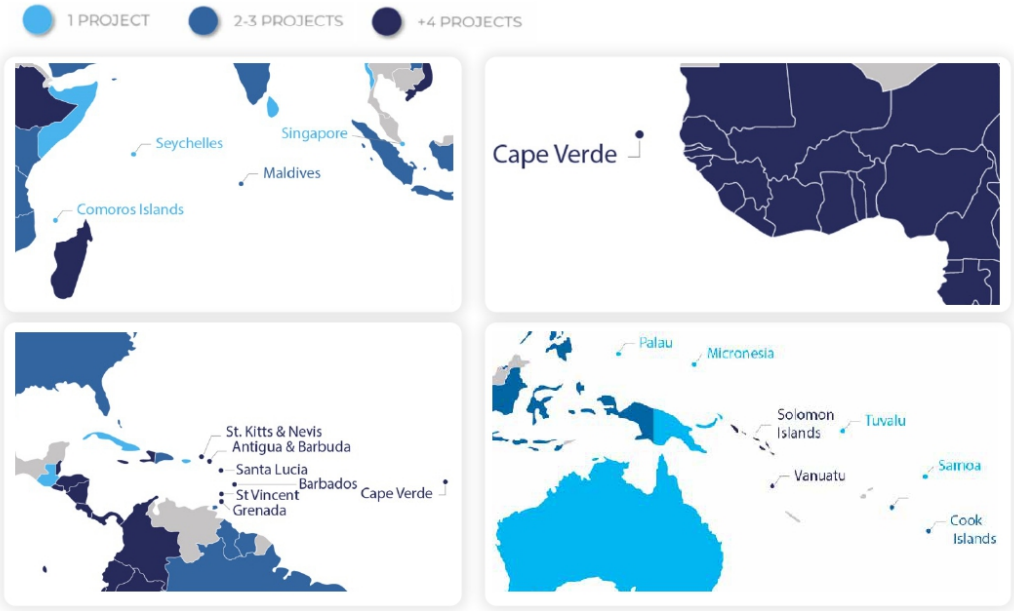
Indian Ocean and South China Sea

- Comores Islands
- Madagascar*
- Maldives
- Mauritius
- Seychelles
- Singapour

Non UN member states / Associate members of Regional Commissions

- Cook Islands
- Puerto Rico

*not considered as SIDS by NU



GEOGRAPHIC EXPERIENCES

Our experiences into the South West Indian Ocean Fisheries Governance and shared growth program



SEYCHELLES

1 project into the SWIOFish3 framework in Seychelles

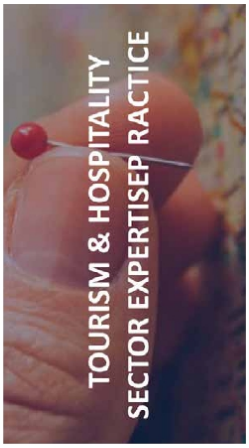
National Tuna Development and Management Plan

MADAGASCAR

6 projects into the SWIOFish2 framework in Madagascar

Elaboration and update of the application texts of the new law on the Fishing and Aquaculture Code
Elaboration of the Fisheries Management Plan (FMP) for the ANOSY region
Elaboration of the Fisheries Management Plan (FMP) for the SAVA region
Elaboration of the Fisheries Management Plan (FMP) for the SOFIA region
Elaboration of the Fisheries Management Plan (FMP) for the DIANA region
Feasibility study for the establishment of a sea cucumber hatchery in Ambanja

SUSTAINABLE TOURISM EXPERTISE



IOS Partners has extensive experience in the tourism and leisure industry, providing a wide range of services to governments, multilateral donor institutions and the private sector. **IOS Partners** has significant knowledge and practice regarding the design and implementation of national strategies to enhance global competitiveness in the tourism sector.**IOS Partners** generates market knowledge, promotes competitive and viable tourism policies and mechanisms, encourages tourism training and formation, and works to make tourism an effective tool for development throughout the world:

- Sustainable Tourism Planning
- Land & Air Service Development
- Cruise Line Tourism Planning
- Destination Promotion & Market Strategies
- Master & Business Planning
- Tourism Training & Certification
- Geotourism, parks & protected area planning
- Financial & Economic Analysis
- Resilience & Recovery Plans
- Cultural & Educational Tourism
- Visitor Center Planning
- Tour Product Development & Packaging
- Rural & Agro Tourism
- Quality Grading Program

Along the years, **IOS Partners** has developed a tailor-made Blue Tourism approach based on its numerous assignments in marine and coastal tourism, including within a large number of SIDS. Our Blue Tourism approach covers governance mechanisms, environmental regulations and management issues, as well as the promotion of initiatives related to Ecotourism, Cruising and Hotels and Resorts.

KEY TOURISM PROJECTS

ST. VINCENT & THE GRENADINES

OECS Regional Tourism Competitiveness Project

The objective of the assignment is to develop a comprehensive and practical Tourism Master Plan that will guide the sustainable socio-economic development of tourism. This Tourism Master Plan will serve to strategically propel the growth of the tourism thus enabling the island nation to be a competitive force amidst constant regional and global changes, demands and trends.

SOLOMON ISLANDS

Aviation and Tourism Sector Strategy

The purpose of this assignment was to prepare a comprehensive 'strategic' plan to guide the development of Solomon Islands' air transportation sector. IOS Partners' contract was extended in October 2020 to also assess the potential impacts of COVID-19 on Solomon Islands' aviation and tourism sectors, and to consider strategies that could mitigate the damage and plan for recovery over the medium to long term. The main objective of the variation was to provide their national carrier, Solomon Airlines, with Strategic Options to mitigate the impact of the COVID-19 on the airline business.

MALAWI

Cultural Development Programme Consultancy

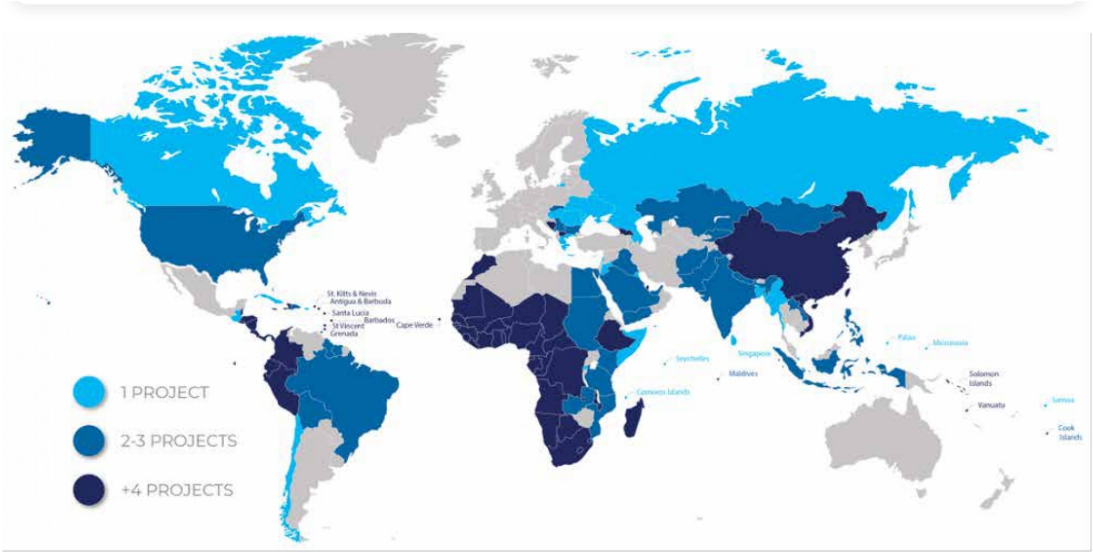
Reviewed, updated, and redrafted the existing cultural development legal framework in Malawi and incorporated cultural changes that have taken place within the sector in order for Malawi to catch up with emerging trends in cultural preservation, conservation, promotion, and sustainable development.



OUR EXPERIENCE IN TRANSPORTATION AND CONNECTIVITY FOR TOURISM

IOS Partners has a unique expertise in connecting tourism places thanks to our extensive experience in the Maritime and Aviation transport. The firm is particularly knowledgeable of the cruise and aviation industries and has demonstrated its capabilities under many projects such as:

- **Solomon Islands** – Diagnostic Assessment of Inter-Island Transport (air and sea)
- **Costa Rica** - Route Development of International Air Services, Phases I-II-III
- **Tuvalu** - Aviation Investment Project (TvAIP)
- **Cape Verde** - Civil Aviation Legal Framework



IOS PARTNERS' OFFICES



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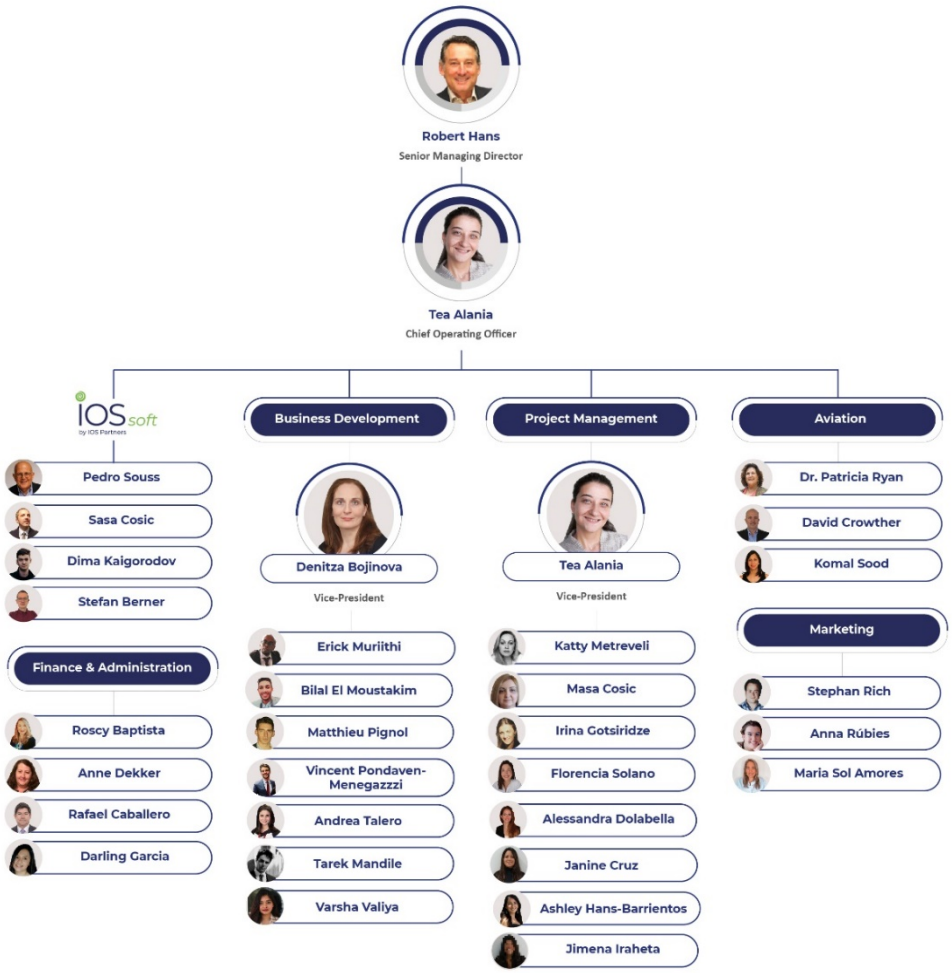
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Finance & Administration
Roscy Baptista
Anne Dekker
Rafael Caballero
Darling Garcia
Business Development
Denitza Bojinova
Vice-President
Erick Muriithi
Bilal El Moustakim
Matthieu Pignol
Vincent Pondaven-Menegazzzi
Andrea Talero
Tarek Mandile
Varsha Valiya
Project Management
Tea Alania
Vice-President
Katty Metreveli
Masa Cosic
Irina Gotsiridze
Florencia Solano
Alessandra Dolabella
Janine Cruz
Ashley Hans-Barrientos
Jimena Iraheta
Aviation
Dr. Patricia Ryan
David Crowther
Komal Sood
Marketing
Stephan Rich
Anna Rúbies
Maria Sol Amores

Will Change Ltd

Mission and Vision

WillChange Ltd is a consulting and training company specialized in sustainable strategy. It supports institutions and businesses in building a prosperous and sustainable future for current and future generations. The company's philosophy is based on the *"art of creating a competitive advantage by becoming sustainable."*

Organization – WillChange mobilizes its expertise and network of freelance consultants to meet the specific requirements of each assignment. This flexible structure allows the company to tailor every proposal to best fit the client's needs.

Expertise and Services – WillChange provides high value-added services addressing climate and strategic challenges:

1. **Strategic Consulting:**
   - Strategic assessments.
   - Change management and business transformation.
   - Integration of ESG (Environment, Social, Governance) principles.
   - Carbon plans: diagnostics, development, and monitoring of net-zero emission strategies.
2. **Training:**
   - Topics: sustainable strategy, carbon accounting, circular economy, biomimicry.
   - Flexible formats: customizable durations and practical case studies.
   - MQA/HRDC certified.
3. **Carbon Transition:**
   - Life cycle analysis.
   - Support for carbon accounting (Bilan Carbone®, GHG Protocol).
   - Development of low-carbon business models.

Strategic Partnerships – WillChange collaborates with renowned partners to strengthen its impact:

- **ZERI (Zero Emissions Research and Initiatives):** global network for sustainable solutions.
- **Bôndy:** social enterprise specializing in CSR consulting and reforestation.
- **Member of the Association pour la Transition Bas Carbone (ABC).**

Client Examples – WillChange has supported leading companies and institutions, including the Government of Mauritius, large conglomerates such as IBL and ENL, medium-sized enterprises, start-ups, and training institutions. The company has operated across all industrial and service sectors in Mauritius.

Founder Profile: Jean-Luc Wilain

Background and Expertise – Jean-Luc Wilain, founder of WillChange Ltd, has 40 years of experience in consulting, management, and strategic development, in French, English, and Spanish. His international career includes senior management positions in various sectors, notably within the IBL Group in Mauritius and ArjoWiggins in Europe.

Values and Commitment – Driven by his passion for building a sustainable world, Jean-Luc is an active member of several organizations promoting sustainability, innovation, and the low-carbon transition, such as the Zermatt Summit Club, Chapter Zero, the Association Bas Carbone, and The Shift Project. Author of the book *"Independence in 2068: Today's Challenges,"* he highlights the current climate and societal issues facing Mauritius. With his forward-looking vision and tailored solutions, WillChange Ltd positions itself as a key player in guiding businesses through their sustainable transformation.

Project References of the Joint Venture

Assignment Name: **OECS Regional Tourism Competitiveness: Technical assistance to support preparing, refining, and/or deepening sustainable tourism development plans and policies, and their implementation within the Ministries of Tourism and Tourism Authorities in St. Vincent and the Grenadines**	**Approx. value of the contract (in current US$):** $ 172,253.50
Country: St. Vincent & the Grenadines (SVG) **Location within country:** Kingstown and regions/islands	**Duration of assignment (months):** 36 months
Name of Client: Central Planning/Ministry of Finance, Economic Planning and Information Technology Email: chavadoyoung1@gmail.com, cenplan@svgcpd.com Phone: +1 784 497 4049, +1 784 457-1746	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 6.78 months
Address: Ministry of Finance, Economic Planning, Sustainable Development, and Information Technology 1st Floor Administrative Building (Financial Complex), Kingstown	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$):** $ 172,253.50
Start date (month/year): April 2021 **Completion date (month/year):** December 2023	**No. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants:**
Name of associated Consultants: N/A	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed:** Shelley-Ann De Gazon – Team Leader T. Jennifer Edwards – Team Leader (substitute) James MacGregor – Tourism Product Development Expert Judy Karwacki – Sustainable Tourism Expert, Community-based tourism Kevin Millington – Product Development and Marketing Specialist Hayden Billingy – Local Project Coordinator David Crowther – Financial Analyst Robert Hans – Project Director Sebastian Rossiter – Project Manager Quentin Lambert – Project Coordinator
Description of Project:	
This project is part of the OECS Regional Tourism Competitiveness. The objectives of this project for Grenada, St. Lucia, St. Vincent and the Grenadines are to: (i) facilitate the movement of tourists within the participating countries using ferries, (ii) improve selected tourism sites, and (iii) strengthen implementation capacity for regional tourism market development. In April 2021, the Central Planning-Ministry of Finance, Economic Planning and Information Technology in St. Vincent & the Grenadines engaged IOS Partners to support sustainable tourism development and economic diversification in St. Vincent and the Grenadines (SVG). This would keep in line with the SVG government's policy for tourism	

development, as outlined in its National Economic and Social Development Plan 2013-2025.

The specific objective of the assignment was to develop a comprehensive and practical Tourism Master Plan that will guide the sustainable socio-economic development of tourism in St. Vincent and the Grenadines. This Tourism Master Plan was meant to strategically propel the growth of tourism thus enabling the island nation to be a competitive force amidst constant regional and global changes, demands and trends.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

Under this assignment, and in collaboration with the Ministry of Tourism, Sports and Culture, Board of Directors and other relevant tourism stakeholders, IOS implemented the following specific activities:

1. Review of all relevant project documentation;
2. Produce an inventory and assessment of tourism in SVG;
3. Conduct a market evaluation;
4. Assess impacts of tourism on SVG;
5. Design an overall tourism development strategy as part of the Tourism Master Plan;
6. Develop an implementation and action plan.

During the development of the Tourism Master Plan, the IOS Partners team of experts identified - together with the main stakeholders - the best strategies and ways forward to ensure a sustainable and optimal medium-term tourism development for SVG. The five-year Master Plan submitted in December 2023 considers the effects of climate change, the impact of the global COVID19 pandemic, and includes a clear Implementation and Action Plan that provides the crucial steps to achieve robust economic growth and obtain positive long-term social-economic impacts for the local SVG communities.

By the end of the project, IOS Partners produced a comprehensive and practical Tourism Master Plan that includes the views and active contributions of all the major stakeholders involved in the project.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment Name: Consultancy Services for Tourism Business in Jamaica	**Approx. Value of the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** $245,158.05
Country: Jamaica	**Duration of assignment (months):** 15 months
Location within country: Various	N/A
Name of Client: Contact: Jerome Newton Business Development Specialist Jamaica Social Investment Fund The Dorchester (Ground Floor) 11 Oxford Road, Kingston 5 Tel: 876-968-4545 Ext: 2315 Mobile: 876-551-7581 Email: Jerome.newton@jsif.org	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 9.5
Address: Jamaica Social Investment Fund 1 Oxford Road, Kingston 5 Jamaica, 1, 1/2 Oxford Road, Kingston, Jamaica	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$ 177,000.00
Start date: July, 2022 **Completion date:** October, 2023	**NO. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants:** 2.95
Name of associated Consultants, if any: Small Planet Consulting, Inc.	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed (indicate most significant profiles such as Project Director/Coordinator, Team Leader):**

	Jennifer Edwards – Team Leader David Crowther – Tourism Financial and Economic Analyst Tea Alania – Project Director Katty Metreveli – Project Manager

Narrative description of Project:

The development and promotion of community-based tourism remains a key area for Jamaica. Emphasizing opportunities for self-employment and the development of small to medium tourism enterprises to enhance the visitor experience. Community Tourism has been estimated to retain nearly 100% of every tourism dollar spend in the community with its locally owned inputs of community experiences provided by local residents, locally grown agricultural products and locally owned small hotels and bed and breakfast accommodation and transportation providers.

JSIF is currently implementing the Second Rural Economic Development Initiative (REDI II) on behalf of Government of Jamaica; and includes 4 components:

1. Climate Resilient Agricultural and Community Tourism Investments for Rural Enterprises;
2. Institutional Strengthening and Capacity Building for Public Entities;
3. Project Management, Monitoring, and Evaluation;
4. Contingent Emergency Response.

The overall objective of this consultancy was to ensure that REDI II develops and incorporates a sound business development approach and strategies for the implementation of Project and its subprojects, while keeping to its Project Development Objectives.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

A) Supporting the Development of Community Tourism Enterprises

- Provided guidance to ensure that all phases of the subproject cycle were inclusive, participatory, and aligned with the realities of rural communities.
- Integrated local perspectives into planning and implementation, ensuring that tourism development directly benefited residents.

B) Improving Financial Access for Rural Tourism Businesses

- Assessed the financial needs and challenges faced by rural micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) in the tourism sector.
- Identified ways to enhance access to credit and financing, working with financial institutions to create tailored solutions.
- Developed strategies to improve financial literacy, revenue generation, and long-term financial planning for community-based enterprises.

C) Building Capacity for Sustainable Community Tourism

- Designed and delivered training programs for local business groups, community tourism operators, and stakeholders involved in REDI II.
- Developed a practical tool-kit to equip community tourism enterprises with skills in operations, management, and sustainability.
- Advised on strategies to strengthen the long-term viability of rural tourism businesses, ensuring continued benefits for local communities.
- Worked alongside REDI II teams to develop a plan for institutional support and capacity building of local tourism enterprises.

D) Monitoring, Evaluation, and Measuring Impact

- Recommended key indicators to track the growth and sustainability of rural tourism enterprises.
- Developed a monitoring and evaluation framework to assess socio-economic benefits and guide improvements to tourism initiatives.
- Contributed to the supervision and evaluation of REDI II's tourism projects, ensuring they remained effective in supporting rural livelihoods.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment name: **Aviation Sector Strategy & Solomon Airlines Strategic Options Analysis - Solomon Islands Roads and Aviation Project**	**Approx. Value of the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$ 475 330,00
Country: The Solomon Islands **Location within country:** Various	**Duration of assignment (months):** 15,5 months
Name of Client:	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:**

the Ministry of Communication and Aviation (MCA) and the Ministry of Infrastructure Development (MID)	7-man months
Address: Ministry of Infrastructure Development P.O. Box G8 Honiara, Solomon Islands Tatyana Nychyperovych Email: tatyana@paiptfsu.com Phone: +677 36720 or +677 36721	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$ 475 330,00
Start date: March 2020 **Completion date:** May 2021	**NO. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants:** N/A
Name of associated Consultants, if any: N/A	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed (indicate most significant profiles such as Project Director/Coordinator, Team Leader):** Anwar Gany - Team Leader Richard Fisher - Aviation Economist Kim Murray - Aviation Regulatory Specialist Dave Park - Airport Infrastructure Specialist David Crowther - Air Market Development Advisor James McGregor – Tourism development Specialist Graham Henderson – Airline Operations Specialist Robert Hans - Project Director

Narrative description of Project:

IOS Partners was engaged by the Solomon Islands Government (SIG) to prepare a comprehensive 'strategic' plan to guide the development of Solomon Islands' air transportation sector. The project was implemented through the following activities:

- Assessment and analysis of existing conditions of Solomon Island's aviation sector enabling legislative frameworks, traffic projections, air traffic control services, infrastructure policy, and regulatory aspects;
- Development of an Aviation Sector Strategy suitable for implementation, including identification of possible funding mechanisms to support future growth of the industry;
- Preparation of practical recommendations for the SIG for future policy developments and reforms in the sector;
- Development of a practical blueprint for implementation of selected options, including a timeframe for implementation and reflective of strategic importance for immediate, short-term, medium and longer-term planning.

In response to the COVID-19 crisis, the SIG extended IOS Partners' contract to assess the potential impacts of COVID-19 on Solomon Islands' aviation and tourism sectors, and to consider strategies that could mitigate the damage and plan for recovery over the medium to long term. The main objective of the variation was to provide their national carrier, Solomon Airlines, with Strategic Options to mitigate the impact of the COVID-19 on the airline business.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

The Consultant undertook the following tasks in the development and formulation of the Aviation Sector Strategy:

i. **Prepared an assessment of the market:** Developed a thorough understanding of the Solomon Islands domestic and international aviation sector and air travel market, including assessing current and forecasted traffic demand; summarizing key issues and challenges; and analyzing the strengths and weaknesses of current arrangements. The Consultant developed three (3) options for traffic forecasting.

ii. **Reviewed the current structure of the international and domestic aviation sector:** IOS Partners considered the operators, market, regulatory framework, economic incentives and subsidies, infrastructure, etc. The economic and social role of air transport in Solomon Islands was also analyzed.

iii. **Analyzed the operational and strategic role of all airports and identified infrastructure requirements:**
   a. Analyzed Solomon Island's airports against the existing and future economic and social characteristics of the regions the airports serve.

b. Prepared recommendations for consideration by SIG regarding operational issues in reference to the strategic role of each airport.

iv. **Identified and assessed current policies and alternative policy options:** Recommended a detailed and comprehensive policy position to foster and maintain stable, sustainable, and viable competitive domestic and international aviation markets. The strategy considered sector issues including domestic and international market entry; conditions for the issuance of air operator's certificate; air services to the outer islands; etc. A practical implementation plan —Blueprint for Implementation of the recommended strategies and initiatives, including timeframes, critical tasks, and other influencing features were developed.

v. **Identified and assessed institutional options**: Identified and weighed options for structuring technical supervision of the aviation sector (safety, security, and environmental aspects), and in-house capability, outsourcing (e.g., PASO or build certain local capacities), and participation in regional and international organizations. Developed a recommended long-term approach that meets Solomon Island's obligations under ICAO and other international agreements, affordable with available resources; and matches local capacity and needs. This included an implementation plan for recommended strategies and initiatives and identification of areas which require institutional capacity development.

vi. **Identified any required legislative and regulatory changes:** Identified changes required to formalize and consolidate recommended reforms. The analysis considered the level of regulation, the impact of regulation, and areas in which regulation is appropriate.

The Consultant also undertook the following tasks in the development of the strategic option analysis for Solomon Airlines:

i. Developed an understanding of the new Post COVID-19 tourism market conditions and the changes to the product delivery/visitor expectations. This task included an analysis of the new traveler's profile and expectations in order for SIG and Solomon Airlines to position themselves strategically under these new market conditions.

ii. Identified and analyzed the most appropriate tourism products/services and resource assets to develop and support the new tourism segments. This included the review of a comprehensive inventory and assessment of both those attractive natural and cultural resources as well as the service providers to identify the level or ability of the industry to respond to the new conditions, particularly in the short and medium term. IOS Partners undertook a product/market matching process to identify the appropriate products within the context of the new market conditions.

iii. Considering the impact of COVID-19, updated Solomon Islands air traffic data and prepared demand forecasts under different assumed scenarios for the pandemic and eventual recovery of aviation and tourism markets. The data and forecasts covered both international and domestic traffic.

- Obtained and analyzed latest available monthly traffic and tourism data to determine impact of COVID-19 to date
- Analyzed tourism sector development options and strategies during the COVID-19 recovery and post-COVID periods
- Developed alternate COVID-19 traffic recovery scenarios, considering the following factors:
  - The extent of the loss of traffic during the crises.
  - Any prolonged economic or other impacts that might continue to constrain demand in originating markets once the original crisis is over.
  - Degree of dependence on a limited number of carriers and/or originating markets that may have been particularly affected by the crisis.
  - Perceptions on the risks of reoccurrence associated with the event that interrupted or reduced air traffic.
  - Significant economic damage to tourism infrastructure or other prolonged reductions in hotel capacity.
  - Air traffic recovery patterns in the Solomon Islands following previous events in comparison to other destinations.
- Updated the demand forecasts prepared earlier in this study to reflect these different assumed scenarios.

iv. Based on the previous tasks, IOS team identified capacity building requirements. Once the products had been defined, the consultant ascertained if each one had the adequately trained management and staff to respond to the International market conditions. This task also included the development and provisions of support

for eventual implementation of an appropriate certification program to demonstrate that all of the components of any product that is being promoted respects the highest standards.

v. Provided a summary of Solomon Airlines' current financial position and expected impact of COVID-19 over the short and medium-term under different scenarios prepared in Task 3. This also included an analysis of the Government's current and forecasted direct and indirect financial exposure to the operations of the airline, including as a shareholder, as the authority potentially imposing community service obligations and as the provider of various forms of financial support. Drawing on the findings of the PRIF-funded "Scoping Study – Post COVID-19 Pacific Short-term Aviation Strategy" draft assignment report, the overview included a separate analysis of the international and domestic components of the Solomon Airlines business and identified current regional/multilateral/bilateral frameworks and agencies currently in place and supporting air travel across the pacific region.

vi. Reviewed Solomon Airlines' Statement of Corporate Objectives 2020-2022 (SOCO), which incorporates the Company Business Plan 2020-2022, and related activities/commitments and analyzed the financial and other implications for Government and for the national airline.

vii. Identified immediate and short-term priority domestic routes and connections and necessary actions to provide the minimum reliable scheduled services to transport people and goods, jumpstart businesses and facilitate projects/investments geared towards economic recovery. This task included a review of Community Service Obligation agreements between Solomon Airlines and the Ministry of Finance and Treasury.

viii. Identified immediate and short-term priority international routes and connections and necessary actions to provide the minimum reliable scheduled services to transport people and goods, jumpstart businesses and facilitate projects/investments geared towards economic recovery. The Consultant drew upon the findings of the PRIF-funded "Scoping Study – Post COVID-19 Pacific Short-term Aviation Strategy" draft assignment report.

ix. Summarized potential alternative or supplementary aviation models, which may be considered to support increased aviation connectivity for Solomon Islands, including the effects of greater market share by regional airlines and conversely greater regional market share by Solomon Airlines. Provided examples where these have been used and discussed the pros and cons for Solomon Islands.

x. In consultation with the Government and Solomon Airlines, recommended, developed and analyzed a short-list of options. The analysis summarized the following information for each option:

- Initial technical analysis – summary of fleet, network and operational strategy, market implications, marketing strategy, and staffing;
- Initial financial analysis – summary of financial structures required to support a viable business model and likely financial implications for Government;
- Additional revenue streams and funding sources to increase Solomon Airlines profit margin;
- Initial risk assessment – main risks and potential high-level risk allocation and mitigating strategies;
- Implications for domestic and regional operations – proposed strategy for continuation of essential domestic and regional routes, with an emphasis on the importance of maintaining domestic services;
- Support that could be requested from development partners and/or other stakeholders to facilitate the different options available;
- Targeted branding and marketing tourism campaign to identify niche markets and appropriate source markets; and
- Conclusion – evaluate the attractiveness of the different options available to Government and other stakeholders, identify key issues and restraints, assess the costs and risks to Government and likelihood of achieving Government objectives.

xi. Discussed institutional arrangements, including any institutional and/or regulatory improvements that would improve the capacity of local agencies to develop both domestic and international services, including identification of any gaps that need to be addressed going forward. The consultant held consultation meetings with the SIG, CAASI and SIACL and the Tourism Division of the Ministry of Culture and Tourism, as well as regional and international bodies, among other relevant stakeholders.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment name: **TA 4527-SOL: Diagnostic Assessment of Interisland Transport**	Approx. value of the contract (in current US$): US$ 365,000
Country: Solomon Islands Location within country: Honiara	Duration of assignment (months): 15
Name of Client: Government of the Solomon Islands/ Asian Development Bank	Total No. of staff-months of the assignment: 9
Address: Robert Guild Director for Pacific Strategy and Special Operations , Asian Development Bank (ADB)— Pacific Department 6 ADB Avenue, Mandaluyong City 1550, Metro Manila, Philippines Tel: + 63 2 632 4444 rguild@adb.org	Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$): USD 300,000
Start date: June 2005 Completion date: January 2007	No. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants: 4
Name of associated Consultants: Nautical Consulting	Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed: Robert Hans –Team Leader/ Principal Privatisation Advisor Brian Tuomi – Maritimes Sector Expert Andy Ricover – Airline Financial Expert and Modeler Tony Liddiard – Airline Operations Expert

Description of Project:

The goal of the TA was to increase the efficiency and effectiveness of interisland air and sea transport services, while minimizing the fiscal burden on and exposure to risk of public institutions and finances. The purpose was to review the status of interisland transport services, determine constraints to their development, and develop strategies for improving them. The outputs were diagnostic assessment reports that informed a strategy for future policy dialogue and programming. It was initially intended to produce (i) a review of existing documentation and an analysis of the operational and financial situations of air and sea transport operators; (ii) an analysis of the entities involved in the ownership, planning, and regulation of interisland transport services; and (iii) the identification of opportunities for improving private sector participation; and (iv) the identification of implementation strategies and action plans for reform.

The government however requested that ADB refocus its assistance toward developing a privatization strategy for Solomon Airlines, prepare the airline for divestment, and guide the privatization process.

Specific services included:

(i) Preparing recommendations for restructuring the airline to ensure effective and efficient interisland services. In particular, evaluated should continue to operate international versus domestic services from within the existing organization, or whether separate and distinct options, up to and including divestment, may be appropriate for each type of operation.

(ii) Determined the required management capability within the airline, Civil Aviation Authority, and Air Transport Licensing Authority to implement each option. Prepared recommendations to obtain the necessary capability, potentially through capacity building or outsourcing.

(iii) Proposed and assessed the feasibility of alternative mechanisms to create contestable markets for provision of transport services including, but not limited to, liberalization of regulations, auctions of service concessions, and minimum subsidy tendering for commercially nonviable but essential service routes.

(iv) Proposed and assesses the feasibility of alternative mechanisms to reform ownership and management of public sector transport operations including, but not limited to, management contracting of public operations, public-private partnerships, joint venture ownership or leasing, asset and service sharing, partial or full privatization, and liquidation.

(v) Prepared a private sector participation strategy for the aviation and maritime sectors. Identify constraints to private sector participation, including policy and regulatory reforms that may be desirable to facilitate the recommendations.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

In the maritime sector, the TA conducted a thorough review of domestic shipping and documented the operational status of domestic service operators, their fleets and other assets, routes and markets, competitors and partners, safety management, organizational structure, and human resources. The TA also reviewed the regulatory and legislative frameworks and identified impediments to private sector development. These inputs were used to prepare an action plan for restructuring operations and institutions.
In the aviation sector, the TA began with a thorough operational review of the airline and a comprehensive financial analysis using a dynamic simulation model to establish a value for the airline using a discounted cash-flow model. The results were analyzed in the context of a range of possible privatization models that became the subject of extensive consultations with a wide range of stakeholders in the public and private sectors within the country and internationally. Additional work was done to analyze the problem of providing social services on uneconomic routes to ameliorate political concerns about the potential impact of commercialization. These activities resulted in a recommended reform program to prepare the airline for sale and a recommended transaction structure.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment Name: **Development of Lagos State Tourism Master Plan**	Approx. Value of the contract (in current US$ or Euro): Confidential
Country: Nigeria Location within country: Lagos	Duration of assignment (months): 4
Name of Client: E&Y Nigeria/ Ministry of Tourism, Arts & Culture (LSMTAC&C) Bunmi Onabanjo: buonabanjo@gmail.com Adewale Adereti: Adewale.Adereti@ng.ey.com	Total No. of staff-months of the assignment: Confidential
Address: Ernst & Young Nigeria 10th & 13th Floors, UBA House, 57 Marina, Lagos, Nigeria. Office: +1 234 1 6314 500 Fax: +1 234 4630 481	Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$ or Euro): US $115,000.00
Start date: February 2018 Completion date: June 2018	No. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants: Confidential
Name of associated Consultants, if any: Sub-consultant to E&Y Nigeria	Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed: Robert Hans – Chief of Party Jean-Marc Bourreau – Corporate Director David Crowther – Chief Economist James McGregor – Senior Tourism Advisor Javier Gonzalez – Infrastructure Advisor Katty Metreveli – Deputy Director, Project Management
Description of Project:	
In realization of the huge potential that the State of Lagos has in the fields of Entertainment, Sport, Creative, Arts and Culture, the administration is committed to investing resources of the state to harness these huge potentials, and to promote tourism and economic development. In this regard, the State Government merged the Arts and Culture with Tourism to form the Ministry of Tourism, Arts & Culture (LSMTAC&C). The purpose of the master plan was to provide a road map to enhance Lagos State's competitive positioning relative to other desirable tourism destinations and to anticipate the state of tourist needs and tourism markets.	
Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:	
IOS Partners, Inc.'s tasks included: 1. Conducting market segmentation and analysis across six strategic tourism sectors 2. Development of at least 5 strategic programs and initiatives to position Lagos as a top tourist destination for each of the 6 sectors of focus: 1) culture and Heritage; 2) Arts and Entertainment; 3) Business and M.I.C.E; 4) Beach and Leisure; 5) Nature and Adventure; 6) Medical and Wellness 3. Identification of potential risks and mitigation action plans for the various tourism programs/initiatives/products	

4. Development of policy and institutional framework to govern the tourism industry and relevant sub-sectors in the medium to long-term
5. Zoning of tourists site
6. Mapping of tourism zones, themes and linkages
7. Base map preparation, mapping and geotagging of tourist sites in Lagos

In addition, IOS was tasked with providing subject matter expertise and input for the following activities:

- Analysis of demand including developing base 20-year tourism forecast
- Analysis of supply of tourism sectors including accommodation capacity and tourism sites
- Identification and analysis of domestic and international visitor demand trends
- Review of existing tourism legislation and policies against leading practices, identification of gaps and improvement opportunities
- Co-facilitation of a 2-day tourism strategy retreat to articulate key strategic imperatives for the transformation of Lagos State Tourism, Arts & Culture
- Defining the airport infrastructure requirements for the tourism industry
- Participating in the Lagos State Tourism Summit

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment Name: **Development of sector activity on tourism in Djibouti (focus on Youth & Woman Entrepreneurship)**	Approx. value of the contract (in current US$): $ 324,954
Country: Djibouti	Duration of assignment (months): 18 months
Name of Client: Centre de Leadership et d'Entrepreneuriat (CLE) Ministère de L'Economie et des Finances Charge de l'Industrie| Funding: World Bank Mme Oubah Malow, Executive Director CLE |oubah.malow@cledjibouti.com M. Ide Mohammed Abdillahi, Head of Program |ide.mohamed@cledjibouti.com |(+253) 77603986|	Total No. of staff-months of the assignment: 11,95
Address: Centre de Leadership et d'Entrepreneuriat (CLE) Quartier 6, Sans-fil PO BOX 716 Djibouti-ville,	Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$): $ 324,954
Start date (month/year): September,2021 Completion date (month/year): March 2023	No. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants: 1,55
Name of associated Consultants: Ecoplannet SARL	Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed: Robert Hans –Supervision and Quality Control Tea Alania - Project Management Director Sebastian Rossiter–Project Manager Quentin Lambert - Project Coordinator Dominique Verdugo - Chef de Projet James McGregor – Tourism Training Expert Anis Meghirbi – Marketing Tourism Expert Amina Said Chireh – Gender & Social Development Expert / Local Coordinator Abdourahman Mahamoud Rayaleh – Woman and Youth Entrepreneurship Expert
Description of Project:	
This mission subscribes to the CLE “Project for Women and Youth Entrepreneurship”, and more specifically falls within the sub-component: “Development of priority value chains of the Project related to improving access to services,	

financing and competitive value chains for women and youth entrepreneurs (Component 2)", with tourism designated as a priority value chain.
IOS Partners was contracted to conduct an inventory of the destination's tourism assets, identify gaps and areas of improvement, and offer solutions for the structuration, reinforcement and promotion of the destination's tourism products on domestic and international markets.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

IOS Partners, Inc.'s services, especially those involving support for entrepreneurship, focused on the integration of youth in the tourism value chain.
IOS Partners, Inc. reinforced the tourism value chain of Djibouti as follows:

- To provide a clear definition and structuring of the current tourism value chain:
  - A comprehensive inventory of all the private sector stakeholders that make up the value chain;
  - An assessment of the gaps and opportunities for the creation and improvement of tourism initiatives; and
  - A workshop on the creation of tourism associations to structure the tourism offer.
- To reinforce and promote tourism products and youth entrepreneurship:
  - Recommendations to enhance the existing tourism offer: infrastructure, star-rating program, classification…;
  - Capacity building and training of stakeholders of the tourism value chain (hotels, guides, restaurants);
    - Visits of cultural, archeological, natural and geological sites of interest
    - Sensitization to best hospitality and sustainable practices in tourism
  - Capacity building and training of CLE project managers and young entrepreneurs;
    - Development of innovative tourism projects and modules on entrepreneurship
    - Presentation of a methodology to support the next cohort of project holders
  - Marketing and promotion of the tourism offer;
    - Crafting of a communications strategy for CLE's business plan contest
    - Presentation of a marketing roadmap to brand the destination internationally

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment name: Strengthening National Coastal Resource Licensing Systems	**Approx. Value of the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$ 104,869.65
Country: Republic of Kiribati **Location within country:** Tarawa	**Duration of assignment (months):** 3 months
Name of Client: Ministry of Fisheries and Ocean Resources	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 2,59
Address: Bairiki, Tarawa | P.O Box 64, Republic of Kiribati, KI **E-mail:** beerot@mfmrd.gov.ki **Phone :** +686 75021099	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$ 104,869.65 (gross)
Start date: September, 30th 2024 **Estimated completion date:** December, 31st 2024	**NO. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants**: 2,5
Name of associated Consultants, if any: IOS Partners Inc IOS Soft.	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed (indicate most significant profiles such as Project Director/Coordinator, Team Leader)** Robert Hans, Project Director Tea Alania, Project Management Director Aloïs Yé, Project Coordinator Pedro Souss, ICT expert Philippe Lallemand Team leader
Narrative description of Project:	

The Ministry of Fisheries and Ocean Resources of the Republic of Kiribati, has engaged IOS Partners, Inc. to provide Consultancy for the project called "*Strengthening National Coastal Resource Licensing Systems".* This project is funded by the World Bank through the Pacific Islands Regional Oceanscape Program (PROP), which aims to strengthen the management of oceanic resources in the region.
The overall aim of IOS Partners' mandate is to centralize the existing coastal resources licensing systems in Kiribati. Currently, there are two separate licensing systems for the coastal resources in Kiribati: one administered by the Kiribati Seafood Verification Authority (KSVA) for seafood export, the other by the Coastal Fisheries Division (CFD) for the harvest of coastal resources and export of non-consumption resources. The two licensing systems operate independently, leading to inefficiencies and regulatory challenges that hinder effective management of the coastal resources.
IOS goal is to streamline these processes into a unified framework, enhancing governance and sustainability in coastal resource management.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

The project **aims to centralize and streamline the two existing licensing systems to enhance efficiency and sustainability.**
This assignment will be conducted in four (4) phases:
Phase 1: Inception
Conduct a kick-off meeting and a field mission with relevant stakeholders (MFMRD / KSVA / CFD and PROP PMU) to deliver an inception report and draft work plan. Key benefits include: clarifying the mandate, identifying challenges, gathering data, building relationships, and maximizing efficiency.
Phase 2: Review of the current coastal marine resources licensing systems
Analyze gaps in the KSVA and CFD licensing systems and propose improvements to enhance their robustness, regulatory alignment, and efficiency.
Phase 3: Assess Institutional Capacity
Evaluate the ability to implement a centralized licensing system by assessing staffing, resources, competencies, and infrastructure. Conduct interviews and focus groups to identify strengths and areas for improvement.
Phase 4: Design and Implement New Licensing System
Develop a comprehensive design and implementation plan, addressing gaps and inefficiencies in the current systems. Define processes, roles, data needs, and required regulatory changes. The plan will include timelines, resources, and milestones. Submit final report with recommendations to strengthen the national coastal licensing system.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment Name: Seychelles National Tuna Development and Management Plan	**Approx. value of the contract (in current US$):** USD 266,742.50
Country: Seychelles **Location within country:** Mahe	**Duration of assignment (months):** 20
Name of Client: Project Implementation Unit of the Department of Blue Economy, Ministry of Fisheries and Blue Economy Ms. Meggy Tirant Procurement Assistant SWIOFish3 Program Department of Blue Economy T \+248 2819175 E meggy.tirant@gov.sc	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 8
Address: Fishing Port PO Box 449 Victoria, Mahé, Seychelles	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$):** USD 257,742.50
Start date: Septembre 2022 **Completion date:** May 2024	**No. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants:** 1.4

Name of associated Consultants: Stuart Laing and Duncan Murray - Blue Economy Research Institute (BERI)	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed:** Jude Bijoux – Team Leader Pierre Failler – Blue Economy Expert Philippe Lallemand – Economic & Financial Modeling Expert Judith Swan – Fishery Law Specialist Arno Haegens – Strategic Communication Expert Stuart Laing – Natural Resources Economist Duncan Murray – Blue Economy Resources Expert Robert Hans - Quality Control Tea Alania - Project Manager

Description of Project:

IOS Partners, Inc., in association with the Blue Economy Research Institute (BERI), was selected to provide the Ministry of Fisheries and Blue Economy with two plans, one Tuna Fishery Management Plan and one Tuna Industry Development Framework.

The main objectives were to:

To identify 10-year development pathways and prepare a development plan for the Seychelles tuna-fishing and post-harvest sectors, in line with the fisheries policies in place and with best international standards, informed by biological, social, and economic analyses and taking into consideration the development aspirations of relevant stakeholders.

To develop a 5-year Seychelles sustainable tuna management plan in-line with stock status, IOTC Conservation, and Management Measures, including the current IOTC YFT rebuilding plan and national policies and ocean governance such as Marine Spatial Plan.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

Review of the Tuna Fishery and Industry, Relevant National Policies, Plans, and Legislation

Output 1: Inception report outlining a detailed work plan for the consultancy, a preliminary schedule of consultative meetings and workshops, identification of key stakeholders, and confirmation of agreed methods for the situational analysis of Part A of the scope of work.

Output 2: Report on the review of the tuna fishery and industry (Part A), including the role of mangrove ecosystems in supporting juvenile fish habitats, and agreed methods for technical inputs to Parts B and C of the scope of work.

Development Plan for the Tuna Fishery and Industry

Output 3: Technical report and presentation on development pathway options for sustainable fisheries, considering environmental conservation strategies, for stakeholder validation and prioritization.

Output 4: Action plan and budget for prioritized development pathway(s).

Output 5: Draft national tuna industry development framework report and administrative framework, ensuring integration of ecosystem-based management approaches.

Development of a Tuna Fishery Management Plan

Output 6: Synopsis of the biological, socioeconomic, and governance contexts that will serve as background to the plan, emphasizing the ecological role of mangroves in coastal fisheries.

Output 7: Report on the vision, purpose, objectives, layout, and structure of the management plan, with sustainable fishery practices at its core.

Output 8: Report on options for conservation and management measures to be presented to stakeholders for validation and selection, including habitat protection strategies.

Output 9: Draft national tuna fishery management plan and administrative framework, incorporating strategies to mitigate habitat destruction.

Validation of the Plans, Training, and Handover

Output 10: A communication, education, and awareness plan and associated materials.

Output 11: Final version of the national tuna industry development framework.

Output 12: Final version of the national tuna fishery management plan, integrating sustainable management of coastal fishery resources.

Output 13: Training materials and a summary of training sessions, including best practices for conservation in fishery management.

Output 14: All datasets (with metadata), scripts, and other workings for the analyses, incorporating relevant environmental data.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment name: Drafting and/or updating application texts for the new Fisheries and Aquaculture law	**Approx. Value of the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$175312,40
Country: Madagascar **Location within country:** Antananarivo	**Duration of assignment (months):** 5 months
Name of Client: Unité de Gestion du Projet SWIOFish 2 (UGP-SWIOFish2)	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 5,72
Address: A 128 SGB, Iadiambola Nanisana 101 Antananarivo, Madagascar **E-mail:** Jean Chrysostophe Razafimandimby| E: coordi@swiofish2.mg| **Phone:**+261 34 05 870 72|	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$175312,40
Start date: December 20,2022 **Completion date:** May 26, 2023	**NO. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants:** 2,09
Name of associated Consultants, if any: Mamia Consulting GEOSYSTEMS Halieus Development Consulting	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed (indicate most significant profiles such as Project Director/Coordinator, Team Leader):** Robert Hans, Project Director Tea Alania, Project Management Director Nora Olga Razaiharidera, Lawyer Mamy Ramanantsoa, Aquaculture expert Quentin Lambert, Project Coordinator

Narrative description of Project:

Within the framework of the second project of Fisheries Governance and Shared Growth of the South West Indian Ocean (SWIOFish2), the Ministry of Fisheries and the Blue Economy (MPEB) wished to elaborate and/or update the application texts of the Fisheries and Aquaculture law in Madagascar.
The main objective of the consortium IOS Partners - Mamia Consulting - GEOSYSTEMS was to ensure, in collaboration with the technical directorates of the DGPA, the availability of the decrees and orders of application of the law 2015-053 on the fishing and aquaculture code, from their conception to their adoption in the council of ministers or the government.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

The specific objectives of this mission were as follows:
• Conduct all necessary research and studies for the elaboration and/or updating of the texts;
• Consult with the heads of the various administrative entities concerned and identify the implementing texts to be updated;
• Adopt an inclusive and participatory approach of all stakeholders during the drafting of texts;
• Develop draft texts, decrees, and orders in accordance with the required standards in this area;
• Accompany the legal department of the Ministry in the legal steps necessary for the adoption of the texts with

the concerned officials;
• Integrate the relevant comments received during the consultations, finalize the draft texts, and validate them;
The consortium worked in close collaboration with the relevant technical and legal directorates of the Ministry of Fisheries and the Blue Economy, and carried out the following tasks:
• Identify the existing texts and the needs in information;
• Conduct field visits in order to establish texts consistent with the reality on the ground, including the importance of mangrove ecosystems in sustaining fisheries, and consultations with the actors;
• Consult with the heads of the various administrative entities concerned as well as all other resource persons;
• Draft the provisional versions of the texts in question;
• Organize and lead the various necessary consultation workshops;
• Organize and lead internal validation meetings;
• Organize and facilitate internal validation meetings;
• Format the corrected drafts;
• Elaborate the final versions (in French and in Malagasy) of the draft texts to be submitted to the Council of Ministers or the Government for adoption.
The study lasted five (5) months and at the end of the project, the consortium delivered the final version of the implementing texts of the Fisheries and Aquaculture law to the client.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment Name : Development of Fisheries Management Plans for the regions DIANA, SOFIA, ANOSY, SAVA	**Approx. value of the contract (in current US$)** : **421936,56 US$** Lot DIANA: 104551,56 US$; Lot SOFIA: 111038,04 US$; Lot ANOSY: 104575,32 US$; Lot SAVA: 101771,64 US$
Country: Madagascar **Locations within country**: Diana, Sofia, Anosy, Sava	**Duration of assignment (months):** 10 months
Name of Client: SWIOFish2 / World Bank	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 26,56 (6,64 per lot)
Address : Unité de Gestion du Projet SWIOFish2 Lot II A 128 SGB Iadiambola Nanisana 101- ANTANANARIVO MADAGASCAR	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$)** :285044,56 US$
Start date : October 2022 **Completion date** : July 2023	**No. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants** :10,72
Name of associated Consultants: MAMIA Consulting GEOSYSTEMS	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed:** **DIANA**- **Team Leader**: Mamy Andriantsoa ; **Fisheries Expert**: Nirina David Rakotomavo, **Socio-economist**: Vestalys Herimandimby **SOFIA**- **Team Leader & Fisheries Expert**: Mamy Andriantsoa ; **Socio-economist**: Laurent Ratrimoharison **ANOSY**- **Team Leader**: Timothy Michael - **Fisheries Expert**: Toky Sylvestre, **Socio-economist**: Moïse Fanomezantsoa **SAVA**- **Team Leader**: Mamy Andriantsoa ; **Fisheries Expert**: Nirina David Rakotomavo, **Socio-economist**: Vestalys Herimandimby
Description of Project:	

The overall objective of the study was to provide technical support to the MPEB and the stakeholders for the development of the Fisheries Management Plan (FMP) for the region concerned. This FMP consisted of a strategic, integrated and participatory spatial planning tool, in order to allow for a better management and a rational use of the fisheries resources.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

- The consultancy supported the development of Fisheries Management Plans (FMPs) by identifying key fisheries and environmental challenges and engaging stakeholders in a participatory and inclusive manner. Particular emphasis was placed on marine fisheries, while lagoon and inland fisheries, including those dependent on mangrove ecosystems, were also considered where relevant.
- **A) Identifying Fisheries and Environmental Priorities**
- Assisted in the preparation of an FMP scoping note, outlining the fisheries and environmental issues, challenges, and priorities of the targeted regions.
- Conducted assessments with a particular focus on marine fisheries while recognizing the role of lagoon and inland fisheries in local livelihoods and ecosystem health.
- **B) Stakeholder Engagement and Participatory Planning**
- Developed a Stakeholder Engagement Plan (SEP) to ensure broad and inclusive participation in the FMP process.
- Conducted extensive field consultations, surveys, and bibliographic research to diagnose the fisheries sector, leading to the definition of ecological and fisheries Management Units (MUs).
- Organized workshops to inform and launch the FMP development process in each region.
- Engaged key local stakeholders, including fishing communities, to co-develop fisheries management measures, implementation strategies, and governance mechanisms.
- **C) Development of Management and Social Plans**
- Prepared FMP implementation plans for each MU, detailing management measures and operational strategies.
- Developed a social management plan addressing socio-economic aspects of fisheries management and the well-being of fishing communities.
- Designed an Action Plan for the Restriction of Access to Resources (PARAR) to regulate fishing pressure while considering alternative livelihoods for affected stakeholders.
- **D) Validation and Formalization of the FMPs**
- Conducted validation workshops to ensure consensus on the FMP documents and their implementation strategies.
- Organized a steering committee meeting to validate the FMP implementation plans.
- Drafted regulatory texts to formalize and facilitate the implementation of each FMP, ensuring sustainable fisheries governance.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment name: Strengthening of artisanal fisheries	**Approx. Value of the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$ 659,985
Country: Haïti **Location within country:** AP3B	**Duration of assignment (months):** 12 months
Name of Client: Ministry of Economy and Finance	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 15
Address: 12B, rue Latortue, Delmas 48, Musseau, Port-au-Prince, Haïti **Phone**: (509) 29 41 02 90 / 28 13 02 90 **Email**: jmgeorges@ute.gouv.ht ; ute_mef@ute.gouv.ht	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** US$ 351,000
Start date: March 2025 **Estimated completion date:** March 2026	**NO. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants**: 9

Name of associated Consultants, if any: DDG FONHDAD	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed (indicate most significant profiles such as Project Director/Coordinator, Team Leader)** Moramade Blanc, Team leader Robert Hans, Project Director Tea Alania, Project Management Director Aloïs Yé, Project Coordinator

Narrative description of Project:

The "Inclusive Blue Economy" (I-BE) Project, funded by IFAD, is implemented by the Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF) in partnership with other Haitian institutions. It aims to strengthen climate resilience and reduce poverty in rural coastal communities in the North and North-East departments of Haiti. The targeted protected area (AP3B) covers approximately 75,000 hectares and includes five main municipalities.
The project focuses on the sustainable management of natural resources, the promotion of sustainable artisanal fishing, and the diversification of livelihoods. It directly benefits around 40,000 people, including 50% women and 40% youth.
The initiative is built on two main components:

1. **Governance and sustainable management of natural resources**
2. **Improvement of livelihoods in local communities**

It includes enhancing fishing practices, watershed management, and capacity building. By collaborating with public and private partners, the I-BE project seeks to provide an environmentally sustainable framework for economic development.

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

- **Assessment & Diagnosis** – Analyze the current state of artisanal fishing, key challenges, and environmental impact, including mangrove degradation.
- **Capacity Building** – Train fishers in sustainable fishing, conservation, and climate adaptation.
- **Community Organization** – Support and strengthen local fishing associations and cooperatives.
- **Infrastructure Improvement** – Propose solutions for better fishing facilities (markets, cold storage, docks).
- **Regulation & Compliance** – Raise awareness and support enforcement of sustainable fishing laws.
- **Sustainable Practices** – Promote selective fishing techniques and marine resource protection.
- **Mangrove & Marine Ecosystem Protection** – Implement programs to restore mangroves and prevent deforestation.
- **Waste & Pollution Management** – Reduce marine waste, especially plastics, to protect coastal ecosystems.
- **Economic Diversification** – Encourage alternative livelihoods to reduce dependence on fishing.
- **Stock Replenishment & Protected Areas** – Establish and support marine conservation zones.
- **Market & Value Chain Enhancement** – Improve processing, storage, and commercialization of fish products.
- **Stakeholder Engagement** – Strengthen partnerships with national and international organizations.
- **Monitoring & Reporting** – Track project impact, provide recommendations, and adjust strategies accordingly.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Assignment Name: Technical Assistance for the Implementation of "*Lalibela Protection, Restoration and Development Project*"	**Approx. Value of the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** €403,702.00
Country: Ethiopia **Location within country:** Lalibela	**Duration of assignment:** 12 months
Name of Client: Ethiopian Heritage Authority (EHA)	**Total No. of staff-months of the assignment:** 36 staff-months

Address: Ethiopian Heritage Authority (EHA) Arada Subcity, King George VI Avenue Addis Ababa, Ethiopia Prof. Abebaw Ayalew eha@eha.gov.et Phone: +251 111 540044; +251 944 335643 Agence Française de Développement (AFD) Bole Sub-city, Woreda 03, House n°2077 Addis Ababa, Ethiopia Mr. Daniel Yani daniely.ext@afd.fr Phone: +251 116 39 29 95 ; +251 116 39 29 02	**Approx. value of the services provided by your firm under the contract (in current US$ or Euro):** €403,702.00
Start date: January 2024 **Completion date:** January 2025 (expected)	**No. of professional staff-months provided by associated Consultants:** N/A
Name of associated Consultants, if any: N/A	**Name of senior professional staff of your firm involved and functions performed (indicate most significant profiles such as Project Director/Coordinator, Team Leader):** Project Director – Robert Hans Team Leader/Conservation Architect – Giulia Agrosi Deputy Team Leader – Fkereselase Sifir Procurement & Finance expert – Birara Yazie

Narrative description of Project:

IOS Partners was engaged by the Ethiopian Heritage Authority (EHA) to provide technical assistance for the implementation of the "Lalibela Protection, Restoration and Development Project" under the patronage of the *Agence Française de Développement* (AFD). The overall aim of this assignment is to assist EHA with human and technical means for the effective management of the protection, restoration and development of the Lalibela UNESCO World Heritage Site; and to enhance EHA staff capacity building program for heritage management and conservation.

These efforts fall under the Franco-Ethiopian cooperation program of restoration, preservation and valorization of the 11 medieval monolithic cave churches; which after nearly 900 years since construction, and due to the continued erosion of the upper part of the rock, both on the roofs of the monuments and the courtyards at the foot of the churches, are in urgent need of restoration.

Conserving the site of Lalibela; enabling its attendance by the faithful, the pilgrims, but also the tourists; and restoring the churches as well as developing its surrounding community, is at the core of the IOS Partners' assignment with EHA.

In working towards this goal, the expected outcomes of this assignment are as follows:

Description of actual services provided by your staff within the assignment:

To achieve the project objectives, **IOS Partners** will undertake the following activities:

COMPONENT 1: Technical assistance to the EHA

1. Ensure the continuity of the ongoing implementation of the project:

- Assist EHA in incorporating decisions, inputs, feedback raised during the UNESCO World Heritage Committee 2023 session (25th September 2023), in on-going and upcoming activities planned in Lalibela;
- Support EHA in updating the World Heritage site management plan and present it to the UNESCO for feedback;
- Assist the EHA to run the international architectural competition for the protection component, based on the preparation of a shared governance between EHA, UNESCO and the main stakeholders for the selection of the contractor, and the finalization of the tender documentation;
- Assist the EHA to launch the international tender process for the restoration component, based on the preparation of a shared governance between EHA, UNESCO and the main stakeholders for the selection of the contractor, and the finalization of the tender documentation;
- Assist the EHA to launch the international tender process for the feasibility study of the urban and social component (ToR of which will be prepared by EHA with the support of AFD) in consultation

with the local administration of Lalibela and following up the implementation and the conclusions of this study;
- Follow up the study execution of the complementary studies (geotechnical, bamboo and hydrological studies) to support the final design of the shelter design;
- Oversee the implementation of the most critical 24 restoration which are under implementation (Sustainable Lalibela Project);
- Ensure that a clear coordination plan and procedures are put in place for EHA to oversee and implement the project in a holistic manner. It means developing a coordination plan/ matrix for Lalibela protection, restoration and development works; and
- Advise and ensure that clear communication channels and procedures (horizontal, vertical) to ensure efficient and effective communication between the different bodies.

2. Ensure the monitoring of the project:
- Initialization of the mission by meeting all stakeholders and collecting documentation;
- Implementation of the necessary tools for project management: planning, budget monitoring, contract monitoring;
- Production of reports and necessary documents to monitor the project progress and the project management unit mission. The expected documents are mentioned in the financial agreement between the MoF and AFD for the Lalibela Protection restoration and development project; and
- Set up the governance of the project, ensure functionality of the local advisory committee: collect all the information needed to organize the meetings, built intelligent working methods and partnerships, among others with Sustainable Lalibela project, to ensure the proper coordination of missions conducted on the site and a joint mobilization of stakeholders and validation committees.

3. Ensure the follow up of the project finance:
- Carry out the financing files support in the finance management and transactions of the project fund;
- Ensure the financial monitoring of the project;
- Support the finance and procurement department in reorganizing their financial system and procedures; and
- Support the transition to electronic procurement process being implemented by EHA and ensure alignment with international procurement procedures and guidelines, AFD's in particular.

4. Ensure the communication of the project:
- Communication strategy proposal and implementation;
- Creation of a website dedicated to the project and regularly updated;
- Organization in conjunction with the local committee of regular consultation (about 4 times a year) with local communities; and
- Production and publication of communication documents: articles, social networks.

5. Ensure that the required logistical support is put in place for the project management unit to make sure that the project activities go as planned.

6. Assist EHA to find funding for the implementation of the protection and restoration works:
- Ensure the interest of potential donors and funders.

COMPONENT 2: Technical, operational & managerial capacity building for EHA and other stakeholders
2.1. Elaborate a need assessment study in terms of expertise and training for the EHA;
2.2. Develop a Training module taking into account the budget made available by AFD;
2.3. Support EHA in developing and implementing its capacity building program taking into account the budget made available by AFD;
2.4. Support EHA in selecting providers and beneficiaries in collaboration with EHA according to identified needs including potentially partner staff involved;
2.5. Make sure the tools and updated user manuals are delivered at the end of the program; and
2.6. Provide an evaluation of the efficacity, efficiency, impact and sustainability of the Lalibela Project.

Name of the Firm: IOS Partners, Inc.

Mission Name: Calculation of the carbon footprint of more than 50 companies	**Approximate value of contracts (in current US$):** 250 000 US$
Country: Mauritius	**Duration of assignments (months): 20**
Name of Client: ENL (conglomerate), Rogers hospitality, Lavastone, Beahcumber, INNODIS, AXXESS, CEAL (civil engineering, agriculture) Ecoasis, (installation of photovoltaic panels), ...	**Number of employees / month participating in the mission: 1**
Your **address**	**Approximate value of services provided by your company under the contract (in US$) :** 250 000 US$
Start date: July 2020 **End date: Ongoing**	**Number of employees/months provided by associate consultants: 1**
Name of any Associate Consultants/Partners:	**Number of professionals provided by Associate Consultants/Partners: 2** **Jean-Luc Wilain** - Team Leader
Project description	
❖ Training in climate issues and the carbon economy ❖ Carbon footprint assessment ❖ Reduction trajectories	
Description of the services actually provided by your staff as part of the assignment	
Calculation of the carbon footprint of more than 50 companies. The results were the carbon footprint and reduction plans to achieve the SBTi targets by 2030. Multiple training sessions in all the companies. NB: the consultant estimated the CCS EF from 2024 to 2030 on the basis of the targets published in the latest roadmap. NB2: the consultant has developed emission factors localised to Mauritius in its database.	

Name of the Firm: WillChange Ltd

Mission Name: Mauritian Lagoon Water Quality Index Project	**Approximate contract value (in current US$):** 65,000 US$
Country: Mauritius	**Mission duration (months): 3**
Name of Client: MOE Mauritius	**Number of employees / month participating in the assignment: 1**
Address: N/A	**Approximate value of services provided by your company under the contract (in US$) :** 22 000 US$
Start date: Sept 2023 **End date:** Dec 2023	**Number of employees/months provided by associate consultants: 2**
Name of Associated Consultants/Potential Partners: **Fetch engénierie**	**Number of professionals provided by Associate Consultants/Partners: 1** **Jean-Luc Wilain** - Team Leader
Project description	
Propose specifications for a water quality index project in the Mauritian lagoons.	
Description of the services actually provided by your staff as part of the assignment	
Reviews of the state of the art and of similar projects that have proved their worth. Stakeholder consultations. Specifications for a water quality index project in the Mauritian lagoons and drafting of reports.	

Name of the Firm: WillChange Ltd

Mission Name: Blue Economy Development Projects	**Approximate contract value (in current US$):** 350,000 US$
Country: Mauritius	**Mission duration (months): 3 years**
Name of Client: IBL Maurice	**Number of employees / month on assignment: 15**
Address: N/A	**Approximate value of services provided by your company under the contract (in US$) :** **NB: was an employee of the beneficiary company, while participating in the consulting effort, then continued as a consultant since July 2020.** 150 000 US$
Start date: May 2017 **End date:** June 2023	**Number of employees/months provided by associate consultants: 5**
Name of Associate Consultants / Potential Partners: ZERI / Gunter Pauli	**Number of professionals provided by Associate Consultants/Partners:** **Jean-Luc Wilain** - Lead Manager (until June 2020) then Consultant
Project description	
Implementation of development projects based on the principles of the Blue Economy according to Gunter Pauli.	
Description of the services actually provided by your staff as part of the assignment	
Development of the ZERI project for IBL. Blue Economy Deliverables: economic analysis, strategic notes and business plans. Results: 6 projects were selected as priorities and implemented.	

Name of the Firm: WillChange Ltd

Mission Name: Business Development with the Mauritius Institute of Oceanography (MOI)	**Approximate Contract Value (in current US$):** US$ 30,000
Country: Mauritius **Location**: Mauritius	**Duration of assignment (months):**
Name of Client: **IBL Ltd**	**Number of employees / month on assignment: 3**
Address:	**Approximate value of services provided by your company under the contract (in US$) :** 30 000 US$
Start date: Jan 2014 **End date: June** 2014	**Number of employees/months provided by Associate Consultants:**
Name of any Associate Consultants/Partners:	**Number of professionals provided by Associate Consultants/Partners:** **Jean-Luc Wilain** - Project Manager
Project description	
Develop a strategic partnership with MOI	
Description of the services actually provided by your staff as part of the assignment	
Business development project with the Mauritius Oceanographic Institute (MOI). The intention was to commercialise their work. A memorandum of understanding was drawn up. Unfortunately, this partnership between a public entity and a private entity did not come to fruition.	

Name of the Firm: WillChange Ltd

Mission name: Commercial development of a macro-algae project in Madagascar	**Approximate contract value (in current US$):** US$ 50,000
Country: Mauritius	**Mission duration (months):**
Name of Client: IBL Ltd.	**Number of employees / month on assignment: 5**
Address: N/A	**Approximate value of services provided by your company under the contract (in US$) :** 50 000 US$
Start date: June 2012 **End date: June** 2014	**Number of employees/months provided by associate consultants:**
Name of Associate Consultants/Potential Partners: **Independent Investors.**	**Number of professionals provided by Associate Consultants/Partners:** **Jean-Luc Wilain** - Project Manager
Project description	
Commercial development of a macro-algae project in Madagascar	
Description of the services actually provided by your staff as part of the assignment	
Project studies Validation of customer markets and intentions Presentation to the board Project follow-up	

Name of the Firm: WillChange Ltd

Mission Name: Installation of an airborne wind turbine in Mauritius	**Approximate contract value (in current US$):** 60,000 US$
Country: Mauritius	**Mission duration (months):**
Name of Client: IBL Mauritius	**Number of employees / month on assignment: 6**
Address	**Approximate value of services provided by your company under the contract (in US$) :** US$ 60,000
Start date: January 2020 **End date:** June 2021	**Number of employees/months provided by the associated consultants:**
Name of any Associate Consultants/Partners:	**Number of professionals provided by Associate Consultants/Partners:** **Jean-Luc Wilain** - Project Manager
Project description	
Installation of an airborne wind turbine in Mauritius	
Description of the services actually rendered by your staff within the framework of the assignment	
Development of the skysails project in Mauritius. Deliverables: Economic assessment of the potential of kite flying in the region, Response to MARENA round 1 Business plan for the pilot installation. Results: Signature of the agreement with the CEB and creation of a joint venture with SkySails Power and IBL.	

Name of the Firm: WillChange Ltd

B. DESCRIPTION OF APPROACH, METHODOLOGY, AND WORK PLAN IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE TERMS OF REFERENCE

a) Description of Approach

The development of the **Blue Tourism Cluster for the Indian Ocean** is conceived as a direct continuation of the ***Action Plan for Sustainable Tourism 2021–2026*** of Cap Business Océan Indien (CBOI). This plan provides the overarching framework for transforming the regional tourism sector towards **sustainable, inclusive, and resilient models**.

It defines six major areas of intervention—**governance, capacity building, observatory and visibility, eco-certification, financing, and regional coordination**—which this technical assistance aims to **operationalize in an integrated and coherent manner**.

The regional context highlights a set of shared challenges:

- High **dependence on coastal tourism**, making island economies vulnerable to climate impacts and environmental degradation;
- **Significant disparities** in the level of tourism development, institutional maturity, and infrastructure across the six island territories;
- A pressing need for **regional harmonization** of policies, sustainability standards, and operational tools;
- And growing **market expectations for low-carbon, biodiversity-based, and community-driven tourism products**.

Within this framework, **Blue Tourism** represents a strategic lever of the Blue Economy, offering island nations the opportunity to reconcile **economic prosperity with ecosystem regeneration**. The project's ambition is to strengthen regional competitiveness, foster biodiversity recovery, and promote social inclusion through a coordinated and measurable transformation of the tourism sector.

Methodological Approach

The proposed methodology is **integrated, participatory, and implementation-oriented**, combining analytical work, stakeholder engagement, and strategic planning. It is structured around six complementary levers, each directly aligned with the axes of the ***Action Plan for Sustainable Tourism***.

1. Governance and Regional Coordination

A robust governance structure will be established from the outset. A **Regional Technical Committee** and **national focal groups** will coordinate planning, validation, and monitoring across the six territories. This governance mechanism will ensure alignment with the Action Plan's objective of **strengthening institutional coordination** and developing a coherent regional framework for sustainable tourism.

2. Comparative Assessment and Strategic Review

A **comparative analysis of policies and regulatory frameworks** will be conducted to identify enabling conditions, gaps, and opportunities for convergence. This will include mapping of the **Blue Tourism value chains**, assessment of sustainability performance, and establishment of a **baseline on carbon emissions and biodiversity impact**. The findings will directly feed into the design of the **Regional Sustainable Tourism Observatory**, as foreseen in Action 3 of the Plan.

3. Strategic Zoning and Ecosystem-Based Planning

Building on the assessment, a **geospatial zoning exercise** will identify priority areas for Blue Tourism development. Zones will be defined based on ecological sensitivity, socio-economic potential, and climate resilience criteria. Recommendations will focus on **low-carbon infrastructure**, **nature-based solutions (NbS)**, and sustainable visitor flow management. This territorial approach will support a diversified and environmentally responsible regional offer.

4. Capacity Building and Stakeholder Empowerment

A **regional capacity-building programme** will be designed and implemented to strengthen the skills and knowledge of SMEs, local authorities, and community-based operators. The programme will include technical and managerial modules, hybrid and online sessions, and a **Training-of-Trainers (ToT)** component. A **monitoring and evaluation tool** will be developed to track progress and ensure continuous learning. This directly contributes to **Action 2 of the Plan**, focused on professionalization and skills transfer.

5. Financing Strategy and Resource Mobilization

Ensuring the sustainability of the Cluster requires an effective financial strategy. A **multi-level financing strategy** will be developed to identify, structure, and align local, regional, and international sources—such as blue and green bonds, climate adaptation funds, carbon credits, and blended finance instruments. A **pipeline of bankable projects** will be prepared to support enterprises and community initiatives in their transition towards Blue Tourism. This responds to the Action Plan's fifth axis on **financing mechanisms and private sector mobilisation**.

6. Regional Branding and Eco-Certification Framework

The creation of a **regional "Indian Ocean Blue Tourism" brand** will establish a unified identity positioning the region as a global benchmark for sustainable and regenerative tourism. A **regional eco-certification framework**, aligned with **GSTC standards**, will be designed, including operational guidelines and a toolkit for SMEs. This initiative will enhance the visibility and credibility of regional tourism operators while supporting their compliance with sustainability norms.

Implementation Logic

The technical assistance will be implemented over **eight months**, following a clear and progressive sequence:

Phase	**Indicative Period**	**Key Results**
Phase 0 – Inception and Mobilisation	Month 1	Project launch, governance setup, stakeholder mapping, and validation of the work plan and calendar.
Phase 1 – Regional Diagnostic and Baseline	Months 1–3	Policy review, comparative analysis, value chain mapping, and environmental/economic baseline.
Phase 2 – Blueprint and Three-Year Action Plan	Months 3–4	Definition of the Cluster framework, strategic zoning, detailed roadmap, and key performance indicators.
Phase 3 – Governance and Digital Platform	Months 4–5	Establishment of the technical committee, development of the online platform, and interim validation.
Phase 4 – Capacity Building and Regional Event	Months 5–7	Implementation of national workshops, the regional MOVE Event, and operationalization of the M&E tool.

Phase 5 – Financing Strategy and Project Pipeline	Months 6–7	Identification of financing sources, preparation of project briefs, and engagement with donors and investors.
Phase 6 – Brand Development and Communication	Months 7–8	Validation of the regional brand, launch of the eco-certification framework, and official presentation of the Cluster.

NB: Throughout the project, IOS Partners will ensure the translation of the main deliverables into French and English.

Knowledge Transfer and Capacity Development Strategy

A central pillar of our approach is the systematic transfer of knowledge and know-how to regional, national, and local actors, ensuring that the Blue Tourism Cluster becomes a self-sustaining regional mechanism beyond the project's duration. The consortium's methodology embeds capacity building and knowledge transfer at three levels — **institutional, professional, and community** — and across all six phases of implementation.

1. Institutional learning and co-creation

From inception, national and regional counterparts are directly involved in analytical, validation, and decision processes through the Technical Committee and national focal points. This **participatory governance model** transforms each deliverable into a learning instrument, with iterative validation sessions, joint drafting of frameworks, and peer review mechanisms that ensure **regional ownership** of outputs and methodologies.

2. Progressive and adaptive capacity building

A comprehensive **Regional Capacity-Building and Training Program** (Phase 4) consolidates the findings from the diagnostic and readiness assessments. It combines a modular learning architecture (awareness → operational practice → certification readiness) with a **Training-of-Trainers (ToT)** mechanism, enabling replication and long-term diffusion of skills. All modules are bilingual (EN/FR) and accessible through the CBOI digital platform, with self-assessment tools and follow-up mentoring to ensure practical application by SMEs and institutions.

3. Continuous knowledge transfer through digital tools

The regional collaborative platform (Phase 3) serves as the backbone of knowledge management. It integrates a digital library, M&E dashboard, GIS maps, and interactive training materials. This ensures open access to data, tools, and learning resources, fostering South–South exchange among island territories and creating a lasting repository of best practices.

4. Learning-by-doing and experiential exchange

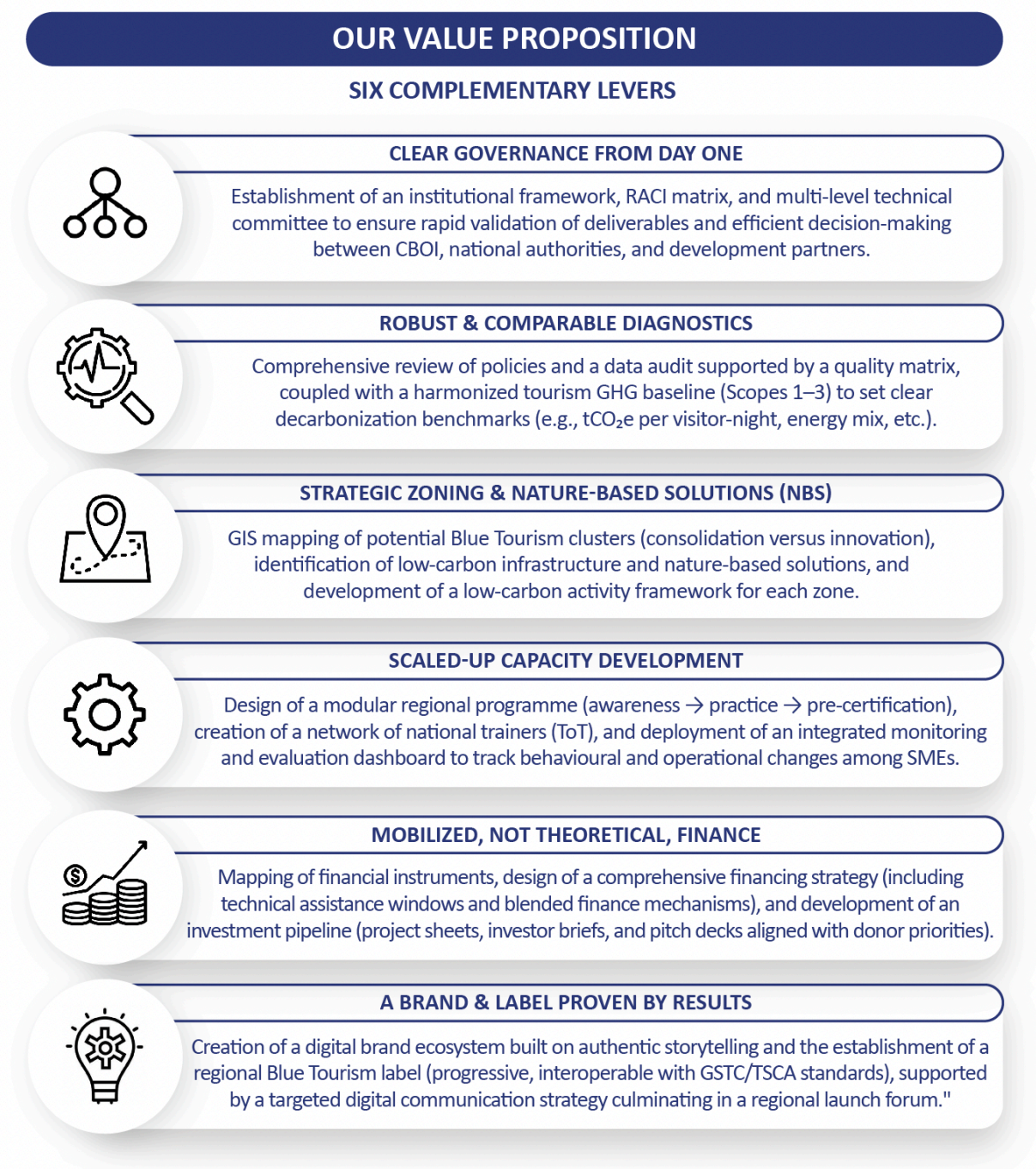
The project promotes peer learning through the **MOVE Regional Event** and national workshops, enabling practitioners, trainers, and SMEs to share experiences on low-carbon innovation and regenerative tourism. These exchanges consolidate technical know-how while building a community of practice that persists beyond the project.

5. Embedded monitoring and feedback for continuous learning

A dedicated Monitoring & Evaluation toolkit (Phase 4) tracks capacity outcomes, behavioural changes, and institutional progress. The system feeds real-time feedback into the training programme, ensuring adaptive learning and continuous improvement.

6. Long-term sustainability of skills transfer

All knowledge resources, tools, and training materials will be integrated into the CBOI online platform and regional knowledge hub, supported by a maintenance and update plan. This guarantees that the capacities developed remain available and continuously enhanced across the Indian Ocean region.
Through this structured, multi-level, and participatory approach, knowledge transfer is not a separate activity but the **core mechanism driving institutional empowerment, private-sector transformation, and regional sustainability**—fully meeting and exceeding the criteria for effective "Transfer of Knowledge (Training) Program" relevance and methodology.



Expected Results

At the end of the assignment, **Cap Business Océan Indien** will benefit from:

- A **validated Regional Blueprint and three-year Action Plan**, providing a clear roadmap for Blue Tourism development;
- A **collaborative online platform** facilitating regional coordination, knowledge sharing, and monitoring;
- A **network of trained and empowered stakeholders** across the six islands;
- A **structured financing mechanism** and a **pipeline of bankable projects** ready for donor and investor engagement;

- And a **regional Blue Tourism brand** supported by a **recognized eco-certification framework**.

b) Methodology

PHASE 0 – Inception & Initial Mobilisation (SO3 – Stakeholder Engagement / SO1 link)

Inception and Initial Mobilisation lay the institutional and operational groundwork, aligning governance, methodology, and coordination among IOC, member states, and partners. It ensures all actors share a common framework before technical work begins.

A0.1 – Launch Mission and Institutional Framework Setup

Official start of the regional Technical Assistance on sustainable and low-carbon blue tourism. Establishes governance, validation chain, and shared understanding among CBOI, AFD, national ministries, and private actors.

Objectives
• Present project scope and intervention logic.
• Confirm governance channels and coordination roles (CBOI / Technical Committee / AFD).
• Secure countries' endorsement of the regional decarbonisation pathway.
• Validate work plan, schedule, communication protocol.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

1. **Regional kick-off meeting** – Hybrid session led by CBOI to present phases (diagnosis → design → implementation → capitalisation) and actor responsibilities.
2. **Governance framework** – Organigram and validation flowchart defining interactions between regional and national levels, aligned with the World Bank ESF principles of transparency, traceability, and accountability.
3. **Designation of focal points** – National and sectoral contacts (tourism, environment, infrastructure, SMEs) listed in a coordination register with roles and communication channels.
4. **Validation package** – Eight-month Gantt, RACI matrix, and communication plan adopted through regional minutes of meeting.

Post-launch follow-up – Inception Report finalised within two weeks, summarising decisions, methodological updates, national inputs, and first risk screening (institutional, data, logistics).
A single, validated governance and coordination framework ensuring consistent execution of all subsequent phases.

A0.2 – Stakeholder Mapping, Readiness and Engagement Plan

This activity identifies, classifies, and mobilises all key actors involved in the development of blue tourism in the Indian Ocean region to ensure inclusive, coordinated, and locally anchored implementation. In line with ToR requirements and good governance practices (World Bank ESF, 2021), the mapping anticipates influence dynamics, strengthens policy coherence, and builds a sustainable collaboration framework among public, private, civil society, and community sectors. It provides the foundation for the regional engagement plan that will guide consultation and validation processes throughout the project.

Objectives
• Identify all actors involved in or affected by blue tourism development.
• Analyse their interests, mandates, capacities, and influence regarding decarbonisation, financing, conservation, and local employment.
• A**ssess the institutional readiness and motivation of stakeholders — both active and potential — to engage in sustainable blue tourism initiatives**, considering post-COVID economic constraints and varying institutional capacities.
• Structure a differentiated engagement plan (information, consultation, co-creation, validation).
• Build an updatable regional stakeholder database including contact details, roles, and levels of involvement.



Our consortium will implement the following approach:

1. **Identification and categorisation of actors**
   - Based on national strategies and existing AFD or UN Tourism projects, experts will compile a comprehensive stakeholders typology covering:
     - public institutions and national agencies (Tourism, Environment, Energy, Finance);
     - private sector representatives (hotel associations, maritime operators, chambers of commerce, investors);
     - local authorities and community organisations;
     - NGOs, civil society, and academia;
     - regional and international partners (CBOI, IORA, UNDP, AFD, World Bank).
   - For each actor, record **mandate, sectoral role, and sphere of influence** within the blue tourism ecosystem.

The output will be an initial stakeholder register, listing names, institutional roles, and levels of interest or dependency in blue tourism development.

2. **Stakeholder Readiness and Incentives Mapping**
   - Conduct a rapid diagnostic of **each actor's ability and willingness to participate** in sustainable blue tourism initiatives. A tailored *Blue Tourism Stakeholder Readiness Tool*, adapted from UNDP and World Bank methodologies, will be applied to score and visualise the institutional, financial, and motivational readiness of each actor.
   - The assessment will go beyond descriptive attributes to measure:
     - institutional capacity (resources, expertise, mandate clarity),
     - financial resilience (ability to sustain engagement),
     - Strategic alignment with low carbon or regenerative priorities, and
     - motivation and incentives to engage (political, financial, reputational).
   - Develop a **Stakeholder Readiness Index** aggregating these four dimensions.
   - Identify **enablers and barriers** for engagement, including incentive **levers** (e.g., tax exemptions, recognition schemes, certification advantages, marketing visibility, training opportunities).
   - Integrate findings into the engagement plan to tailor communication and support strategies.

3. **Influence–interest analysis (stakeholder mapping)** – Building on the readiness assessment, apply a power–interest matrix adapted to multi-island contexts to visualise where each stakeholder stands in terms of influence and engagement potential:
   - Classify stakeholders into four quadrants:
     - *champions* (high influence, high readiness),
     - *potential allies* (low influence, high readiness),
     - *strategic actors* (high influence, low readiness), and
     - *observers* (low influence, low readiness).

   This visual tool supports **prioritisation** of engagement strategies and informs resource allocation for communication and capacity-building.



4. **Engagement plan and communication strategy** – The plan defines interaction modalities per group: frequency, format (bilateral, multi-actor, virtual), and channels (CBOI platform, email, webinars, field missions). It follows the World Bank *Stakeholder Engagement Framework* (2018) and the *CBOI Inclusive Dialogue Charter* to ensure inclusive and transparent communication.

5. **Validation and institutional integration** – The engagement plan will be reviewed by the regional technical committee (Phase 3) and incorporated into the project governance manual, serving as the reference for future consultations under the framework, action plan, and certification phases.

This activity delivers a robust and inclusive consultation architecture, ensuring transparency, local ownership, and the effective participation of all relevant stakeholders across the islands.

A0.3 – Inception Report

This activity consolidates the operational and methodological framework of the *Blue Tourism* project in the Indian Ocean. It synthesises the outcomes of the launch mission and stakeholder mapping to validate the project's methodology, governance, schedule, and responsibilities. As both a contractual and strategic document, it ensures coherence between CBOI, AFD, and member states for a coordinated and measurable transition towards low-carbon and resilient tourism.

Objectives
• Confirm the shared understanding of objectives and deliverables.
• Detail the methodology and sequence of work across SO1–SO6.
• Finalise the consolidated schedule, roles, and communication plan.
• Identify initial risks and propose mitigation measures, incorporating insights from the stakeholder readiness assessment to anticipate institutional or participation-related constraints.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

1. **Consolidation of inception data** – Integrate results of the launch mission and stakeholder mapping into a clear institutional synthesis. Define decision-making and validation channels through a governance diagram showing interactions among CBOI, member states, and donors.
2. **Presentation of the methodology** – Describe the logic of intervention and the analytical tools to be used in each phase (literature review, regional framework, governance, capacity building, finance, certification).

Specify how instruments such as the GHG baseline, value-chain mapping, and RACI/validation matrices fit within the operational schedule.

3. **Validation of schedule and responsibilities** – Prepare a consolidated eight-month Gantt chart with key milestones and inter-phase dependencies. Approve roles and responsibilities in a RACI matrix jointly validated with CBOI.
4. **Risk and quality management plan** – Identify institutional, technical, and logistical risks and define mitigation measures. Integrate findings from the stakeholder readiness assessment to define contingency strategies for low engagement scenarios, ensuring that participation support measures are in place. Establish a quality assurance mechanism based on dual review, progressive validation, and compliance with ESF standards.
5. **Reporting and communication plan** – Set the format of monthly progress reports (status, deviations, corrective actions) and visibility rules for AFD and CBOI identities.

The inception report provides the contractual and technical baseline of the project. It aligns all stakeholders under a common roadmap, establishes transparent governance, and ensures rigorous monitoring of the blue-tourism decarbonisation process in the Indian Ocean region.

Summary Table of Deliverables – Phase 0: Initial Mobilisation and Framework

Phase	Main Deliverables	Outputs	Timeline
Phase 0 – Inception & Initial Mobilisation	• Minutes of the kick-off meeting • Stakeholder Register/list, Readiness & Engagement Plan • Inception Report (operational framework with readiness-based risk mapping)	• Institutional organigram (infographic) • Governance & responsibility matrix (RACI) • 8-month Gantt chart • Stakeholder Readiness Index summary integrated in the risk matrix	**Month 1**

PHASE 1 — Diagnostic and Baseline Analysis (SO1 – Literature Review Report)

This first phase aims to **establish the Diagnostic and Baseline Analysis that form the analytical basis** through a comprehensive review of blue tourism policies, data, and emissions across member countries. It provides a factual, evidence-based baseline for all subsequent planning.

A1.1 – Literature Review and Policy Framework Mapping

This activity establishes the **documentary and analytical baseline** for the project by compiling and synthesising all existing information related to tourism, blue economy, environment, and climate within the Indian Ocean region. It focuses on **collecting and classifying** relevant national and regional documents — policies, plans, legal instruments, and research — to provide a coherent overview of the institutional and policy landscape shaping blue tourism.

The activity provides a clear and harmonised view of the existing blue-tourism policy landscape in the Indian Ocean, serving as a factual reference point for subsequent comparative and harmonisation work in Phase 2.

Objectives
• Compile and classify national and regional policies, plans, reports and academic research related to tourism and environment including blue economy and blue tourism strategies, marine and coastal ecosystem management, climate resilience, and examples of regional cooperation.
• Identify regulatory instruments addressing climate, energy, biodiversity, and blue economy.
• Provide a common documentary baseline for future analyses and consultations.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

Experts will collect and classify key documents from governments, regional agencies, donors (AFD, UN Tourism, World Bank), and scientific journals. A structured digital library will be created by country and theme.

Each document will be assessed through a standard grid evaluating: integration of climate and sustainability, coherence with SDGs and GSTC (global Sustainable Tourism Council) or TSCA (Tourism Sustainability Certification Alliance) standards, presence of measurable indicators, and alignment with sectoral policies (energy, fisheries, infrastructure).

Findings will be summarised in a regional policy map highlighting institutions, mandates, and functional linkages, along with a comparative table of policy instruments (fiscal, regulatory, certification, green finance).

By providing a harmonised view of the blue-tourism policy landscape in the Indian Ocean, this activity forms the analytical base for GHG diagnostics (A1.2–A1.3) and the regional sustainability framework (Phase 2).

A1.2 – Data Diagnostic and Gap Analysis

This activity assesses the availability, reliability, and comparability of data related to blue economy and blue tourism, environment, vulnerability assessment to climate change and greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions in the CBOI member states. It establishes a factual foundation for evidence-based analysis and highlights gaps affecting the measurement of environmental and climate performance in the sector.

Objectives
• Inventory and structure all relevant statistical sources and assessment models at national and regional levels.
• Evaluate data quality and comparability across countries.
• Identify critical information gaps impacting tourism-climate analysis.
• Recommend practical actions to strengthen or harmonise data systems.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

Experts will compile databases and publications from ministries of tourism, national statistics offices, environmental observatories, donor-funded projects (AFD, EU, UNDP) and scientific journals. Data will be categorised into five themes as follow:



Each dataset will be evaluated using the **World Bank *Data Quality Assessment Framework*** to score accuracy, timeliness, and coherence. Discrepancies will be rated as minor, moderate, or critical to prioritise improvement needs. A "data gap matrix" will link each strategic indicator (GHG, energy, tourism activity, biodiversity) to its current or missing sources and propose harmonisation or proxy solutions using regional/international references (WTTC, UN Tourism).

The resulting diagnostic guides the construction of the GHG baseline (A1.3) and the design of the monitoring system in Phase 4, ensuring data consistency and regional comparability.

A1.3 – Spatial Differentiation: Urban vs. Rural Tourism Systems

Governance, participation, and tourism impacts often differ sharply between coastal urban and rural areas, with different pressures and expectations.

Objectives	
• Conduct a comparative assessment of blue tourism dynamics in urban–coastal zones (e.g., high density, infrastructure concentration, investor presence) versus rural–peripheral zones (e.g., community-based activities, limited market access):	
- Use GIS and socio-economic indicators to map resource use conflicts, service accessibility, and economic linkages.	- Integrate local governance capacity and participation mechanisms as differentiating variables.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

1. Identify and classify the typology of tourism areas (urban coastal hubs, peri-urban corridors, rural and remote areas).
2. Use spatial and socio-economic data to analyse disparities in infrastructure, access to resources, connectivity, and economic spillovers.

3. Map and visualise governance and participation patterns using GIS and participatory field validation in a few selected areas (stakeholder workshops, community mapping).
4. Integrate findings into the regional diagnostic to inform differentiated policy and investment recommendations.

Purpose: This ensures that the strategy reflects territorial equity and avoids a "one-size-fits-all" cluster design by highlighting both the strengths and vulnerabilities of rural and urban tourism systems.

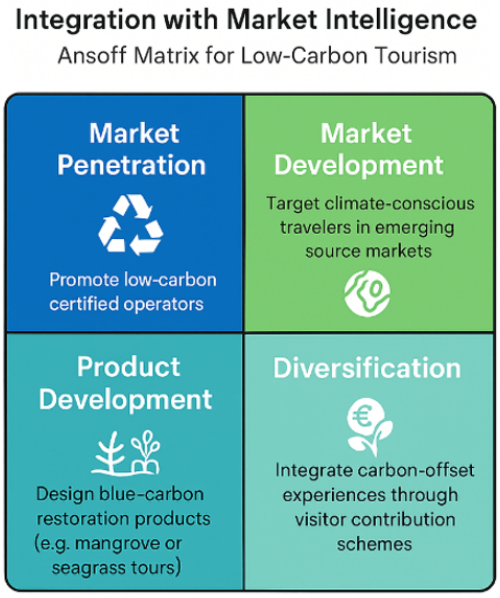
A1.4 – Strategic Carbon Diagnostic and Low-Carbon Positioning

This activity establishes a preliminary regional diagnostic of greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions associated with tourism in the Indian Ocean Commission (CBOI) member states. The purpose is not to conduct full-scale carbon accounting but rather to develop a **strategic and comparable baseline** that supports the design of the regional sustainability framework and identifies opportunities for **low-carbon positioning** within the future Blue Tourism Cluster.

Objectives
• Estimate the order of magnitude of tourism-related emissions using comparable and credible data sources.
• Identify the main emission drivers across key subsectors (accommodation, mobility, food services, maritime activities).
• Highlight potential "low-carbon competitive advantages" and readiness levels across island territories.
• Provide actionable insights to guide the 2026–2029 Action Plan and inform the design of the Blue Tourism sustainability framework.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

• **Data review and approximation** – Compile available data from tourism boards, utilities, and environment ministries, complemented by international references (UN Tourism, WTTC, IEA). When necessary, apply proxy values to ensure cross-country comparability.
• **Comparative diagnostic** – Estimate indicative GHG intensity by subsector using harmonised indicators such as tons of CO_2 equivalent per visitor-night or per tourism revenue unit.
• **Benchmarking and readiness mapping** – Compare territories according to their energy mix, tourism typology, and existing low-carbon initiatives to identify priority areas for emission reduction and climate adaptation.
• **Strategic interpretation** – Translate the diagnostic results into policy and investment insights, highlighting the most promising levers for decarbonisation and resilience within the Blue Tourism Cluster.



Purpose
This streamlined diagnostic provides an evidence-based foundation for the regional sustainability framework and the three-year Action Plan (Phase 2). It focuses on comparability, readiness, and opportunity identification—rather than exhaustive emission modelling—ensuring full alignment with the Terms of Reference while strengthening the analytical depth of the Blue Tourism Cluster blueprint.

Summary Table of Deliverables – Phase 1: Diagnostic and Baseline Analysis

Phase	Main Deliverables	Outputs	Timeline
Phase 1 – Diagnostic & Baseline Analysis	• Institutional Review & Policy Mapping Report • Data Availability & Gap Analysis Report • Spatial Differentiation Study (Urban–Rural Tourism Systems) • Strategic Carbon Diagnostic & Low-Carbon Positioning Note	• Regional document database (digital library) • Policy & regulatory synthesis table • Data gap & quality matrix • Regional low-carbon readiness and competitiveness map	**Months 2–3**

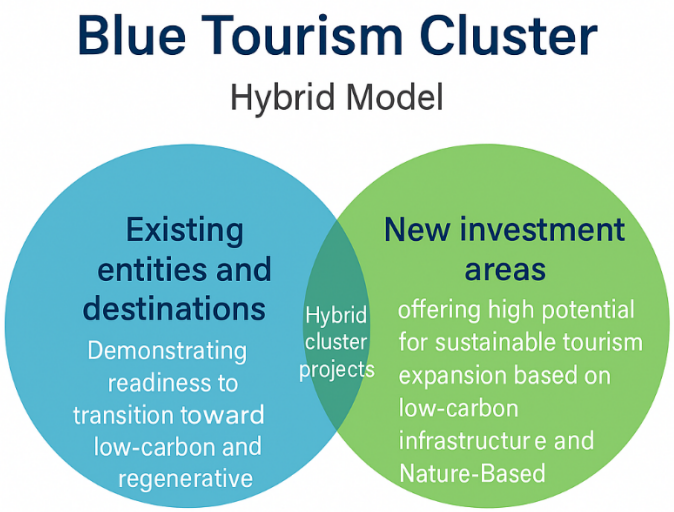
PHASE 2 — Regional Framework and Three-Year Action Plan (2026–2029) – (SO2 – Blue Tourism Cluster Development Plan)

The objective of this phase is to develop the **Regional Framework and Three-Year Action Plan (2026–2029),** that *builds on and deepens* the diagnostic results from phase 1. While Phase 1 established the quantitative and policy baselines, **Phase 2 interprets these diagnostic findings into spatial, economic, and governance strategies** to identify and validate **Blue Tourism Clusters** — coherent geographic zones where low-carbon infrastructure, regenerative tourism products, and supportive governance frameworks can be developed synergistically.

Through strategic and spatial analyses (**A 2.1 – A 2.3**), the phase will:

- Map existing and potential tourism assets and value chains;
- Define cluster typologies and readiness levels (emerging, consolidating, or mature);
- Identify priority **Blue Tourism Clusters** combining environmental resilience, market potential, and community inclusion;
- Validate these clusters with national authorities, CBOI, and stakeholders through participatory review sessions.

These validated clusters will serve as the spatial backbone for the **regional Low-Carbon Tourism Investment and Activity Framework**, guiding infrastructure prioritisation, policy reform, and private investment attraction in later phases.



This approach ensures the cluster acts both as a **laboratory for innovation** and a **scaling mechanism for transformation**, enabling cost-effective behavioural changes alongside targeted infrastructure and investment mobilisation.

A2.1 – Policy, Regulatory, Institutional and climate adaptation Benchmark

Building on the policy mapping and documentary baseline developed under A1.1, this activity conducts a **comparative and functional benchmark** of political, regulatory, and institutional frameworks governing tourism, environment, and climate adaptation across CBOI member states.

It focuses on identifying **regulatory levers and convergence opportunities** that can accelerate the decarbonisation of blue tourism, and lays the groundwork for **harmonising national approaches** under the regional sustainability framework.

Objectives
• Identify alignment and discrepancies with international frameworks (Paris Agreement, CBD, GSTC, SDGs).
• Benchmark and compare national frameworks to define **regional alignment priorities**.
• Identify **policy levers** enabling the blue tourism clusters to function (e.g. investment incentives, land-use zoning, standards).
• Align blue tourism objectives with **NDCs and NAPs** to strengthen coherence with climate agendas.
• Propose a **harmonisation roadmap** (2026–2029) for governance and regulation.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

1. **Document Review and Classification** – Compile laws, policies, and regulatory instruments (tourism, environment, energy, adaptation, coastal management).
2. **Comparative Policy Analysis** – Evaluate coherence across countries and sectors using criteria of policy integration, institutional coordination, and economic instruments.
3. **Climate Adaptation Alignment** :

    - Review each country's *National Adaptation Plan (NAP)*, *Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs)*, and relevant *Disaster Risk Management* strategies.
    - Identify synergies and regulatory barriers between blue tourism priorities and national adaptation measures.
    - Develop an **Adaptation Compatibility Matrix** to ensure the project supports existing commitments and donor frameworks.

4. **Institutional Mapping** – Identify key actors, mandates, and coordination gaps, integrating adaptation governance bodies into the analysis.
5. **Harmonisation Roadmap** – Recommend regional alignment steps, including a working group on sustainable tourism governance and a 2026–2029 harmonisation agenda.

This activity delivers a consolidated picture of governance, regulation and adaptation across the region, identifying pathways to accelerate policy convergence and support the regional decarbonisation blueprint.

A2.2 – Blue Tourism Value Chain and Emission Source Analysis

This activity maps the main blue-tourism value chains within CBOI member states and identifies the primary sources of greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions along each stage of activity. It links the economic structure of the sector with its environmental footprint to guide the prioritisation of decarbonisation measures in the forthcoming regional action plan.

Objectives
• Identify major components of blue-tourism value chains (accommodation, transport, catering, maritime and land leisure, services, etc.).
• Quantify the relative contribution of each segment to total emissions (Scopes 1–3).
• Detect economic and environmental bottlenecks hindering low-carbon transition.

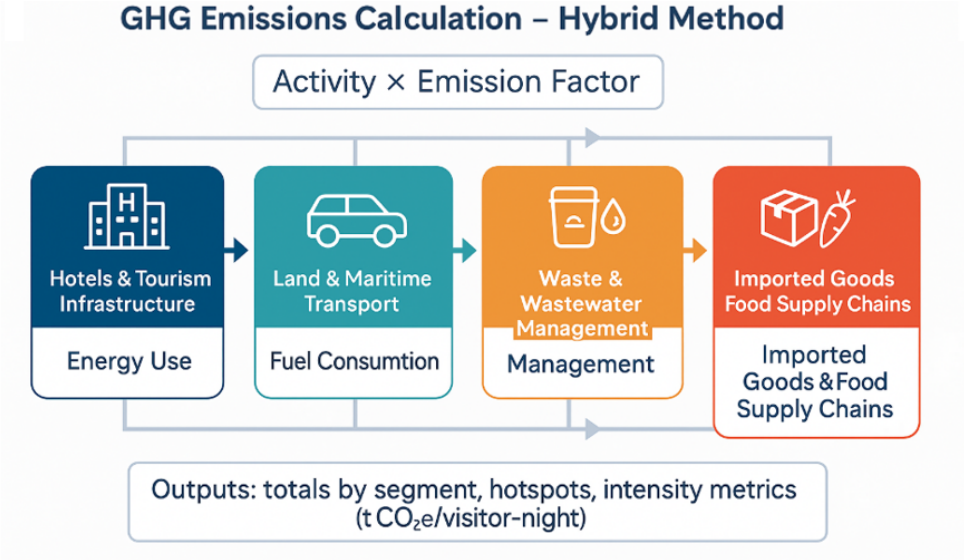
• Define priority levers for emission reduction and efficiency improvement.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

Experts will map the main economic and logistical flows of blue tourism, covering accommodation, inter-island transport, food supply, waste management, and energy consumption. Each link will be described in terms of actors, inputs, outputs, and interconnections with fisheries, agriculture, and maritime transport.

Using the hybrid method (*activity × emission factor*) developed in Phase 1, GHG emissions will be calculated for each segment:

- **Energy use** in hotels and tourism infrastructure.
- **Fuel consumption** in land and maritime transport.
- **Waste and waste-water management.**
- **Imported goods and food supply chains.**



Economic indicators (value added, employment, share of GDP) will be correlated with emission intensity (tCO_2e / USD of value added) to identify high-impact, high-return areas for intervention.

Interventions will be categorised along two complementary pathways:

(i) **technological and infrastructural innovations**, such as energy retrofitting, fleet electrification, circular waste systems, and green mobility; and
(ii) **behavioural and organisational transformations**, targeting staff practices, visitor behaviour, procurement choices, and governance coordination.

These 'soft measures'—awareness, incentives, voluntary standards, and nudges—will be analysed for their emission-reduction potential and cost-effectiveness, recognising that behavioural change can offer substantial benefits at lower investment levels.

Overall, Measures will be ranked by feasibility, cost, behavioural adoption potential, and reduction impact to guide both investment and capacity-building priorities.

This activity delivers an integrated economic–environmental profile of blue tourism, defining concrete decarbonisation entry points for the 2026–2029 regional plan.

A2.3 – Zoning, Identification and validation of Low-Carbon Infrastructure and Nature-Based Solutions

This activity identifies and validates priority zones for sustainable tourism investment, combining environmental, energy, and socio-economic factors to promote low-carbon infrastructure and Nature-Based Solutions (NbS) that enhance coastal resilience and carbon capture.

The validation process ensures that selected zones reflect both scientific analysis and stakeholder consensus, aligning national priorities with regional sustainability objectives.

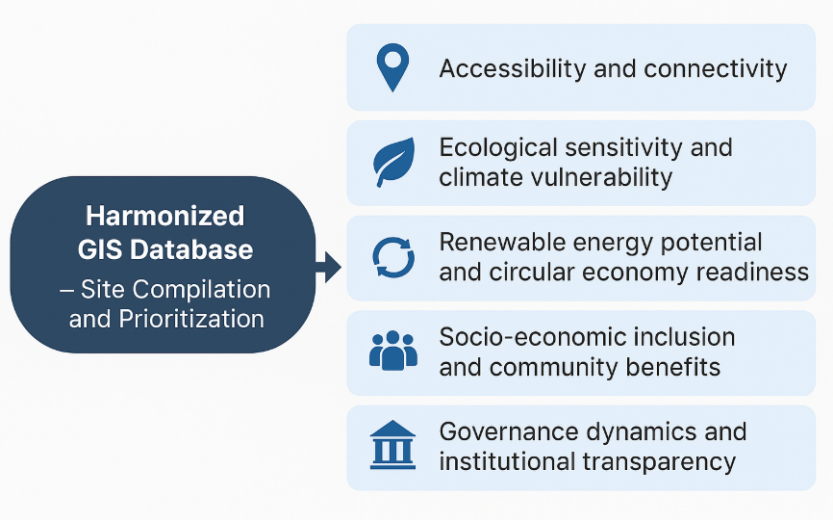
Zoning will distinguish between:

(i) **Consolidation zones**—existing tourism areas with strong institutional capacity and readiness to decarbonise; and
(ii) **Innovation zones**—new or underdeveloped areas offering high potential for low-carbon and NbS-based tourism models.

Objectives
• Identify and validate areas with high potential for low-carbon tourism.
• Integrate environmental, energy, and social criteria in site selection.
• Assess feasibility of sustainable infrastructure (energy, ports, waste, accommodation).
• Propose Nature-based Solution models for coastal protection and regeneration.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

A harmonized GIS database will compile data on tourist areas, coastal ecosystems, infrastructure, and environmental constraints, based in particular on testimonials and input from stakeholders in the blue economy, as well as documentary analysis. A weighted multi-criteria grid will guide site scoring and prioritisation, incorporating indicators such as:



Preliminary zoning maps will be reviewed by the local teams, including through a site visit with the team leader where possible, before presentation to **national authorities, CBOI, and key stakeholders** through in person or virtual validation meetings to confirm the selection of high-potential, low-impact zones.

Validated **high-potential, low-impact clusters** will then serve as the basis for identifying **context-specific investment options**, combining low-carbon infrastructure and regenerative tourism models. These may include solar powered eco-lodges, hybrid or electric mobility, circular waste and water systems, and Nature-based Solutions (NbS) such as mangrove or seagrass restoration, coral gardening and dune rehabilitation.

In parallel, the study will identify **low-emission economic opportunities and activity guidelines** aligned with each zone's ecological and socio-cultural context—such as regenerative marine excursions, carbon-offset visitor schemes, community-led coastal heritage trails, scientific diving, or sustainable gastronomy circuits.

These recommendations will serve as a **"Low-Carbon Tourism Activity Framework"**, advising member states and investors on viable, climate-compatible products and experiences to be prioritised in the regional action plan.

A2.4 – Development of the Regional Blueprint and 2026–2029 Action Plan

This activity translates analytical findings from A2.1–A2.3 into a coherent regional strategy for the sustainable and low-carbon transition of blue tourism in the Indian Ocean. It defines a shared vision, strategic priorities, and measurable actions for coordinated implementation among member states.

Objectives
• Define a common regional vision for sustainable, low-carbon blue tourism.
• Establish strategic pillars, priority measures, and performance indicators.
• Structure a three-year action plan with clear responsibilities and timelines.
• Identify governance and financing mechanisms to support implementation.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

The Blueprint will be co-designed with CBOI and member states through a concise, data-driven process structured around four pillars: governance, decarbonisation, inclusion, and resilience.

Main steps:

- **Framework alignment:** Link objectives with CBOI policy, Paris Agreement, and SDGs.
- **Action design:** Convert priorities into measurable actions with KPIs and clear responsibilities.
- **Phasing:** Sequence actions over 12–36 months by urgency and feasibility.
- **Governance & finance:** Specify coordination roles and indicative funding sources (blue/green funds, PPPs, carbon credits).
- **Validation:** Review through a regional workshop and final endorsement by the CBOI Technical Committee.

The Blueprint and Action Plan form the project's core strategic output—turning diagnostics into an actionable roadmap for sustainable, low-carbon tourism. Validated Blue Tourism Clusters will also serve as the entry point for identifying priority investment opportunities, which will be further structured and financed under Phase 5.

Summary Table of Deliverables – Phase 2: Regional Framework and Three-Year Action Plan

Phase	Main Deliverables	Outputs	Timeline
Phase 2 – Regional Framework & 3-Year Action Plan (2026–2029)	• Comparative Policy & Institutional Benchmark• Economic / Environmental Value-Chain Analysis • Strategic Zoning Report (low-carbon & NbS) • Alignment with National Climate Adaptation Frameworks • Validated Regional Blueprint + Action Plan	• Regional regulatory harmonization map • "Carbon intensity by tourism segment" matrix • GIS map of priority low-carbon zones • Adaptation Compatibility Matrix • **Low-Carbon Tourism Activity Framework (economic opportunities & activity guidelines)** • **Behavioural and Organisational Transformation Pathways** • Consolidated Blueprint with regional GHG indicators & resilience indicators	**Month 4**

PHASE 3 — Regional Governance and Collaborative Platform (SO3 – Stakeholder Engagement)

This phase operationalizes this framework through a **transparent, participatory governance system** and a **digital coordination platform**, ensuring coherence, accountability, and institutional convergence across the region.

A3.1 – Governance Architecture and Mandate of the Technical Committee

This activity establishes the institutional framework for project governance and coordination between CBOI, member states, and partners. It defines the decision-making structure, roles, and validation procedures ensuring transparency, accountability, and effective regional cooperation.

Objectives
• Define the governance structure and decision pathways.
• Establish Technical Committees in each island territory (national level) with focal points, feeding into the Regional Technical Committee coordinated by CBOI. (composition, mandate, procedures).
• Clarify roles and responsibilities of CBOI, national ministries, and experts.
• Formalise coordination, validation, and quality-assurance protocols.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

The governance system will be designed using a multi-level approach adapted to regional coordination.

Main steps:

- **Institutional review:** Analyse existing CBOI and AFD coordination mechanisms to capitalise on operational structures (steering units, technical secretariats).
- **Governance structure:** Define three tiers—strategic (AFD), regional (CBOI), national (focal points)—represented in an institutional organigram.
- **Technical Committee setup:** Specify composition (one representative per member state, thematic experts, donor observers), meeting frequency, and validation functions.
- **Operating rules:** Develop simplified internal regulations covering decision-making, voting, validation timelines, and documentation standards.
- **Coordination and quality protocol:** Draft a coordination manual detailing communication flows, document formats, validation matrices, and review schedules, aligned with the World Bank ESF principles of transparency and accountability.
- **Validation:** Submit the governance manual and committee mandate for regional workshop approval and publication on the collaborative platform.

This activity delivers a functional and transparent governance system that ensures collective validation and consistent management of all project phases.

A3.2 – Establishment of a Regional Collaborative Communication Tool

Our consortium will facilitate the **selection and setup of an existing collaborative communication tool** (such as *Slack*, *Microsoft Teams*, or *Mattermost*) to support coordination, information sharing, and teamwork across CBOI member states. The selection process will be **participatory**, allowing CBOI, national focal points, and key stakeholders to jointly decide on the most appropriate solution according to accessibility, usability, and institutional preferences.

Objectives
• Enable real-time communication and coordination among CBOI, national teams, and partners.
• Provide a shared and user-friendly space for documents, calendars, and meeting notes.
• Ensure bilingual accessibility (English/French) and inclusiveness across island territories.
• Promote long-term collaboration through a simple, low-maintenance solution.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

• **Participatory selection of the tool** – During the inception phase, the consortium will facilitate a short comparative review of potential platforms (e.g. Slack, Microsoft Teams, Mattermost). Stakeholders will assess each option based on criteria such as accessibility, data security, familiarity, and compatibility with existing institutional systems. The final choice will be validated by the Regional Technical Committee.
• **Configuration and workspace setup** – Once selected, the tool will be structured into thematic channels (governance, diagnostics, training, financing, communication) with a shared repository for key documents, calendars, and deliverables.
• **User orientation and onboarding** – A short online session (approximately one hour) will be conducted to familiarise users with the chosen tool's main features — file sharing, discussion threads, virtual meetings, and notifications — ensuring smooth and inclusive participation.
• **Operation and moderation** – The CBOI team will act as workspace administrator, ensuring proper moderation, regular updates, and consistent communication flow among project participants.
• **Sustainability and continuity** – The collaborative tool will remain active after the completion of the technical assistance, serving as a permanent coordination and knowledge-sharing space for the Blue Tourism Cluster, without requiring additional development or maintenance costs.

The outcome is an operational, stakeholder-endorsed collaborative workspace ensuring continuous, transparent, and inclusive communication throughout the implementation of the Blue Tourism initiative.

A3.3 – Validation Protocols and Quality Management of Deliverables

This activity establishes a quality assurance and validation system to guarantee the technical, institutional, and contractual compliance of all project outputs. It ensures traceability, consistency, and transparency throughout the production and review process.

Objectives
• Define procedures for review, validation, and archiving of all deliverables.
• Create a validation matrix detailing responsibilities and timelines.
• Ensure technical, linguistic, and institutional conformity of outputs.
• Integrate document management and traceability within the online platform.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Validation framework:** Implement a two-level process — technical validation by experts and institutional validation by CBOI — based on ToR quality criteria (analytical accuracy, alignment, operational relevance).
- **Validation matrix:** Specify for each deliverable the producer, technical reviewer, institutional validator, and review deadlines (10–15 working days).
- **Quality control manual:** Define requirements for structure, style, references, figures, and terminology, ensuring alignment with AFD–CBOI standards.
- **Document management system:** Use the regional platform for version tracking, modification logs, and secure archiving of validated reports.
- **Continuous improvement:** Hold quarterly quality reviews with CBOI and the Technical Committee to refine processes and incorporate feedback.

This activity delivers a standardised, traceable validation process that ensures the credibility, coherence, and usability of all project deliverables.

Summary Table of Deliverables – Phase 3: Governance and Collaborative Platform

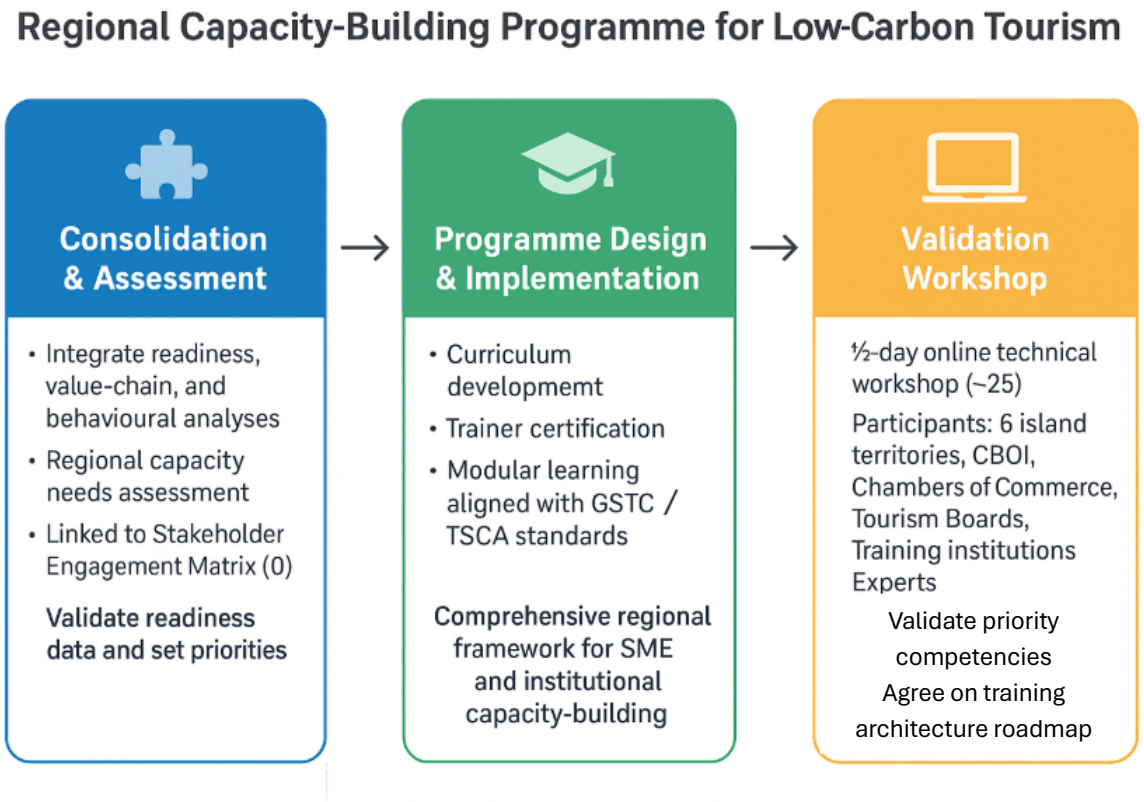
Phase	Main Deliverables	Outputs	Timeline
Phase 3 – Governance & Collaborative Platform	• Governance Manual & Committee Mandate • Operational Digital Platform (website + dashboard) • Quality Manual & Validation Matrix	• Regional governance organigram • Internal regulations of the Technical Committee • Multilingual collaborative platform (EN/FR) • Document management & validation-tracking system	**Month 5**

PHASE 4 — Capacity Building and Monitoring & Evaluation (SO4 – Capacity Building)

The phase **Capacity Building and Monitoring & Evaluation** converts strategy into **tangible capacity development**, providing training, tools, and monitoring systems to empower local institutions, enterprises, and communities to adopt sustainable blue tourism practices. It builds on readiness analyses (Phase 0), diagnostics (Phase 1–2), and stakeholder mapping to deliver a coordinated regional training and mentoring programme supported by an integrated M&E system.

A4.1 – Assessment, Design and implementation of the Regional Capacity-Building and training programme for Tourism SMEs

This activity consolidates previous readiness, value-chain, and behavioural analyses into a single regional programme for developing the capacities of tourism SMEs and institutions to adopt low-carbon, circular, and regenerative practices.



It begins with a regional capacity needs assessment, directly linked to the Stakeholders' Engagement Matrix (Phase 0), to identify gaps in skills, knowledge, and institutional capacity across public, private, and community actors. The assessment will update and validate the readiness data, providing a quantified basis for prioritising training themes and selecting participants for the regional programme.

It then proceeds to the design and implementation of the capacity-building programme, combining curriculum development, trainer certification, and modular learning delivery aligned with GSTC or TSCA standards.

A half-day online technical workshop will bring together around 25 representatives from the six island territories (CBOI, chambers of commerce, tourism boards, training institutions, and experts). This session will validate the priority competencies to be addressed and finalise the architecture of the regional training framework and delivery schedule.

Objectives		
• Translate diagnostics (Phases 1–2) into a practical regional training and mentoring framework (Identify and prioritise capacity gaps using readiness and stakeholder data).		
• Develop modular training content across three progressive levels: *awareness, operational practice, and innovation:*		
Step 1 – Awareness: Popularise sustainability principles through short e-learning and outreach.	*Step 2 – Operational Improvement:* Provide self-assessment and improvement tools for incremental adoption.	*Step 3 – Certification:* Prepare enterprises for GSTC or equivalent recognition.
• Establish a regional Training-of-Trainers (ToT) network and bilingual (EN/FR) online learning platform.		
• Support gradual compliance with GSTC / TSCA and regenerative-tourism standards.		

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Capacity Needs Assessment:** Consolidate readiness findings and conduct targeted consultations with key stakeholders from the engagement matrix to prioritise technical and managerial capacity gaps.

- **Programme Design:** Synthesise existing findings (both from assessment and online workshop) to identify priority competencies (energy efficiency, waste reduction, circular supply chains, inclusive governance, digital sustainability marketing).

- **Curriculum Development:** Three bilingual (EN/FR) modules will be produced, structured around the four GSTC or TSCA pillars: awareness, operational practice, and certification readiness. The material will include presentations, short videos, and practical worksheets representing approximately 36–45 hours of flexible learning accessible through the CBOI online platform.

- **Training of Trainers:** Identify 2–3 national trainers (already with good knowledge of selected topics) per country (including using the readiness assessment), conduct ToT sessions, and deploy blended (online with short sessions + in-person) workshops. NB: It is assumed that these champions have already been identified and are available; if not, the Training of Trainers will be addressed to our local counterparts (LCs), who will then deliver the trainings to the local stakeholders.

The ToT programme will be delivered entirely online through a **series of six 1–2 hour virtual sessions** spread over three weeks, combining expert demonstrations, peer group work, and mentored practice on topics such as energy efficiency, waste reduction, circular supply chains, inclusive governance, and digital sustainability marketing. Participants will complete applied exercises using case studies and receive personalised feedback to ensure they can confidently deliver SME workshops in their respective territories.

- **Roll-out:** National trainers deliver SME workshops locally, supported by digital modules and self-assessment tools integrated with the M&E system.

- National trainers will deliver training cycles to **15–20 tourism SMEs per country – based on identified blue tourism clusters -** (90–120 in total), ensuring broad coverage across key subsectors such as accommodation, food services, and marine or community-based tourism. Participants should include representatives from tourism industry associations, relevant public sector institutions, and selected members of academia that will be validated by the technical committee.
  Each cycle will include **four 1.5-hour hybrid sessions**, combining demonstrations, group exercises, and practical assignments focused on sustainability diagnostics, operational improvements, and digital marketing for low-carbon operations.. One in-person training workshop will be delivered in each territory. Cap Business will engage with the Chambers of Commerce in each territory to explore the possibility of securing venues free of charge. Otherwise, IOS Partners will cover venue rental and light refreshments. Participants will complete self-assessments and develop individual sustainability action plans, with progress tracked through the regional M&E dashboard.

- **Follow-Up:** Apply participant self-evaluation and 12-month follow-up to track behavioural and operational changes.

This activity will run concurrently with A4.2 to ensure that performance indicators and self-assessment tools are integrated into training design from the outset. Trainers and participating institutions will contribute to the definition of metrics and data collection methods to ensure full alignment between learning outcomes and the regional M&E system.

A4.2 – Co-Development of the Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Toolkit

Building directly on the outcomes of the **regional capacity needs assessment** (A4.1) and the **Stakeholders' Engagement Matrix**, this activity develops a regional Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) system in parallel with the capacity building programme to ensure training modules, institutional mentoring and enterprise engagement are all measured consistently. The toolkit will track both **capacity outcomes** (skills, knowledge, and institutional strengthening) and impact outcomes (behavioural and operational changes). It ensures harmonised data collection, reporting, and learning across CBOI member states.

Objectives
• Define a common framework of sustainability and training performance indicators.
• Integrate monitoring and self-assessment tools within the training curriculum (A4.1).
• Develop a practical digital toolkit for data collection and reporting at enterprise and national level (M&E Dashboard).
• Enable continuous feedback and adaptive management for trainers and CBOI.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

i. **Joint Design with A4.1:** Collaborate with training designers to embed KPIs and self-assessment tools into each module (e.g., energy use, waste reduction, behavioural change metrics).
ii. **Indicator framework:** Select measurable indicators based on the UN Tourism *Measuring Sustainability Framework* and the World Bank *Results Framework*, covering four dimensions:
    - *Climate & Environment* – GHG emissions, energy, water, waste.
    - *Economy & Employment* – tourism GDP share, jobs, community revenues.
    - *Governance & Capacity* –trained enterprises, practices adopted.
    - *Inclusion & Society* – gender balance, youth training, community participation.
iii. **Toolkit & dashboard:** Develop a digital interface integrated into the CBOI platform for self-reporting and aggregate monitoring, allowing national focal points to input data and generate visual summaries (graphs, maps, trend lines).
iv. **Pilot & feedback loop:** Test in two countries (e.g. Mauritius, Madagascar) alongside TOT sessions to validate usability and consistency.
v. **Training for users:** Deliver short sessions for national focal points and CBOI staff; provide a visual manual and user guide.
vi. **Continuous improvement:** Establish an annual reporting cycle aligned with the Technical Committee's review meetings.

Timeline:
A4.1 and A4.2 will **start together (Month 4–5)**, with the M&E system piloted before full training rollout (Month 6–7).

A4.3 – The Move Event: a Regional Blue Tourism Knowledge & Networking Event

This activity convenes a **two-day regional event** bringing together **around 50 participants**, including tourism SMEs, local trainers, institutional representatives, and vocational and academic training agencies — to consolidate the outcomes of A4.1–A4.2. The Move event serves as both a **training milestone** and a **regional learning hub** to peer exchange among Indian Ocean territories engaged in sustainable and low-carbon tourism.

The event will be organised either in **Madagascar or Seychelles**, depending on the highest relevance and logistical feasibility at the time of implementation, while ensuring complementarity with other MOVE events previously held. Remote participation will be available through an **online hybrid format** to enable inclusion of actors unable to travel.

Objectives
• Strengthen peer learning and cooperation among SMEs, training institutions, and national tourism authorities.
• Provide advanced capacity-building sessions on blue economy, low-carbon transition, and GSTC-aligned eco-certification.
• Facilitate knowledge sharing between territories on climate adaptation, circular tourism practices, and inclusive business models from pilot enterprises and TOT participants.
• Present and validate results of the regional training (A4.1) and M&E toolkit (A4.2).
• Foster regional networking and partnerships to sustain the blue tourism transition.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Format:** Two-day hybrid (in-person + online) and plastic free event combining workshops, peer-learning sessions, and demonstrations of eco-tourism practices.
- **Participants:** Approximately 50 representatives from SMEs, local authorities, national tourism boards, training institutions, and regional organisations.
- **Content:**
  - Presentation of regional capacity-building outcomes and M&E findings.
  - Thematic sessions on low-carbon innovation, circular supply chains, and eco-certification.
  - Case studies from pilot enterprises and national trainers.
  - Networking and matchmaking for future collaboration and investment.
- **Venue Selection:** Either **Madagascar** or **Seychelles**, prioritising local eco-accommodation venues demonstrating sustainability in practice.
- **Hybrid Access:** Livestreamed plenary and interactive online workshops for remote participants from other CBOI member states.
- **Follow-Up:** Consolidation of event outcomes and participant feedback into the final **Capitalisation Report (A4.4)** and integration into the **CBOI digital library**.

Deliverables

- Regional event programme and participant list (around 50 participants).
- Workshop materials and presentations (EN/FR).
- Summary report including key outcomes, lessons, and recommendations.
- Recorded sessions uploaded to the regional platform.

Timeline
To be organised after completion of A4.1 and A4.2 pilot phase (around Month 7–8), before final capitalisation activities (A4.4).

A4.4 – Capitalisation and Knowledge Sharing

This activity ensures the collection, organisation, and dissemination of all knowledge, tools, and results produced during the project. It strengthens institutional learning and visibility while supporting the long-term sustainability of the blue-tourism transition.

Objectives
• Compile and structure all validated deliverables, tools, and lessons learned.
• Integrate lessons and data from the M&E system (A4.2) to guide future training updates and policy recommendations.
• Disseminate results through the regional platform and communication channels.
• Strengthen CBOI's capacity to maintain and update knowledge resources.
• Promote South–South exchange among member states and other coastal regions.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Compilation:** Gather all validated reports, studies, maps, training modules, and M&E tools in a final digital library organised by theme (governance, climate, finance, skills, certification).
- **Capitalisation report:** Summarise key achievements, lessons learned, innovations, and recommendations for replication, highlighting measurable results (**GHG reduction, enterprises trained, behavioural changes observed, and performance data from the M&E dashboard**).
- **Dissemination:** Publish materials on the CBOI platform with infographics, summaries, and case studies; organise a regional closing webinar presenting results to member states, private sector, and partners.
- **Networking:** Support CBOI in establishing a regional good-practices network linking trained institutions and pilot enterprises.
- **Sustainability:** Prepare a short transfer plan detailing procedures for annual updates of the platform, training modules, **and monitoring dashboard**, ensuring that results continue to inform capacity-building programmes.

The activity ensures long-term access to project outputs, fosters collective learning, and consolidates CBOI's role as regional knowledge hub for sustainable and low-carbon tourism.

Summary Table of Deliverables – Phase 4: Capacity Building and Monitoring & Evaluation

Phase	Main Deliverables	Outputs	Timeline
Phase 4 – Capacity Building & M&E	•Capacity needs assessment •Regional Capacity-Building & Training Framework (incl. ToT network & digital platform) • Digital M&E Dashboard + User Manual • Move regional event • Capitalisation & knowledge sharing • Report + Regional Webinar	• GSTC/TSCA -aligned modular curriculum (EN/FR) • Certified regional trainers per island and network map • Online learning platform structure • Integrated regional M&E dashboard •Two-day hybrid event; participant list; summary report; session recordings • Final capitalisation report & digital library	**Month 6**

PHASE 5 — Financing Strategy and Blue Investment Pipeline - (Mobilising Sustainable and Private Finance) (SO5 – Financing Strategy)

This phase anchors the initiative's financial sustainability by creating an integrated financing strategy and a pipeline of bankable blue projects to mobilize both public and private investments. While **the identification of investment opportunities begins in Phase 2**, through the validation of Blue Tourism Clusters and the analysis of low-carbon infrastructure and NbS potential, **Phase 5 structures these opportunities** into a coherent regional **financing and investment framework**.

Beyond project funding, this phase addresses mechanisms for funding the broader low-carbon transition of the blue tourism sector. It identifies opportunities for mobilising both public and private investments, exploring innovative financing models such as trust funds (e.g., Madagascar National Parks), blue bonds, carbon offset schemes, and blended finance instruments.

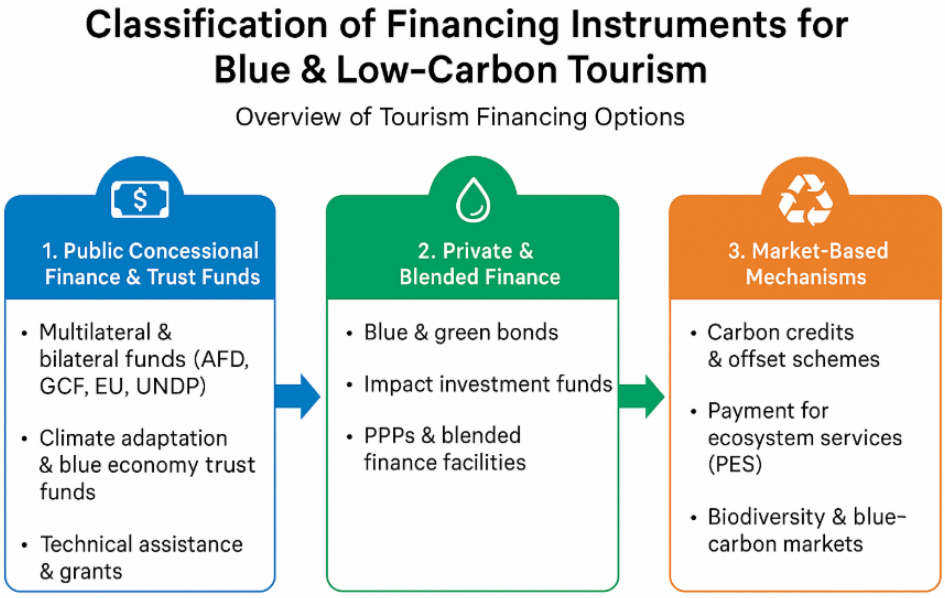
A5.1 – Mapping of Available Financial Instruments

This activity provides a comprehensive overview of financing sources and mechanisms accessible for sustainable and low-carbon blue-tourism projects in the Indian Ocean region. It identifies existing opportunities, eligibility criteria, and potential synergies to support the regional financing strategy.

Objectives
• Inventory public, private, bilateral, and multilateral financing sources.
• Identify instruments relevant to sustainable tourism: grants, concessional loans, PPPs, carbon mechanisms.
• Assess eligibility conditions and legal frameworks for each member state.
• Provide a consolidated financial reference base for the regional strategy (A5.2).

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Document review:** Compile financing instruments from development banks and donors (World Bank/IFC, AFD/Proparco, AfDB, GCF, GEF, EU Global Gateway, UNDP, Blue Action Fund).
- **Classification:** Organise by type:



- **Assessment:**
  - Analyse relevance per country using criteria such as accessibility, co-financing potential, administrative feasibility, and expected climate impact.
  - Analyse innovative financing models currently operating in the region — such as environmental trust funds, endowment mechanisms, or carbon offset markets — with lessons learned from the Madagascar National Parks Trust Fund and other conservation-finance examples.
- **Cross-checking:** Identify overlaps or synergies between ongoing regional programmes (AFD Blue Economy Initiative, WB Blue Finance Program).
- **Constraints and opportunities:** Note regulatory or financial barriers (sovereign guarantees, procurement rules, currency risks) and propose preliminary mitigation options.
- **Validation:** Present findings to CBOI and the Technical Committee as an interactive table and synthesis report.

The activity delivers a regional financial landscape highlighting the most viable instruments and entry points for investment in sustainable and low-carbon tourism. This mapping includes financing instruments for both programme implementation and the transition of private actors toward low-carbon models.

A5.2 – Development of the Regional Financing Strategy

This activity defines an integrated financial strategy to mobilise resources for sustainable and low-carbon blue-tourism initiatives in the Indian Ocean. It operationalises the priorities of the Regional Blueprint (Phase 2) by identifying mechanisms, governance, and coordination procedures for long-term financing.

Objectives
• Define strategic investment priorities and financing pillars.
• Define financing mechanisms to support both the implementation of the Blue Tourism Cluster roadmap and the mobilisation of private investment for low-carbon and regenerative infrastructure.
• Identify the most suitable instruments (grants, PPPs, carbon credits, blended finance).
• Establish a governance and accountability framework for fund management.
• Simplify access to regional and international funding sources.

The activity aims to achieve the following objectives:

- Define strategic investment priorities and financing pillars.

- Define financing mechanisms to support both the implementation of the Blue Tourism Cluster roadmap and the mobilisation of private investment for low-carbon and regenerative infrastructure.
- Identify the most suitable instruments (grants, PPPs, carbon credits, blended finance).
- Establish a governance and accountability framework for fund management.
- Simplify access to regional and international funding sources.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Structuring:** Build the strategy around three complementary levels —
    1. *Regional:* creation of a coordinated financing framework under CBOI.
    2. *National:* integration of sustainable-tourism projects in public-investment plans.
    3. *Local:* facilitation of access for SMEs through micro-credit or simplified grant windows.
- **Instrument selection:** Based on A5.1 results, select mechanisms adapted to island contexts (AFD, GCF, GEF, impact funds, blue/green bonds). Incorporate blended finance mechanisms, PPPs, and de-risking facilities to encourage private investment in renewable energy, eco-lodges, green mobility, and circular infrastructure identified under Phase 2.
- **Regional fund design:** Propose the establishment of a *Blue Tourism Fund* hosted by CBOI to pool resources, co-finance priority projects, and manage an "assistance window" for project preparation.
- **Governance:** Define oversight structure (steering committee including CBOI, donors, member states) and operating rules (selection criteria, auditing, reporting).
- **Validation:** Organise a regional workshop to review and adopt the strategy, including its vision, financing pillars, governance model, and 2026–2030 implementation calendar.

The financing strategy provides the financial architecture for the regional programme, ensuring predictable and coordinated investment flows for the blue-tourism transition. This financing architecture provides the foundation for the Blue Investment Pipeline and the investor engagement process described in A5.3.

A5.3 – Identification and Structuring of the Blue Investment Pipeline

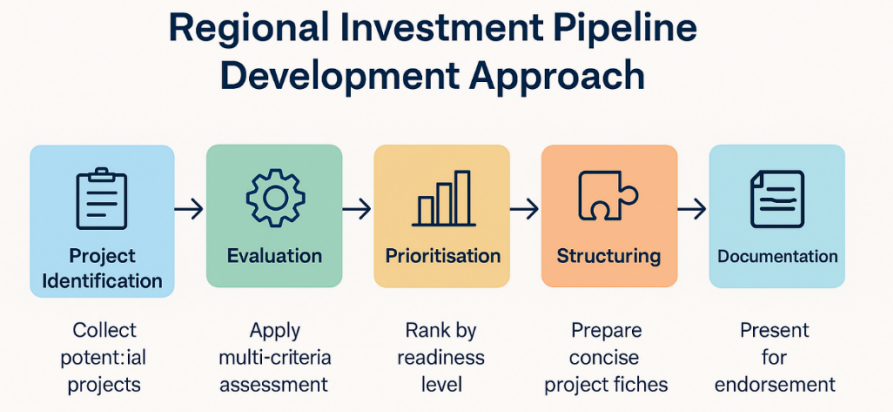
Building on the cluster-based investment priorities and financing strategy established in phase 2 and A5.2, **this activity develops a portfolio of bankable projects and investment profiles by country and theme**. It consolidates the investment opportunities pre-identified during the blue tourism cluster validation into a structured pipeline, **linking available funding sources with concrete low-carbon and sustainable-tourism initiatives across CBOI member states**. Each investment fiche will outline potential investors, financial mechanisms (grants, concessional loans, blended instruments), expected ROI, and sustainability outcomes.

Objectives
• Inventory public and private tourism projects with high environmental and economic impact.
• Assess their technical, institutional, and financial feasibility.
• Prioritise 10–15 projects ready or close to investment.
• Prepare standardised project fiches compatible with donor and investor requirements.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Project identification:** In coordination with CBOI and national ministries, collect potential projects from public institutions, private operators, and regional initiatives (AFD, WB, GCF).
- **Evaluation:** Apply a multi-criteria grid covering technical feasibility, socio-economic viability (employment, inclusion), GHG reduction potential, and innovation or replicability.
- **Prioritisation:** Classify projects into three phases — (1) immediate financing, (2) requiring additional technical assistance, and (3) emerging high-potential concepts.
- **Structuring:** For selected projects, prepare concise fiches including objectives, estimated costs, financing plan, expected impacts, risks, and key partners.
- **Documentation:** Develop investment briefs following international standards, summarising environmental justification, alignment with the Regional Blueprint, and potential financial structure (public, private, blended).

- **Validation:** Present the regional investment pipeline to the Technical Committee for endorsement and sharing with financial institutions and investors.



This activity produces a structured, ready-to-finance project portfolio that translates the regional strategy into concrete investment opportunities.

A5.4 – Development of Investment Tools and Regional Investment Forum

This activity produces standardised tools to help CBOI and member states promote their sustainable and low-carbon tourism projects to donors and investors. It translates technical and environmental arguments into clear, investment-ready communication materials.

Objectives
• Create harmonised templates for project presentation and funding proposals.
• Develop concise investment briefs and pitch decks adapted to different audiences.
• Strengthen CBOI and national capacities to present and negotiate projects.
• Support preparation for the *Blue Tourism Investment Forum*.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Template design:** Review formats used by major financiers (World Bank, IFC, AFD, GCF, Proparco) and develop three standard tools:
    1. *Project fiche* (2 pages) – summary, budget, expected impacts, indicators.
    2. *Investment brief* (4–6 pages) – financial structure, partners, risk profile.
    3. *Pitch deck* (10–12 slides) – key facts, value proposition, climate benefits.
- **Content adaptation:** Tailor formats to three target groups — (1) public donors (impact and governance focus), (2) private investors (returns and guarantees), (3) PPP stakeholders (risk-sharing and sustainability).
- **Graphic and narrative production:** Design visual templates consistent with CBOI branding, including strategic alignment box (CBOI–SDG link), impact sheet (emission reduction, community benefits), and investment section (amount, partners, expected return).
- **Capacity building:** Train CBOI and national representatives to use the tools, prepare investment presentations, and update project briefs.
- **Integration:** Upload editable versions (Word, PowerPoint) and a short investor-communication guide onto the regional platform for future use.
- Prepare a regional pitch deck and organise a Blue Tourism Investment Forum, bringing together public and private investors, donors, and member states to showcase the investment pipeline and selected bankable projects.

The activity equips the region with professional, reusable investment tools that enhance visibility, credibility, and access to sustainable-finance opportunities.

Summary Table of Deliverables – Phase 5: Financing Strategy and Blue Investment Pipeline

Phase	Main Deliverables	Outputs	Timeline
Phase 5 – Financing Strategy & Investment Pipeline	• Financial Mapping Report • Regional Financing Strategy Document • Investment Pipeline Report + Database• Financial Communication Guide • Blue tourism investment forum & regional Pitch Decks	• Database of financial instruments + bankable projects • Governance model for Regional Blue Tourism Fund • Financial-flow & co-financing schemes • Full investor-communication toolkit	**Month 7**

PHASE 6 — Digital Branding, Certification, and Communication (SO6 – Indian Ocean Blue Tourism Brand)

Branding, Certification, and Regional Communication ensures visibility, credibility, and long-term recognition, through a regional brand, sustainability certification label, and coherent communication strategy, positioning the Indian Ocean as a global reference for low-carbon blue tourism. However, in the current tourism landscape, destination branding depends less on top-down campaigns and **more on the credibility of user-generated stories**. The Indian Ocean Blue Tourism initiative therefore focuses on **creating a shared digital narrative** rather than a traditional logo-driven brand, positioning the region through authentic, data-backed, community-centred communication.

A6.1 – Development of a Shared Narrative and Digital Brand Ecosystem

This activity builds a collaborative digital brand ecosystem to position the Indian Ocean as a leading destination for sustainable and climate-positive tourism. The brand unifies the communication of CBOI member states, strengthens regional competitiveness, and enhances international visibility.

Objectives
• Design a common brand reflecting sustainability, inclusion, and decarbonisation values.
• Define the brand's positioning, promise, and target audiences.
• Develop a shared narrative and visual-digital toolkit enabling storytelling consistency across platforms.
• Prepare for the coordinated regional and international launch of the brand under CBOI leadership.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Benchmark and positioning:**
  - Analyse existing national and sectoral brands to identify overlaps and opportunities.
  - Benchmark the region's current digital reputation and analyse online narratives around blue tourism.
- **Co-creation workshop:**
  - Hold virtual co-creations with tourism offices, ministries, associations, and private/community actors to identify key themes, audiences, and stories that express each island's blue-tourism identity.
  - Consolidate insights into two regional brand proposals, present them through the CBOI platform, and invite stakeholders to vote online during a validation period before refining the selected concept through a short regional lab.
- **Design and production:**
  - Develop a light, adaptable visual toolkit for online and community use, along with multilingual narrative elements and storytelling templates.
  - Create digital engagement guidelines (hashtags, tone, visual codes) to unify user-generated content under the regional brand.
- **Communication toolkit:** Produce standard templates — brochures, event banners, digital and social-media materials — accessible to all members via the CBOI platform.
- **Monitoring and evaluation**
  - Set up a social-listening dashboard to monitor engagement, sentiment, and visibility.

- Prepare materials and guidelines for coordinated regional launch and online activation.

The activity delivers a collaborative digital brand ecosystem combining a shared narrative, adaptable visual toolkit, and guidelines for user-generated storytelling. Rather than a fixed logo or slogan, the brand lives through authentic content produced by travellers, enterprises, and communities, positioning the Indian Ocean as a leading region for sustainable and regenerative blue tourism.

A6.2 – Establishment of the Regional Blue Tourism Label Framework

This activity develops a regional **Blue Tourism Label** as a medium- to long-term recognition system for tourism operators and destinations that embody the principles of sustainability, inclusion, and the Blue Economy.

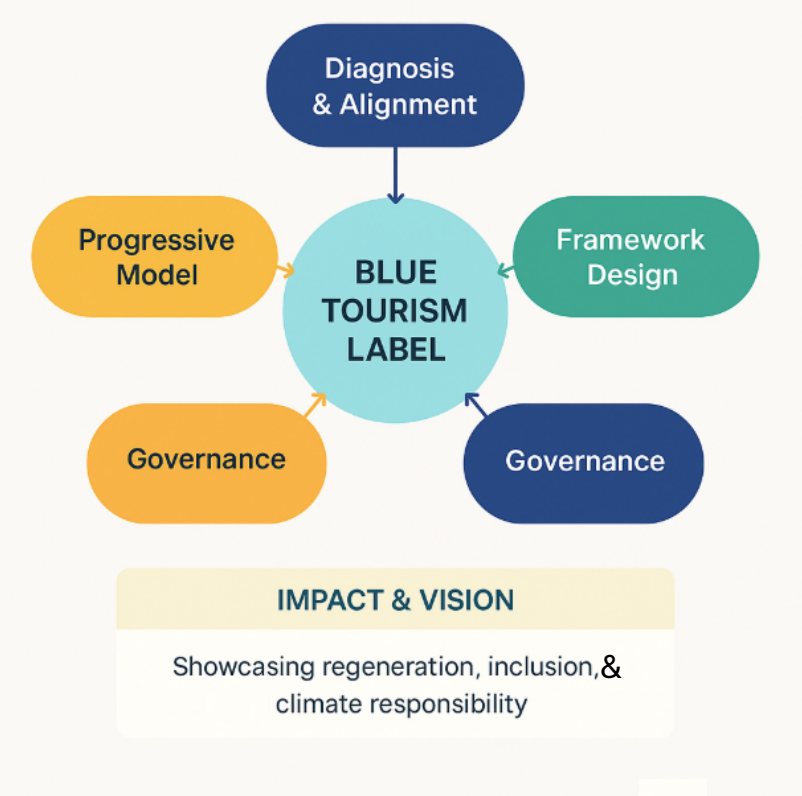
Rather than a formal certification mechanism, the label serves as a **progressive recognition pathway** encouraging tourism actors to integrate climate-resilient, low-carbon, and regenerative practices into their business models.

It strengthens the visibility and credibility of sustainable tourism across the Indian Ocean region while promoting responsible entrepreneurship.

Objectives
• Create a regional Blue Tourism Label recognizing sustainable practices and alignment with Blue Economy values.
• Define governance, eligibility criteria, and recognition levels (enterprises, destinations, community projects).
• Integrate flexibility for MSMEs through a stepwise improvement approach.
• Ensure interoperability with international and European certification frameworks (GSTC, TSCA, Travelife, Green Globe, EU Ecolabel).

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Diagnosis and alignment:** Review existing labels and certification schemes in member states and Europe (e.g., Green Globe, Travelife, ATR, EU Ecolabel) to identify convergence points and good practices.
- **Framework design:** Structure the blue tourism label around four pillars
  - sustainable management, inclusion and innovation
  - socio-economic inclusion and decent work
  - cultural and natural heritage conservation,
  - Climate and environmental performance (energy, water, waste, GHG reduction).
- **Progressive model:** Define three recognition levels — *Engaged*, *Advanced*, *Leader* — corresponding to progressive adoption of sustainable practices and measurable outcomes.
- **Governance and management:** Establish a regional coordination committee under CBOI with national focal points to manage labelling applications, communication, and data reporting.
- **Pilot testing:** Test the label in two countries (e.g., Mauritius and Madagascar) with different types of operators (SME and destination).
- **Visibility and promotion:** Integrate the label into the regional brand (A6.1) and communication strategy (A6.3) as a key identifier of sustainable enterprises and destinations.



The Blue Tourism Label becomes a **regional signature of sustainable excellence**, showcasing tourism actors committed to regeneration, inclusion, and climate responsibility. It acts as an **accessible stepping-stone** toward international recognition (GSTC, TSCA, etc.) while anchoring the region's Blue Economy narrative in tangible, verifiable action.

A6.3 – Regional Communication and Digital Marketing Strategy

This activity defines a joint communication and promotion strategy for the *Indian Ocean Blue Tourism* brand and the blue tourism label, ensuring consistent messaging, enhances visibility of results, and regional and international positioning. Rather than focusing solely on institutional visibility, the strategy aims to **amplify authentic stories** of change — enterprises, communities, and destinations embracing sustainability and the values of the Blue Economy.

Objectives
• Develop a coherent regional communication plan for the blue tourism label and brand.
• Promote the values of sustainability, innovation, and inclusion through authentic storytelling.
• Highlight project results, success stories and measurable impacts (economic, social and environmental.
• Strengthen the digital presence of CBOI and member states through coordinated online platforms and campaigns.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Diagnostic and planning:**
  - Map existing communication channels and practices of national tourism bodies and ministries
  - Identify synergies, content gaps and key narratives to unify under the blue tourism label.
- **Narrrative Strategy and content design:**
  - Define the storytelling framework linking the regional brand (A6.1) and Label (A6.2)
  - Create modular story templates highlighting labelled operators, communities, and destinations.
  - Develop bilingual (EN/FR) content guidelines promoting regenerative values and user-generated content (UGC).
- **Digital marketing ecosystem**

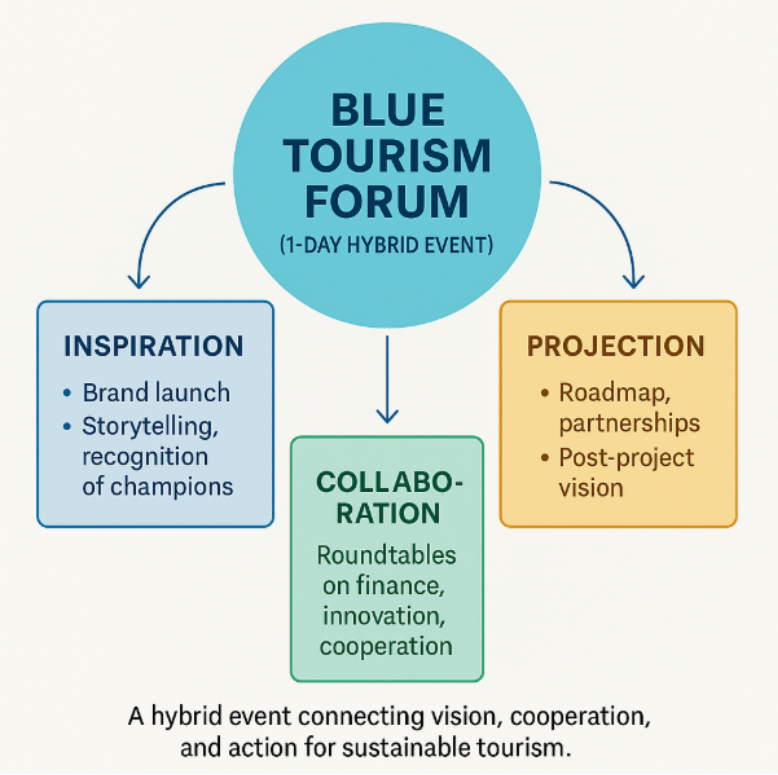
  - Integrate the Blue Tourism Label into the CBOI platform, with a searchable directory and interactive map of labelled actors.
  - Use digital storytelling tools (videos, infographics, impact dashboards) to showcase label achievements.
  - Launch coordinated campaigns using hashtags and community engagement challenges (#BlueTourismIndianOcean, #BlueIsTheNewGreen).
- **Visibility and partnership promotion:**
  - Engage influencers, media, and tour operators to feature labelled experiences.
  - Promote partnerships with regional airlines, OTAs, and investors through co-branded visibility packages.
  - Organise virtual "Blue Tourism Days" to present updates, share innovations, and attract collaboration.
- **Monitoring and evaluation:**
  - Integrate communication performance indicators (reach, engagement, sentiment) into the project's M&E dashboard (Phase 4).
  - Adjust content and audience targeting based on real-time analytics and social listening data.

The communication and digital marketing strategy positions the **Blue Tourism Label** as a dynamic regional movement rather than a static certification. By combining authentic storytelling, digital visibility, and measurable impact, it builds collective ownership of the Blue Tourism identity — both within the region and across international markets.

A6.4 – Regional Launch Forum for the Blue Tourism label and Brand

This activity represents the official launch and validation of the *Indian Ocean Blue Tourism* Label and brand, marking the culmination of the project, and the start of its long-term operational phase.

Rather than a traditional presentation event, the forum acts as a **regional showcase and marketplace** — combining institutional validation, storytelling, networking, and investment dialogue around sustainable blue tourism. It celebrates the transformation journey of participating enterprises, destinations, and institutions, while mobilising partners for the next phase of collaboration and financing.



A hybrid event connecting vision, cooperation, and action for sustainable tourism.

Objectives
• Validate and officially launch the Indian Ocean Blue Tourism Label and shared brand narrative.
• Present project achievements, key lessons and success stories from "pioneer" enterprises and destinations engaged in sustainable blue tourism initiatives.
• Mobilise member states, private sector, donors, and media to sustain the blue tourism movement.
• Foster partnerships and investments supporting low-carbon, inclusive, and regenerative tourism.

Our consortium will implement the following approach:

- **Event design:**
  - Organize a one-day hybrid "Blue Tourism Forum" combining high level institutional sessions, technical panels and public visibility activities.
  - Structure the event around three segments
    i. *Inspiration* – Launch of the brand and label, storytelling of regional champions, and recognition of pilot enterprises.
    ii. *Collaboration* – Roundtables on financing, innovation, and regional cooperation (linked with Phase 5 outputs).
    iii. *Projection* – Presentation of the post-project roadmap and new partnership opportunities.
- **Sustainability of the Forum:** The event will adopt **eco-responsible practices** consistent with Blue Tourism principles — including plastic-free logistics, local and seasonal catering, reduced paper use, and carbon-conscious transport options. Local artisans, community groups, and sustainable tourism operators will be engaged in logistics, showcasing regional know-how and promoting short supply chains.
- **Programme:**
  - opening ceremony (CBOI, AFD, member states),
  - presentation of the blue tourism label framework and first pioneer enterprises and destinations
  - Exhibition space and networking for pioneer enterprises and investors.
  - Session on *Blue Economy financing mechanisms* and trust fund models (linking with A5.1–A5.3).
  - Interactive showcase of the new digital brand platform (A6.1–A6.3).
- **Communication materials:**
  - Produce a visually engaging "Blue Tourism Journey Book" summarising project milestones, results and impact indicators ((GHG reduction, enterprises engaged, communities reached)
  - Develop visual assets (videos, banners, videos, press kits, social media reels), for the event and post-event dissemination.
- **Participation and networking:**
  - Invite representatives from member states, donors (WB, AFD, GCF, EU), tourism associations, certified operators, and regional/international media.
  - Create networking spaces for B2B and B2G exchanges to identify investment and partnership opportunities.
- **Follow-up and sustainability:**
  - Publish a **post-forum roadmap and partnership declaration** summarising institutional commitments.
  - Establish a **Blue Tourism Network** to maintain collaboration among labelled enterprises, national focal points, and regional partners beyond the project.

The **Regional Blue Tourism Forum** marks the transition from technical assistance to long-term ownership of the Blue Tourism movement.
It consolidates the brand and label as living symbols of sustainable transformation, celebrates champions of regenerative tourism, and mobilises partners for continued action and investment across the Indian Ocean region.

Summary Table of Deliverables – Phase 6: Branding, Blue Tourism Label, and Regional Communication

Phase	Main Deliverables	Outputs	Timeline
Phase 6 – Branding, Certification & Communication	• Shared narrative and digital brand ecosystem "Indian Ocean Blue Tourism"	• Adopted regional brand & blue tourism label identity	**Month 8**

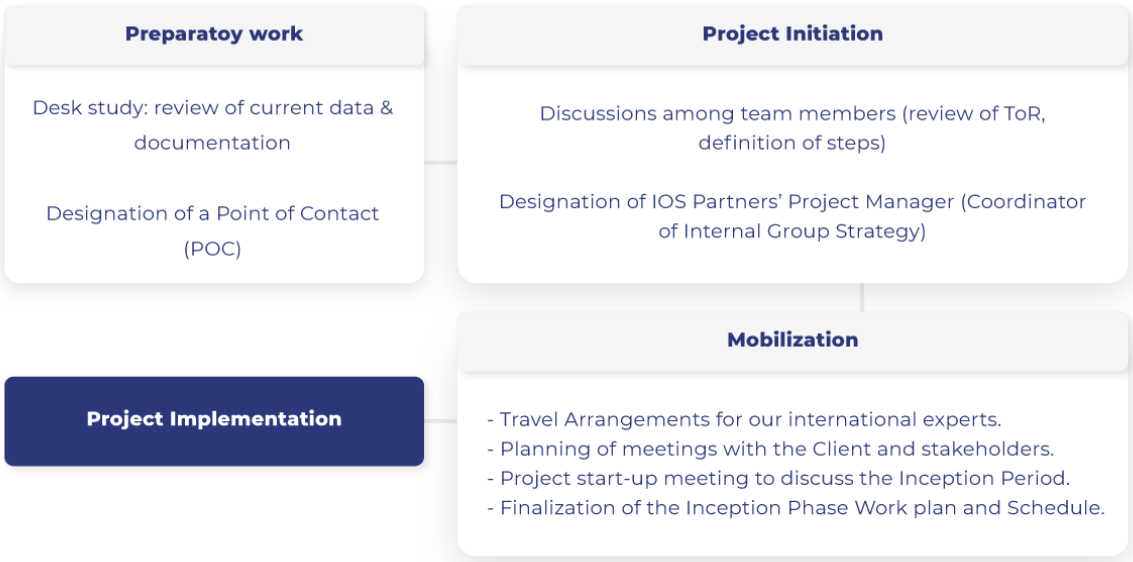
• Regional blue tourism label Framework and guidelines • Regional Communication and digital marketing Strategy • Regional Blue Tourism Forum (launch and networking events)	• Coordinated regional communication tools and digital story telling platform • Post-TA continuity plan for brand, label and partnerships • Sustainable, plastic free, locally sourced forum model showcasing blue tourism values	

c) Work Plan

This section presents the **project work plan** and **IOS Partners' project management procedures**. In order to ensure the timely execution of the project and the optimal use of consultant resources, we propose the implementation of the following measures:

a. Project launch

Before the actual start, we will draw up a **list of specific data and documents** required for the assessment and review of the various aspects of the mission.
This list will be sent by email, accompanied by a **proposed schedule of meetings with the relevant authorities** and visits to stakeholders, including **field visits**, and addressed to the designated point of contact (POC).



Project Launch

Keys to success for the project launch:

(i) **Close communication and cooperation with the Task Force**: we will contact the relevant counterparts as soon as the contract is signed in order to quickly implement an effective start-up phase during the **inception phase**.

(ii) **Ensuring the quality of the data collected**: as soon as the contract is awarded and during negotiations, IOS Partners will prepare a comprehensive data request, which will be sent to our local partners and collaborators in order to quickly begin collecting the relevant additional information.

b. Project implementation

- **Frequent project team meetings** to identify potential difficulties and share results, contacts and data.
- Any difficulties encountered will be communicated **to the client without delay** via the team leader and project manager.
- **Regular meetings with the client** will allow us to present and validate the results of the analyses and recommendations.

We believe that these meetings will facilitate **efficient and rapid** progress on all tasks and activities planned as part of the assignment.

c. Material and logistical resources

- **ATP equipment and team**
  - High-performance laptop + high-speed internet connection.
  - Printer and standard consumables.
  - Mobile phone with data for off-site travel.
- **Office & infrastructure**
  - Dedicated office provided by the MDE with secure internet access.
  - Equipped meeting room (projector, videoconferencing).
- **Inter-island and field travel**
  - Estimate: 20 missions (120 days) on Grande Comore, Anjouan, Mohéli.
  - Air tickets, daily allowances, vehicle rental, accommodation.
  - Coordination with the MDE for local logistics (transfers, hotels).

d. Reporting/monitoring

At each stage of the project, we will produce and submit several reports presenting the results of the activities carried out as part of the consultancy assignment. These milestones are detailed in the section Deliverable at the end of the TOR as well as in our methodology.

In addition to these milestones, and in order to **monitor technical activities and project management**, we will also submit **quarterly progress reports**, which will include:

- A **detailed schedule** of all aspects of the project, updated every three months in a format accessible to stakeholders.
- A **detailed budget forecast** updated every three months.
- A project **progress monitoring note**, including risk identification and proposed mitigation measures.
- A **training progress report**, with an assessment and proposals.

At the end of each month, a **meeting will be held with the Chargée de Mission Blue Economy, Sustainable Tourism, Maritime Connectivity, Ms. Nawshin Mahadooa** to share information, adjust the work plan and ensure that no essential aspects are overlooked.

The *reporting* activity will address the following elements:

Achievement of intended results	Relevance and appropriateness of objectives and costs	Overall assessment and working environment	Client engagement	Responsibility for specific aspects of the mandate
All of our team members will be available	Communications	Adherence to Work Plan	Adherence to Budget	Quality Assurance

Reporting

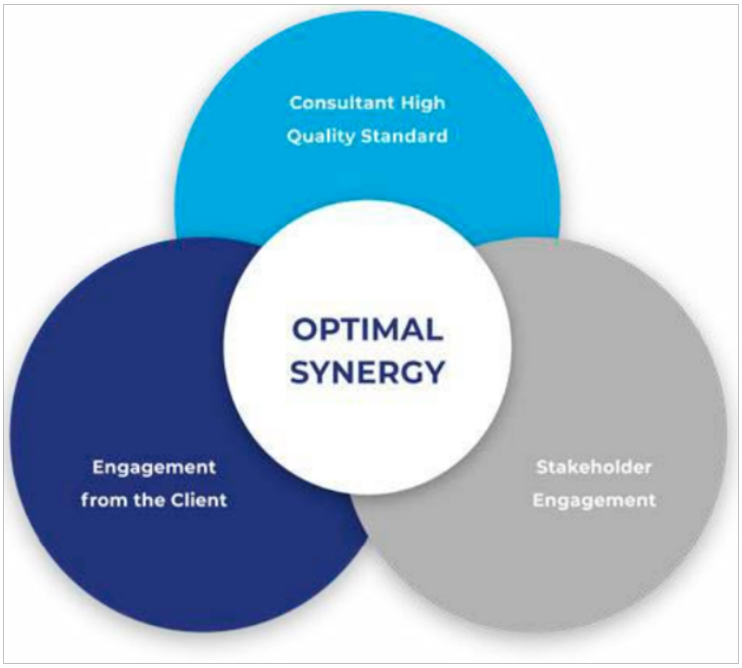
The pillars of our management approach to ensure effectiveness:

(i) **Rigorous planning and regular monitoring** to promote problem solving and maintain focus on the technical aspects of the project;
(ii) **Clear lines of communication and accountability**, avoiding duplication or confusion;
(iii) **The use of standardised templates, checklists and procedures**, ensuring comprehensive coverage of tasks and avoiding "reinventing the wheel".

In addition to our internal quality assurance system, we are pleased to note that IOS Partners implements a **two-tier quality management system**: a **strategic (corporate) level** and an **operational (project) level**.
At each level, the company's quality programme is based on the requirements of the **international ISO 9000 standard**.

e. Schedule, sequencing of proposed tasks and risk management

Adherence to the schedule and task sequencing is essential to achieving the mission's objectives. Our team has developed a **work plan based on the indicative schedule in the TOR**, taking into account several factors and adding the details necessary for effective implementation.



Creating synergies to ensure an optimised schedule and sequencing

We understand that the consulting assignment must be completed **within 8 months** of the contract being signed.
We are committed to meeting deadlines and acting effectively to achieve the objectives set, within the envisaged timeframe and budget.

Nevertheless, it is essential to adopt a **realistic implementation schedule**, taking into account the potential challenges of the project, such as:

- **Mobilising and securing stakeholder buy-in** for the planned activities;
- The **finalisation of additional studies**;
- **Possible delays or extensions in tendering procedures and calls for projects**;

From the outset of the project, our team will implement the first steps of our **integrated risk management process** by:

(i) clearly identifying all risks;
(ii) classifying them according to their probability and impact (low, medium, high);
(iii) proposing appropriate mitigation strategies.



Integrated risk management procedure

Deliverables and Timetable

The IOS Partners team will follow the **timetable below** for the submission of final documents. **Form TECH-3 – Work Schedule and Deliverables Plan** will describe in detail the general breakdown of project activities as presented in the Terms of Reference (TOR), according to the different **phases, expected results and deliverables**.

***NB**: The exact dates will be finalized during the kick-off meeting and included in a shared follow-up calendar (collaborative tool).*

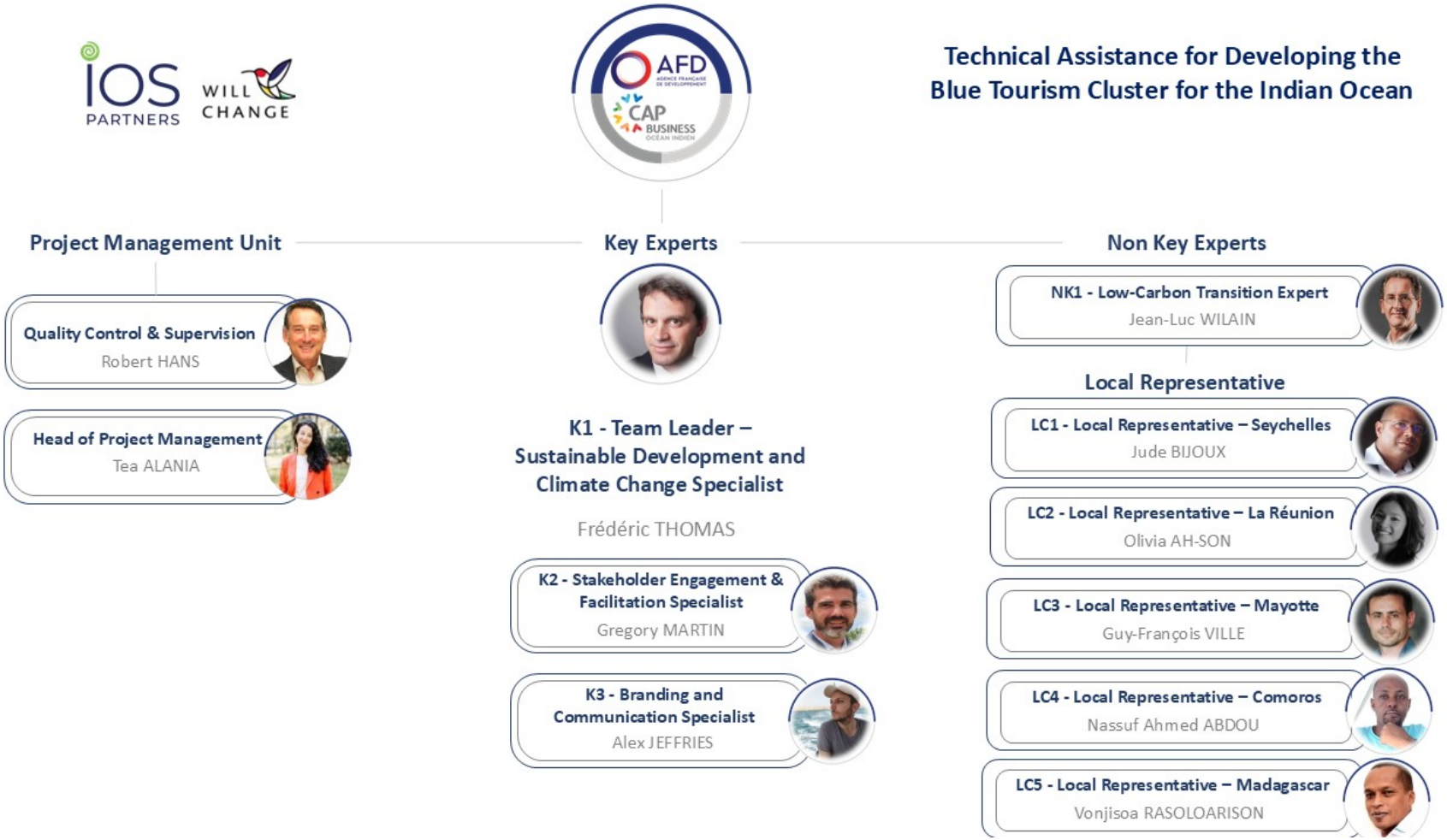
Key Expert 1 (K1): Frederic Thomas - Team Leader / Sustainable development, Climate Change Specialist	**K2: Gregory Martin - Stakeholder Engagement and Facilitation Specialist**	**K3: Alex Jeffries - Branding and Communication Specialist**	**Non Key Expert 1 (NK1): Jean-Luc Wilain - Low carbon strategy Specialist**	
Local Counterpart (LC) Seychelles: Jude Bijoux	**LC La Réunion - Olivia Ah-Son**	**LC Mayotte - François Guy Ville**	**LC Comores - Nassuf Abdou Ahmed**	**LC Madagascar - Vonjy Rasoloarison**

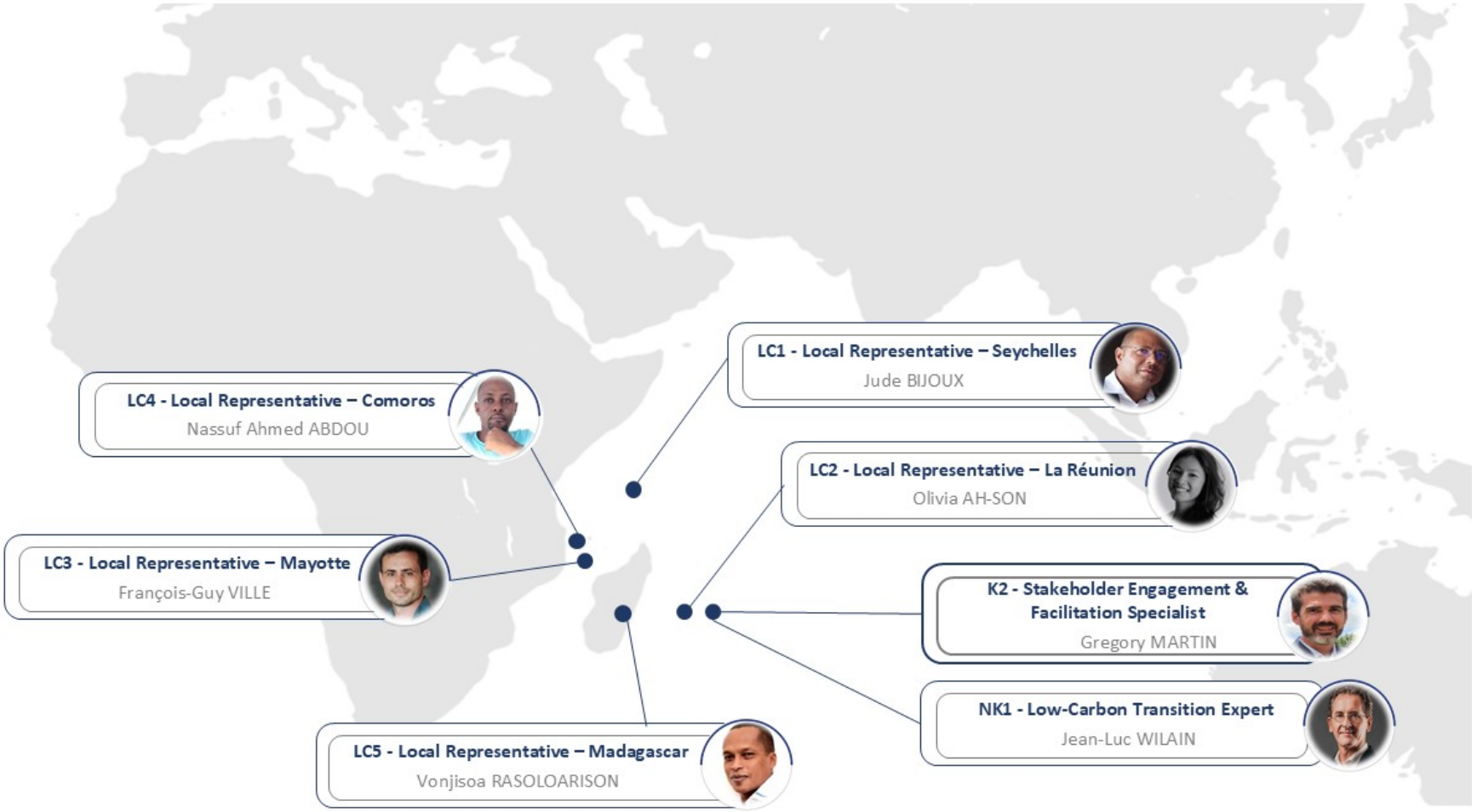
Activity	Expert in charge	Duration of activity	Corresponding deliverable / workshop	Deliverable due date. (W - week)	Timeframe for PMU validation of deliverables
PHASE 0 – Launching & Initial Mobilisation (SO3 – Stakeholder Engagement)					
A0.1 – Launch Mission and Institutional Framework Setup		1 week			
A0.2 – Stakeholder Mapping, Readiness and Engagement Plan		3 weeks			
A0.3 – Launching Mission Report		1 week	D1	Month 1 (W3)	2 weeks
PHASE 1 — Diagnostic and Baseline Analysis (SO1 – Literature Review Report)					
A1.1 – Literature Review and Policy Framework Mapping		2 weeks	D2	Month 2 (W6)	2 weeks
A1.2 – Data Diagnostic and Gap Analysis		2 weeks			
A1.3 – Spatial Differentiation: Urban vs. Rural Tourism Systems		2 weeks			
A1.4 – Strategic Carbon Diagnostic and Low-Carbon Positioning		2 weeks			
PHASE 2 — Regional Framework and Three-Year Action Plan (2026–2029) – (SO2 – Blue Tourism Cluster Development Plan)					
A2.1 – Policy, Regulatory, Institutional and climate adaptation Benchmark		1 week			
A2.2 – Blue Tourism Value Chain and Emission Source Analysis		2 weeks			
A2.3 – Zoning and Identification of Low-Carbon Infrastructure and Nature-Based Solutions		2 weeks			
A2.4 – Development of the Regional Blueprint and 2026–2029 Action Plan		2 weeks	D3	W16	2 weeks
PHASE 3 — Regional Governance and Collaborative Platform (SO3 – Stakeholder Engagement)					
A3.1 – Governance Architecture and Mandate of the Technical Committee		**1 week**			
A3.2 – Establishment of a Regional Collaborative Communication Tool		2 weeks			
Deliverables		1 week			
PHASE 4 — Capacity Building and Monitoring & Evaluation (SO4 – Capacity Building)					
A4.1 – Design and implementation of the Regional Capacity-Building and training programme for Tourism SMEs		6 weeks	Capacity building workshops in all the six territories (hybrid/online)	W23	
A4.2 – Co-Development of the Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Toolkit		6 weeks			
A4.3 – The Move Event: a Regional Blue Tourism Knowledge & Networking Event		2 weeks	On-site : One regional capacity building event: The Move Event	W28	
A4.4 – Capitalisation and Knowledge Sharing		1 week			

PHASE 5 — Financing Strategy and Blue Investment Pipeline - (Mobilising Sustainable and Private Finance) (SO5 – Financing Strategy)					
A5.1 – Mapping of Available Financial Instruments		1 week			
A5.2 – Development of the Regional Financing Strategy		2 weeks			
A5.3 – Identification and Structuring of the Blue Investment Pipeline		2 weeks			
A5.4 – Development of Investment Tools and Regional Investment Forum		2 weeks			
PHASE 6 — Digital Branding, Certification, and Communication (SO6 – Indian Ocean Blue Tourism Brand)					
A6.1 – Development of a Shared Narrative and Digital Brand Ecosystem		3 weeks			
A6.2 – Establishment of the Regional Blue Tourism Label Framework		3 weeks			
A6.3 – Regional Communication and Digital Marketing Strategy		3 weeks			
A6.4 – Regional Launch Forum for the Blue Tourism label and Brand		1 week	Blueprint and Validation workshop with technical committee		
Drafting of the final report (gathering all the outputs of the project)		1 week	D4	W31	2 weeks

C. CONSULTANT'S ORGANIZATION AND STAFFING

- **Organigram**




LC1 - Local Representative – Seychelles
Jude BIJOUX
LC4 - Local Representative – Comoros
Nassuf Ahmed ABDOU
LC2 - Local Representative – La Réunion
Olivia AH-SON
LC3 - Local Representative – Mayotte
François-Guy VILLE
K2 - Stakeholder Engagement & Facilitation Specialist
Gregory MARTIN
NK1 - Low-Carbon Transition Expert
Jean-Luc WILAIN
LC5 - Local Representative – Madagascar
Vonjisoa RASOLOARISON

- **Technical Team**

K1 - Team Leader – Sustainable Tourism Development and Climate Change Specialist



Frédéric Thomas is an **economist specialising in sustainable tourism, trade and investment**, with over **twenty years of international experience** leading multidisciplinary teams and designing strategies for **island and coastal economies**. He currently works as an **international consultant in sustainable tourism** and serves as **Associate Professor at the University of Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne**. Over the course of his career, he has acted as **Team Leader and Lead Tourism Expert** for major donor-funded assignments, including the **Blue Tourism Hub Initiative (UNDP, Guinea-Bissau, 2023)**, where he supported the creation of a governance framework and business incubator for marine and circular tourism. He also led the **Tonga Tourism and Investment Roadmap (ITC, 2025)**, developing a **marine tourism and investment strategy aligned with Blue Economy principles**. In **Sri Lanka**, he contributed to the **Climate Change Adaptation Strategy for Tourism (GGGI, 2022–2024)**, preparing the **national framework for climate adaptation and resilience in the tourism sector**. He previously coordinated the formulation of the **National Tourism Policies of Madagascar (World Bank, 2020–2021)** and **Sri Lanka (UNDP, 2020–2021)**, integrating **sustainability, investment readiness, and stakeholder participation** into national regulatory frameworks.

In addition to his policy and planning expertise, Thomas has conducted numerous **feasibility studies, cost–benefit analyses, and tourism investment assessments** for **AFD, the World Bank, ITC, and IFC**, including the **Feasibility Study for AFD Financing in Cameroon (2019)** and the **P4R Tourism Diversification Programme in Morocco (2015)**. His assignments consistently combine **economic analysis with environmental and social sustainability**, ensuring **inclusive, low-carbon, and resilient tourism models** that align with international best practices and donor expectations.

Thomas has extensive exposure to the **Indian Ocean region**, through both field and academic work in **Madagascar, Seychelles, Mauritius, Djibouti, and Sri Lanka**. His expertise covers **Blue Economy integration, sustainable island tourism planning, and coastal community resilience**. He has collaborated with **institutions operating within the Indian Ocean Commission region**, developing governance, investment, and climate adaptation strategies tailored to **Small Island Developing States (SIDS)**.

He holds a **PhD in Tourism Economics and Sustainable Development** from the **University of Nice Sophia-Antipolis (2003, with highest honours)**, a **Master II in Industrial Organisation and Production Financing (Econometrics and Statistics)** (1999), and a **Master I in Economics** (1998) from the same university.

Thomas is a **native French speaker** and is **fluent in English**, which he uses as his working language.

K2 - Stakeholder Engagement and Facilitation Specialist (based in Maurice)



Grégory Martin is a **Mauritian–French expert in stakeholder engagement and ecological transition**, with **over a decade of experience** facilitating dialogue between **public authorities, private enterprises, and civil society** across the **Indian Ocean region**. He has played a pivotal role in connecting regional actors and promoting sustainable cooperation between **Mauritius, La Réunion, and neighbouring islands**. From **2013 to 2023**, he served as the **Official Representative of the Regional Council of Réunion Island in Mauritius**, working within **Team Europe frameworks** that included the **European Delegation, AFD, and the French Embassy**. During this period, he coordinated **over 130 cooperation projects**, signed **eight memoranda of understanding**, and organised **more than forty official missions**. He also led **national consultations for the INTERREG programme** and coordinated the **first Joint Commission between La Réunion and Mauritius (2022)**, which brought together **over ninety participants** from government, business, and civil society.

Building on this extensive experience in regional dialogue, Martin has recently deepened his engagement in **sustainable development, circular economy, and blue economy** facilitation. As **Founder of MAUTOPIA**, a

Mauritian agency dedicated to ecological transition, he has advised both **public and private sectors** on circular economy development and stakeholder coordination. He **co-facilitates the "Rodrigues Green Island" Roadmap (AFD, 2025)** as part of the **ARTELIA–NODALIS–LEGIS consortium**, supporting the island's ecological transition and local governance mechanisms. His expertise has also been mobilised for several regional initiatives, including the **Mauritius Plastic Pollution Free Roadmap (University of Mauritius, Ministry of Environment and UNEP, 2025)** and the **ExPLOI Programme with Plastic Odyssey (Indian Ocean Commission, 2025)**, where he organised collaborative workshops and facilitated partnerships among **government agencies, private operators, and NGOs**.

Martin's experience extends to the **tourism and hospitality sector**, where he has led **ecological transition initiatives for the Association of Hoteliers and Restaurateurs of Mauritius (AHRIM, 2024)**, facilitating environmental committees, capacity-building sessions, and **pilot projects on waste collection and sustainable practices**. For the **Association of Mauritian Manufacturers (AMM)**, he has conducted **multi-stakeholder workshops** on **industrial symbiosis**, **Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR)**, and the **emergence of local recycling networks**, strengthening the private sector's role in sustainable resource management.

Through his various roles, Martin has demonstrated a proven ability to **convene, mediate, and align diverse stakeholder groups** around shared sustainability objectives, making him ideally positioned to support **inclusive and participatory approaches** in **Blue Tourism development**. His work is grounded in a **strong understanding of the socio-economic and institutional realities of the Indian Ocean**, informed by his dual **Mauritian–French background** and active engagement with **regional cooperation frameworks**.

He holds a **Master's in International Management** from **ISG Business School in Paris (2008)** and a **DUT in Business Management for Small Enterprises** from the **University of Paris XIII (2004)**. A **native French speaker**, he is **fluent in English** and **Mauritian Creole**, allowing him to work effectively with both international institutions and local communities.

K3 - Branding and Communication Specialist



Alex Jeffries is an **international branding and communication specialist** with a strong focus on **sustainable tourism marketing** and **destination identity development**. He is currently the **Director of Passport Creative**, a France-based agency dedicated to developing **brand strategies for tourism operators and destinations**. His expertise lies in integrating **community values**, **cultural heritage**, and **environmental responsibility** into tourism narratives and visual identities, ensuring brand coherence across multiple media and markets.

Jeffries has designed and implemented **branding and communication strategies** for tourism operators in **Africa and the Indian Ocean**, including **Madagascar**, where he developed **destination marketing tools and visual identities** for safari and adventure operators. His work consistently aligns branding initiatives with **sustainability and community empowerment principles**. He has led several **international assignments for the International Trade Centre (ITC)**, including in **The Gambia (2025–present)**, where he conducted a **comprehensive digital audit** of tourism and creative industry stakeholders and developed a **digital maturity monitoring framework**, and in **Eswatini (2024–present)**, where he **trained national tourism teams** on **destination branding, digital marketing, and promotional content creation**. For **Tonga (2025)**, he carried out a **digital competitiveness analysis** and developed a **market prioritization framework** for the island's tourism sector.

Jeffries also contributed to the **Climate Change Resilience in Tourism Project in Sri Lanka (GGGI, 2022–2024)**, where he **co-authored technical papers** on tourism adaptation to climate change, **developed vulnerability assessment tools**, and supported the integration of **sustainability and resilience principles** into national tourism communication strategies. Before his transition to sustainable tourism, he worked in the **media industry** as **Senior Producer for Fox's *The Real* in the United States (2015–2020)**, managing production teams and developing **human-interest narratives** for a global audience—skills he now applies to destination storytelling and brand identity design.

He holds a **Master's degree in Management of International Tourism** from the University of Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne (IREST, 2021) and a **Bachelor's degree in Spanish with a specialization in Film and Television Studies** from the University of California, Los Angeles (2010). He has also received advanced professional training in **digital brand platforms, tourism intelligence, data visualization, and workshop facilitation**.

A native English speaker, Jeffries is fluent in French and Spanish and has working proficiency in Italian. His experience bridging communication, sustainability, and tourism—combined with his regional work in **Madagascar**—positions him well to contribute to the creation of a strong, inclusive, and environmentally responsible Blue Tourism brand for the Indian Ocean.

NK1 - Low-Carbon Transition Expert (based in Maurice)



Jean-Luc Wilain is a **Mauritian engineer and sustainability strategist** with more than **thirty years of professional experience** in business management, low-carbon transition, and corporate sustainability. He is the **Managing Director of WillChange Ltd**, a Mauritian advisory firm specialising in **climate change mitigation, carbon footprint assessment, and low-carbon strategy design**. An **accredited Bilan Carbone Master**, he has conducted **over fifty greenhouse gas (GHG) evaluations** and prepared **transition plans** in accordance with international standards such as the **GHG Protocol**. His work also includes **training programmes on carbon accounting and energy transition**, as well as **strategic reviews and project finance advisory** to support public and private actors in developing sustainable growth pathways.

Wilain represents the **Zero Emissions Research and Initiatives (ZERI) Foundation** and its founder, **Gunter Pauli**, in Mauritius, fostering collaboration between local institutions and international experts on applied sustainability initiatives. Notably, he supported the **Mauritian Ministry of Environment, Solid Waste and Climate Change** through the establishment of the **Lagoon Water Quality Index (LWQI)**, a tool for monitoring environmental performance in coastal areas. His career reflects a deep engagement with **climate action and sustainable innovation** across island economies.

Previously, Wilain served as **Chief Operating Officer and Head of Business Development** at **Ireland Blyth Limited (IBL)**, one of Mauritius's leading conglomerates. There, he forged **strategic partnerships in renewable energy** with firms such as **ENGIE, GREENYELLOW, SKYSAILS POWER, and ETIA**, led the company's **corporate sustainability strategy**, and acted as IBL's **main liaison with Mauritian authorities** including the Ministry of Environment, the Economic Development Board, and the Central Electricity Board. His leadership extended to **project finance, PPP negotiation**, and **investment management**, including the coordination of a **public–private partnership with the Republic of Gabon**.

As part of his continued contribution to sustainability, Wilain mentors start-ups in **renewable energy, marine biotechnology, and sustainable materials** through innovation incubators in **Mauritius and Finland** (2021–2023). His advisory work promotes **low-carbon innovation** and **resource-efficient practices** within emerging Blue Economy ecosystems. He is also the **Director of Blue Innovation Ltd**, a company owning the **PORRIMA experimental vessel** (formerly *Planet Solar*), the first ship to circumnavigate the globe powered exclusively by solar energy.

He holds an **Engineering Master's degree ("Ingénieur civil des Mines")** from **ENS Mines Saint-Étienne (1985)**, an **Advanced Management Program** from the **Ecole de Management de Lyon (2010)**, a **Postgraduate Diploma in Business Administration and Strategy** from **Stellenbosch University (2016)**, and a **Bilan Carbone certification** from the **Institut Français du Carbone (2020)**.

Wilain is the **author of "L'indépendance en 2068: les défis d'aujourd'hui"**, an essay analysing Mauritius's path toward **decarbonisation and energy sovereignty**. He is a **member of the Shift Project**, the **Association pour la Transition Bas Carbone (ABC)**, the **Business Mauritius Sustainable and Inclusive Growth Commission**, and **Chapter Zero – The Directors' Climate Forum**.

A **native French speaker**, he is **fluent in English and Spanish**. His long-standing engagement with **Mauritian climate policy, low-carbon innovation, and regional cooperation** makes him a key asset for advancing the **Blue Tourism Cluster's sustainability and climate resilience objectives** in the **Indian Ocean**.

LC1 – Local Counterpart– Seychelles



Jude Bijoux is a **Seychellois marine ecologist and fisheries expert** with more than **twenty years of professional experience** in **marine resources management, biodiversity conservation, fisheries governance, and climate change adaptation**. He is the **Managing Director of Fisheries and Marine Consultancy Services (FMCS)** and **CAFE Consulting**, two Seychelles-based firms providing advisory services to national institutions and regional organisations. Over the course of his career, he has collaborated extensively with **UNDP, UNEP, FAO, the Indian Ocean Commission (IOC), the World Bank, the Seychelles Fishing Authority (SFA), the Ministry of Agriculture, Climate Change and Environment (MACCE)**, and the **Seychelles Conservation and Climate Adaptation Trust (SeyCCAT)**. His work combines technical expertise in marine ecology with a deep understanding of policy processes and institutional coordination within island environments.

Bijoux has led numerous **marine and coastal governance projects in Seychelles**, including as **Team Leader for the National Tuna Management and Industry Development Plans** under the **World Bank SWIOFish3 Project (2022–2024)**, where he coordinated multi-stakeholder consultations and policy formulation. He is also **Team Leader for the Aldabra Group Marine National Park Management Plan (SeyCCAT, 2025)** and has coordinated the **climate change adaptation chapter** of Seychelles' **Fourth National Communication and First Biennial Transparency Report to the UNFCCC (UNEP, 2024–2025)**. His consultancy has produced key national frameworks such as the **National Coral Reef Conservation and Management Plan (2020)**, the **National Plan of Action to Eliminate IUU Fishing (Ecofish Programme, 2023–2024)**, and the **GEF-8 Blue and Green Economy Project Document (UNDP, 2024)**.

Earlier in his career, Bijoux served as **Chief Fisheries Scientist at the Seychelles Fishing Authority (2013–2015)**, where he supervised the development of the **Demersal Fisheries Management Plan for the Mahé Plateau** and coordinated scientific research on artisanal fisheries. Prior to that, as **Manager of the Research Section at the Seychelles National Parks Authority (2003–2007)**, he oversaw **marine research and monitoring programmes**, including the management of **Curieuse Marine National Park**, Seychelles' most visited protected area. He also worked as **Integrated Coastal Zone Management Officer for the Indian Ocean Commission (2007–2010)**, supporting the **ReCoMaP Project** and contributing to the **Seychelles Sustainable Development Plan (2012–2020)**.

Bijoux's technical expertise spans **marine ecology, fisheries stock assessment, climate vulnerability analysis, integrated coastal zone management, and Blue Economy planning**. His work routinely combines scientific research with participatory stakeholder engagement, policy drafting, and institutional capacity building for government agencies, NGOs, and local communities.

He holds a **PhD in Marine Ecology (Université de la Méditerranée Aix-Marseille II, 2014)**, a **Master's degree in Oceanology – Environment and Economy (Université de la Méditerranée Aix-Marseille II, 2009)**, and a **BSc (Hons) in Marine Biology (University of Newcastle upon Tyne, 2001)**. He has also completed advanced certifications in **Integrated Coastal Zone Management**, **Fisheries Stock Assessment**, and **Sustainability Leadership** from the **University of Cambridge Institute for Sustainability Leadership (2024)**.

A **native Seychellois Creole speaker**, Bijoux is **fluent in English and French**. His long-standing collaboration with national and international partners positions him as a key liaison for the **Blue Tourism Cluster initiative**, ensuring close coordination with **Seychelles' institutions, marine stakeholders, and regional organisations** across the Indian Ocean.

LC2 - Local Counterpart– La Réunion



Olivia Ah-Son is a **Réunion-based strategy and development consultant** with over a decade of experience supporting **public institutions and private organisations** in the design and implementation of **territorial, economic, and ecological transformation projects**. She is currently a **Senior Consultant at Verso Consulting (Saint-Denis, La Réunion)**, where she leads assignments related to **institutional strengthening, socio-economic planning, and green transition** in the French Overseas Departments and the wider Indian Ocean region. Her work combines **analytical expertise and participatory facilitation**, ensuring the integration of sustainability and inclusiveness into local development policies.

Ah-Son has played a key role in major strategic initiatives in **La Réunion**, including the **Technical Assistance for the Ecological and Industrial Transition of the Western Coast Territory (Territoire de l'Ouest, 2022–2024)**. In this assignment, she **facilitated territorial cooperation** among institutional, academic, and private stakeholders, coordinated the **structuring of blue and green economy projects**, and contributed to the creation of the **Tropical and Insular Innovation Campus (CITI)**. She also supported **Réunion Prospective Compétence (2025)** in analysing the **impact of ecological, digital, and agri-food transitions on employment and skills**, identifying future labour needs to guide local training and workforce planning.

Her regional experience extends beyond La Réunion to the neighbouring islands. In **Mayotte (2023–2024)**, she contributed to the **evaluation of the "Octroi de Mer" strategy** for the Departmental Council and prepared a **territorial diagnosis for economic development in the South Mayotte intercommunal area**, mapping local sectors and formulating recommendations for the establishment of a development agency. She has also coached project holders within the **OMBREE II incubation programme (2023)**, promoting innovation and sustainability across the French Overseas Territories.

Before returning to the Indian Ocean, Ah-Son worked in **international development and management consulting**, notably with **Acting for Life** in West Africa (2017–2020), where she managed donor-funded programmes on agropastoralism and vocational training, and with **Médecins Sans Frontières** in North Africa and the Middle East, where she coordinated HR and financial systems in complex operational environments. She began her career with **Capgemini Consulting**, supporting major corporate and institutional transformation projects in France and internationally.

She holds a **Master of Science in Strategy and Organisation Consultancy** from **EDHEC Business School (2011)**. A **native French speaker**, she is **fluent in English** and brings to the Blue Tourism initiative a combination of **strategic planning expertise, stakeholder engagement capacity, and regional knowledge of La Réunion and the Indian Ocean**.

LC3 - Local Counterpart– Mayotte



François Guy Ville is a **sustainable development and strategy specialist** with over a decade of experience leading **territorial cooperation, green economy, and tourism projects** across the **Indian Ocean region**. Based in **Mayotte and Réunion**, he has extensive expertise in the **transition of island economies toward sustainability**, combining economic development planning, stakeholder facilitation, and environmental strategy. Since 2015, he has served as **Senior Manager at VERSO Consulting (Réunion)**, where he manages strategic studies and technical assistance assignments for **public institutions and private operators** in areas such as **blue economy development, circular economy, and low-carbon transition**.

Ville has carried out several assignments directly in **Mayotte**, including **support to local tourism project promoters under the Sustainable Tourism Fund (ADEME, 2021)**, where he guided local entrepreneurs in developing proposals aligned with national sustainability frameworks. He also led the **feasibility study for the establishment of the Energy Renovation Support Service (SARE, ADEME, 2021)**, defining its governance, scope, and implementation plan to strengthen **climate resilience and energy efficiency** in the island's built environment. These experiences have provided him with a deep understanding of **Mayotte's institutional landscape**, **private-sector dynamics**, and **community-level development challenges**.

Beyond Mayotte, Ville has coordinated regional projects advancing **blue and green economy integration**. He facilitated multi-stakeholder cooperation for the **ecological and industrial transition of the Western Coast Territory in Réunion (2022–2024)**, identifying and structuring projects in sustainable tourism, innovation, and resource management. He also contributed to the **definition of a Territorial Platform for Sustainable Food Systems (Qualitropic, 2022)** and the **regional study on aquaculture markets for the Réunion Regional Council (2025–2026)**, both aligned with the objectives of the **Outermost Regions Innovation Plan (PIOM)**.

His professional background combines **economic and environmental expertise**. Trained at **Toulouse Business School (Master 2 in Management and Strategy, 2011)**, he also completed specialised training in **Bilan Carbone (2009)** and **Corporate Social Responsibility (2008)**. His early work included assignments in **innovation ecosystems** (Cleantech Open, USA) and **corporate sustainability analysis** (EDF, Ipsos, CGI).

A **native French speaker** and **fluent English professional**, Ville brings a unique regional perspective bridging **Mayotte, Réunion, and the wider Indian Ocean islands**. His proven experience in **sustainable tourism, territorial governance, and climate-oriented development** positions him as a key liaison for ensuring **local coordination, stakeholder engagement, and the operational rollout of the Blue Tourism Cluster** in **Mayotte**.

LC4 - Local Counterpart – Comoros



Nassuf Ahmed Abdou is a **Comorian coastal geographer and marine resource specialist** with more than **fifteen years of experience** in **coastal ecosystem management, fisheries governance, and sustainable tourism development** across the **Union of the Comoros**. His expertise lies in the **intersection of Blue Economy planning, ecotourism promotion, and climate change adaptation**, where he has worked closely with **national ministries, UN agencies, and local communities** to design policies and implement field-based projects for the sustainable use of marine and coastal resources.

He is currently a **Fisheries Expert at the National Institute for Research on Agriculture, Fisheries and Environment (INRAPE)**, where he has participated in **FAO-supported stock assessments** (octopus, lobster, squid), the formulation of **co-management frameworks for artisanal fisheries**, and the preparation of the **National Aquaculture Development Plan (2021)**. He has also authored a **training manual on sustainable fishing practices** for small-scale fishers, contributing to national efforts to strengthen the **Blue Economy sector** through improved governance and ecological responsibility.

Ahmed Abdou has served as **consultant and technical expert for UNDP, FAO, UNEP, and the Comorian Ministries of Environment and Tourism**, leading multiple projects that link **coastal protection and sustainable tourism**. He co-authored the **Comoros National Charter for the Environment (2024)** and the **National Strategy for Sustainable Coastal Tourism (2023)**, which provide the country's guiding frameworks for integrated resource management and climate-resilient tourism. He has also led feasibility studies for **marine and coastal protected areas**, including the **Itsandra Marine Park (2022–2023)** and **mangrove rehabilitation sites in Iconi and Domboini (2022)**, and conducted **environmental impact assessments** such as the **Fishing Port of Chindini (2016)**. His fieldwork has combined **biophysical and socio-economic surveys**, stakeholder facilitation, and community training to ensure local ownership of marine conservation initiatives.

Ahmed Abdou has also contributed to the **development of community-based ecotourism** through a series of projects supported by UNDP and the Ministry of Tourism, including the **Ecotourism and Blue Economy Potential Assessment for Mohéli Island (2020)** and the **Mitsamiouli–Galawa Coastal Area Ecotourism Project (2019)**. These initiatives assessed tourism potential, designed management frameworks, and promoted **inclusive, climate-conscious tourism models** in coastal and marine settings. His **2018 baseline study on coastal vulnerability to climate change** and ongoing **PhD research at Cheikh Anta Diop University in Senegal** further reinforce his academic leadership on **climate resilience and island sustainability**.

He holds a **Master's in Ecotourism and Bio-Management (University of Toliara, Madagascar, 2015)**, a **DEA in Geography (University of Antananarivo, 2014)**, and a **Licence in Geography (University of the Comoros, 2010)**. His doctoral research, expected in 2025, focuses on *"Challenges of Coastal Zone Vulnerability to Climate Change and Human Activities in an Island Country: The Case of the Comoros."*

A **native Comorian speaker**, he is **bilingual in French**, with **working proficiency in Arabic and English**. His long-standing engagement with **coastal governance, ecotourism policy, and Blue Economy initiatives** positions him

as a strategic liaison for implementing the **Blue Tourism Cluster** in the **Comoros**, ensuring strong institutional coordination and community participation.

LC5 - Local Counterpart– Madagascar



Vonjisoa Rasoloarison is a **Madagascar-based environmental and biodiversity specialist** with more than **twenty-five years of experience** in **natural resource management, coastal governance, and community-based conservation**. He has played a central role in coordinating **marine, coastal, and protected area programmes** across Madagascar, combining technical, institutional, and participatory approaches to promote sustainable development and biodiversity conservation. His career demonstrates a deep understanding of **Madagascar's coastal ecosystems**, from the **mangroves of Menabe** to the **marine protected areas of DIANA and SAVA**, and of the social and economic dynamics that underpin successful **Blue Economy and ecotourism initiatives**.

Rasoloarison has led or contributed to numerous projects linking **biodiversity conservation with sustainable tourism and fisheries**. As **Governance and Biodiversity National Expert for WWF (2025)**, he participated in developing the project *"Sustainable Financing and Inclusive Management of Locally Managed Marine Areas (LMMAs)"* across Madagascar's DIANA, Menabe and Atsimo Andrefana regions. He conducted the **diagnosis of the ecotourism sector in the mangroves of Kivalo Menabe (WWF, 2024)**, assessing visitor patterns and stakeholder engagement to design an incubation programme for community-based tourism. Under the **AFD-funded Kobaby Project (2023–2024)**, he facilitated **benefit-sharing workshops** in nine protected areas, including three marine ones, and contributed to **tourism development in the Tsingy Mahaloka complex**, supporting a partnership between the **KOFAMA community** and **Iharana SARL**, a local tour operator.

As **Team Leader for Société Miavana (2024–2025)**, Rasoloarison oversaw the **Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA)** for the **Ankao Archipelago development project**, located within the **marine section of the Loky Manambato protected area**—a major Blue Tourism site in northern Madagascar. He has also led multiple **environmental and social studies** for projects in the fisheries, hydropower, and tourism sectors, including for **Sahanala S.A (fishery infrastructure, 2022)**, **MGB Development (blue tourism scoping, 2020)**, and **Themis Clean Energy (Sahofika Hydropower, 2017–2022)**. His earlier assignments with **Fanamby NGO** included directing **five protected landscape programmes (600,000 ha, 25 communes, 100,000 people)**, managing **coastal and marine ecosystems**, **watershed restoration**, and **value-chain development** in cocoa, spices, and essential oils, while coordinating donor-funded projects from **EU, UNDP, AFD, GEF, and WTO**.

Throughout his career, Rasoloarison has combined **technical expertise in ESIA and coastal biodiversity management** with **hands-on community facilitation and governance support**. His work has strengthened local structures for co-management of **marine and coastal resources**, promoted **inclusive benefit-sharing mechanisms**, and encouraged **sustainable tourism ventures** within conservation landscapes.

He holds a **Diploma of Advanced Studies (DEA) in Plant Ecology (1994)** and a **Master's degree in Applied Biological Sciences (1990)** from the **University of Antananarivo**. A **native Malagasy speaker**, he is **fluent in French** and has a **working knowledge of English**. His long-standing engagement with **marine conservation, ecotourism development, and local governance** makes him a key asset for ensuring the **Blue Tourism Cluster's relevance and integration within Madagascar's coastal and island communities**.

- **Management and supervision team**

The pillars of our management approach to achieving efficiency are: (i) good planning and monitoring to encourage problem solving and maintain focus on technical work (ii) clear lines of communication and responsibility that avoid duplication and confusion (iii) the use of templates, checklists and standard procedures that ensure completeness and avoid reinventing the wheel.

In addition to our internal quality assurance system, we are pleased to mention that IOS Partners implements a 'two-tier' quality management process, with a company-level approach and a project-level approach. At both levels, the company's quality programme is based on the requirements of ISO 9000, the international quality standard.

For this project, IOS has designated the following people as responsible for the execution, quality compliance, control and verification of each of the project activities:

Person responsible for the QCP	Area of responsibility
NK1 - Tea ALANIA ***Head of Project Management***	● Supervision of project activities and outputs, checking compliance with the terms of reference and work plan, meeting contractual deadlines. ● Responsible for overseeing logistical aspects of mission activities and other administrative tasks. Also available to provide ongoing support to the team.
NK2 - Robert HANS ***Quality Control & Insurance***	● Overall quality control and high-level independent advice on organisational development. ● Supervision of project activities and outputs, checking compliance with terms of reference and work plan.
Permanent IOS Project Coordinator	● Constant communication with the client and team members. ● Assist the Team Leader (K1) to ensure the smooth running of the project by ensuring constant contact with the customer, coordination between experts and management of logistical issues. ● Report directly to the IOS Head of PM (NK1).